The Dharma Text of the Buddha's Treasury

Toh 123 · Derge Kangyur

སངས་རྒྱས་ཀྱི་མཛོད་ཀྱི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་ཡི་གེ།

The Dharma Text of the Buddha's Treasury, known in Tibetan as Sangs rgyas kyi mdzod kyi chos kyi yi ge, is a Mahāyāna sūtra that also bears the alternative title The Instruction Given on All Phenomena. Set on Vulture Peak Mountain near Rājagṛha before a great assembly of monks and countless bodhisattvas, it opens with Śāriputra rising from meditation to question the Buddha about his teaching that all phenomena are without arising, without cessation, and without characteristics. The Buddha's response unfolds across chapters that explain the "Buddha's Treasury," beginning with an exploration of the true characteristic of all phenomena. The work is Toh 123 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the general sūtras of the Great Vehicle.

The Dharma Text of the Buddha's Treasury, first fascicle. It is also called "The Instruction Given on All Phenomena." The first chapter of the text in which the Buddha explains the Buddha's Treasury: the chapter on the true characteristic of all phenomena.

Thus have I heard at one time. The Buddha was staying on Vulture Peak Mountain, near the city of Rājagṛha, together with a great assembly of monks, all of them widely known and learned, and with boundless bodhisattva great beings, immeasurable and countless.

At that time Śāriputra rose from his meditative absorption and went to the Buddha. He bared his right shoulder, bowed down with his head and face, and said to the Buddha, "Blessed One, the Tathāgata has taught that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity. It is rare for people to believe and understand this."

The Buddha said to Śāriputra, "What merit do you see, that you offer this praise, saying, 'When the Tathāgata teaches that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rare for people to believe and understand it'?"

Śāriputra said to the Buddha, "Blessed One, it is not that anything is real; I have privately had this thought. The Blessed One explains the Dharma that has no name and no characteristic by means of names and characteristics. He explains the Dharma that has no speech and no words by means of speech

and words. When I reflect on the meaning of that, the thought arises of how rare this is."

The Buddha said to Śāriputra, "So it is, so it is. Its meaning is rare, supremely rare. Therefore it is called the unsurpassed, eternal, perfect awakening of the buddhas.

"Śāriputra, suppose a skilled painter were to paint upon space, and make colors and forms of every kind appear there. What do you think? Would that painter be rare or not?"

"Blessed One, he would be rare."

"Śāriputra, when the Tathāgata, through the unsurpassed, eternal, perfect awakening that he attained, teaches that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rarer by far for people to believe and understand it. And why is that? Concerning the Dharma that has no name and no characteristic, there is no thinking, no attaining, and no practicing. It is inconceivable, and it is not something in which the mind can abide or on which it can rely. There is no expressing it by comparison; it cannot be expressed by comparison, nor can it serve as a support or a place to abide. There is no feeling of it, no examining of it, no way of gathering it in. It does not remain in the mind. There is no attaining it by attainment. It has no near shore and no far shore. It has no conceptual thought, no movement, and no intrinsic nature. Since it is empty of itself from the very beginning, it cannot be thought and it cannot arise. Such a Dharma without name or characteristic, which the whole world is unable to believe, is taught by means of names and characteristics. Therefore, when it is taught in this way, that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rarer still for people to believe and understand it.

"Śāriputra, suppose someone could chew up Mount Meru, king of mountains, swallow it, digest it completely, and then fly off into the sky unharmed. What do you think? Would that be rare or not?"

"Blessed One, it would be rare."

"Śāriputra, when the buddhas teach that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rarer still for people to believe and understand it.

"Śāriputra, suppose there were a city of men, its breadth and height each one yojana, with flames bursting from its four gates, and a man carrying a load of

dry grass were to cross through it. The flames, fanned by a fierce wind, would burn his body, yet the fire would not burn the grass, nor could it burn his body, and he would come out from within it no different from before. What do you think of that? Would it be rare or not?"

"Blessed One, it would be rare."

"Śāriputra, when the Tathāgata teaches that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rarer still for people to believe and understand it.

"Śāriputra, suppose someone were to make a boat out of stone and cross over from the near shore of a lake to the far shore. What do you think of that? Would it be rare or not?"

"Blessed One, it would be rare."

"Śāriputra, when the Tathāgata teaches that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rarer still for people to believe and understand it.

"Śāriputra, suppose someone were to carry as a load Mount Meru, king of mountains, together with all the mountains, rivers, grasses, and trees beneath the four quarters of the sky, and, making a ladder out of a fly's leg, were to climb all the way up to the realm of Brahmā. What do you think of that? Would it be rare or not?"

"Blessed One, it would be rare."

"Śāriputra, when the Tathāgata teaches that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rarer still for people to believe and understand it.

"Śāriputra, again, suppose a lotus fiber, fine as a thread of rain, were to hold up Mount Meru, king of mountains, so that it hung in the sky. What do you think of that? Would it be rare or not?"

"Blessed One, it would be rare."

"Śāriputra, when the Tathāgata teaches that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rarer still for people to believe and understand it.

"Śāriputra, suppose that when the world is being consumed by the great fire at the end of the eon, a man could extinguish that fire by spitting a single time, and by blowing a single time could restore the world systems and the palaces

of the gods. What do you think of that? Would it be rare or not?"

"Blessed One, it would be rare."

"Śāriputra, when the Tathāgata teaches that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rarer still for people to believe and understand it.

"Śāriputra, the river Ganges is great and wide, beyond all measure and reckoning."

"Blessed One, it is so."

"Śāriputra, suppose a great rain were to fall everywhere beneath the four quarters of the sky, with raindrops as large as the river Ganges, and a man were to catch the raindrops in his hand so that none fell or leaked away. What do you think of that? Would it be rare or not?"

"Blessed One, it would be rare."

"Śāriputra, when the Tathāgata teaches that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rarer still for people to believe and understand it.

"Śāriputra, is Mount Meru, the king of mountains, high and great or not?"

"Blessed One, it is high and great."

"Śāriputra, suppose a rain of great stones were to fall everywhere within the four quarters of the sky, each of them as large as Mount Meru, the king of mountains, and a man were to catch and gather those stones in his hand so that not even a piece the size of a mustard seed fell or slipped away. What do you think of that? Would it be rare or not?"

"Blessed One, it would be rare."

"Śāriputra, when the Tathāgata teaches that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rarer still for people to believe and understand it.

"Śāriputra, suppose, for example, a man were to place all sentient beings in his left hand, and with his right hand lift up the great trichiliocosm with its world systems, Mount Meru, its rivers, and its plants and trees, and could make all those sentient beings be of one mind, joyful and happy, with no divergence in their thoughts. What do you think of that? Would it be rare or not?"

"Blessed One, it would be rare."

"Śāriputra, when the Tathāgata teaches that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no characteristic, and no activity, it is rarer still for people to believe and understand it.

"Śāriputra, the Dharma taught by the Tathāgata is that all phenomena are without essential nature, empty, nothing whatsoever; therefore it is hard for the whole world to believe and understand it. Why is that? Śāriputra, in that Dharma there is no perception; it is free of all perception. There is no thought; it is free of all thought. There is no taking up and no casting off. There is no turmoil. There is no sorrow and torment. There is no near shore and no far shore. There is no middle either. There is no delusion and no knowledge. Only through immeasurable wisdom can it at last be known; it cannot be known by thought.

"There is no conduct, no perception, no sorrow and torment. Since it has no thought, it passes beyond all thought; since it has no mind, it passes beyond all minds. There is no turning toward and no turning away. There is no bondage and no release. There is no truth and no untrue phenomenon. There is no delusion, no phenomenon of delusion, no net of delusion. There is no name, no word, no explanation, and no non-explanation. There is no exhaustion and no non-exhaustion. There is no conduct, no path, and no fruit of the path. Since there is no separation, it passes beyond all separations. There is no thought, no mingling, no taking up, no casting off, and no attainment, nor can it be attained. The truths too are cleared away, and attachment, aversion, and delusion are cleared away as well. There is no truth and no falsehood. It is not permanent, nor is it impermanent. It is not light, nor is it non-light. It is not darkness, nor is it light. It does not abide in the mind. It has no essential nature.

"Because essential nature is empty from the very root, it can crush the māras. It crushes the turmoil of sorrow. It crushes the five aggregates. It crushes the twelve sense spheres. It crushes the eighteen elements. It crushes the claim that the five aggregates exist. It crushes the claim that the twelve sense spheres exist. It crushes the claim that the eighteen elements exist. It crushes the claim that sentient beings exist and the claim that a person exists. It crushes the claim that a lifespan exists, the claim that a life force exists, the claim that existence exists, and the claim that existence does not exist. It crushes all crooked views and annihilationism.

"Śāriputra, this wondrous Dharma of mine can crush all attachment, the claim that phenomena exist, disbelief and lack of faith in the genuinely true mark of all phenomena, and all opposition to the Buddha's Dharma. Why is that? Śāriputra, some sentient beings speak in terms of a view of self, speak of a person, speak of sentient beings as existing, speak of them as not existing, speak with the thought of permanence, speak with the thought of existence, speak with the thought of nonexistence, and speak of phenomena, and speak of them as names of mere images. All such speaking openly opposes the Buddha; it is disputing with the Buddha. Śāriputra, anyone who holds that even the slightest thing is attained in the Dharma is disputing with the Buddha. All who dispute with the Buddha enter a crooked path; they are not my disciples. Not being my disciples, they dispute with nirvāṇa, dispute with the Buddha, dispute with the Dharma, and dispute with the Saṅgha.

"Śāriputra, a person who sees in that way I do not permit to go forth from home and receive the precepts of moral discipline. Śāriputra, a person who sees in that way I do not permit even a single sip of water, nor to receive offerings.

"Śāriputra, suppose there is a person who has in this way cleared away and abandoned the aims of unwholesome attachment, who goes forth from home within my Dharma and does not seek after phenomena, does not think of nirvāṇa, does not even form the thought of nirvāṇa, and is not attached even to nirvāṇa, and who is not frightened or terrified by the Dharma of ultimate emptiness. If even such a person must exert diligence for the sake of expounding all phenomena, what need is there even to mention the views of one who is attached in such a way to the unwholesome? A person who is attached in such a way to the view of self, attached to sentient beings, attached to a person, and attached to phenomena, in order to cut off these attachments, practices and trains so as to accomplish the signless samādhi, and does not grasp a sign even in the signless samādhi. That person comprehends that all phenomena have a single characteristic, and that is characteristiclessness.

"Śāriputra, through this wondrous Dharma such a thing is called the forbearance of pliant and tamed acceptance of the Dharma. When one has obtained such a forbearance of pliant and tamed acceptance of the Dharma, only then is one called my disciple; one is then able to accept the offerings that are made, but has not yet received a prophecy."

If one asks why, Śāriputra, it is because this Dharma of mine, the genuine mark of truth, cannot be entered, cannot be taken up, cannot be discarded, cannot be clung to, and cannot be explained. The path of spoken words is cut off. There is no joy in it, and no delight. The mind that desires and delights is cut off as well, and conditions do not come together. Even through freedom from conditions there is no path; the path is cut off. Words that speak of arriving at the pathless, all expression and all going, all sound and speech, are cut off.

It has no form and no color. There is no taking up, no clinging, no practice, no truth, no falsehood, no darkness, no light, no destruction, no dispute, no coming together, no separation, no movement, no thinking, and no conceptual thought. It cannot be attained. There is no stain, no purity, no name, and no mark. It is not a phenomenon that the mind can count, and it is not something the mind can know.

Within this Dharma of mine there is no male and no female. There is no god, no nāga, no yakṣa, no gandharva, no kumbhāṇḍa, and no piśāca. There is no annihilation and no permanence, no view of a self, no sentient being, and no person. There is no coming, no going, and no entering. There is no moral discipline and no lapse from it, no purity and no stain. There is no samādhi, no sage, and no root of the sage. There is no meditative concentration and no root of meditative concentration. There is no knowing, no seeing, no desire, and no dispute. There is no path and no fruit of the path, no wisdom and no root of wisdom. There is no light, and no absence of light. There is no liberation, and no absence of liberation. There is no result, and no attainment of a result. There is no power, and no attainment of power. There is no fear, and no fearlessness. There is no mind, and no root of mind. There is no staying and no going, no rite, no near shore, and no far shore. There is no conceptual examination by recollection and perception. There is no awakening, and no factor of awakening. There is no wisdom, and no absence of wisdom. There is no earth, no water, no fire, and no wind. There is no evil and no merit. There is no dharma, and no absence of dharma. There is no suffering and no happiness. It is the source, the root of all that is expressed in comparisons; and because it is entirely free of everything, it cannot even be reckoned.

Śāriputra, I have set forth precious words. My Dharma destroys all minds, all views, all māras, and every arising of laziness; it dispels all recollecting and thinking, and it removes all words of speech.

Within that Dharma of mine there is no permanence, and no impermanence either. There is no suffering, and no happiness either. There is no stain, and no purity. There is no annihilation and no permanence. There is no view of a self, no sentient being, and no person. There is no lifespan, no life force, no birth, and no cessation.

If one asks why, Śāriputra, it is because the Tathāgata sees no "I" in phenomena; and although, since the "I" is at peace, this is given the name nirvāṇa, he does not see any attainment of nirvāṇa either. Śāriputra, the Buddha does not think of nirvāṇa, he does not form a thought of nirvāṇa, and he has no attachment to nirvāṇa. Therefore this appears as something supremely wondrous, and it is rare. When the Tathāgata explains that all phenomena have no arising, no cessation, no mark, and no activity, then among all people those who believe it and come to understand it are scarcely to be found.

This is the second chapter, the chapter on recollection of the Buddha.

At that time Śāriputra asked the Buddha, "Blessed One, within this Dharma, what sort of person is called a bad spiritual friend, and what sort is called a good spiritual friend?"

The Buddha said to Śāriputra, "Some monk teaches another monk like this: 'Monk, recollect the Buddha. Recollect the Dharma. Recollect the Saṅgha. Recollect moral discipline. Recollect generosity. Recollect the gods. Monks, contemplate the body, and reflect that the bodily form is impure. Understand that all conditioned phenomena, every one of them, are impermanent. Understand that all phenomena are empty and nonexistent. Monk, take up the marks of all conditions, and, as they are imputed within the conditions of the mind, reflect single-mindedly on the mark of emptiness. Have faith in the virtuous mind. Look at the marks of nonvirtuous phenomena, and once you have taken up the marks of nonvirtuous phenomena, examine them in order to cut them off, and train in the practice of reflection. To cut off attachment, examine the mark of impurity. To cut off aversion, examine the mark of a mind of loving-kindness. To cut off delusion, examine phenomena as causes and conditions. Constantly reflect on pure moral discipline, take up the profound mark of emptiness, and constantly practice diligence. Having attained the four meditative concentrations, seek the path single-mindedly; having abandoned nonvirtuous phenomena, examine that there is inner bliss. Practicing the path single-mindedly, examine and understand the distinction between virtue and

nonvirtue. Having understood them as marks and taken them up, reflect single-mindedly; examine the bliss of nirvāṇa, empty and peaceful, and take up the final end of nirvāṇa as lasting, clean, and wholly pure.'

"Teaching like this is called crooked teaching: to teach such things as though they were straight is to teach crookedly. Śāriputra, one who teaches in this way is called a bad spiritual friend. Such a person is called a slanderer; he is a tīrthika, and empty. He is also called one who explains the Dharma of the path crookedly to others. Śāriputra, to such a bad one I do not allow even a single sip of water to be received as an offering. I may call him a teacher, but I do not call him a disciple. Śāriputra, in my Dharma there are many teachers who teach in such a way that laziness arises. Śāriputra, as for one who receives such teaching: he takes the vows, and if for as long as five years he cannot let go of everything, then, though he applies his mind diligently to what was taught in that way, he gains for himself nothing at all.

As for monks who go forth and neither ask nor inquire, I declare that although such a person has completed five years, he is nonetheless called one of crooked view. He is mixed up with the teachings of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and practices just as Māra teaches.

Śāriputra, suppose a certain monk who has received such teaching hears that in emptiness no phenomenon whatsoever is attained, and at once realizes for himself: "What I received before was entirely crooked view." He has no doubt about the Dharma of emptiness in which nothing whatsoever is attained, and he has no regret. Having entered deeply, and because there is no hearing, he relies on no view of a self and no view of a person at all. Śāriputra, I declare that such a person is called one who practices the pure and stainless holy life.

Śāriputra, if a certain monk accomplishes such forbearance of non-attainment, then even though he would at once see nirvāṇa without remainder, I prophesy that this person will enter the first assembly in the time of the buddha Maitreya. At that time the buddha Maitreya too will be overjoyed and will call out three times: "This person is capable, because in the Dharma of the buddha Śākyamuni he accomplished the forbearance in which nothing whatsoever is attained." So he will call out.

Śāriputra, whether one lives in a household or has gone forth from the household, once such forbearance has been accomplished, I truly prophesy that this person attains nirvāṇa.

Śāriputra, if a certain person who has received such teaching hears the Dharma of emptiness in which nothing whatsoever is attained and is at once terrified, that person deserves compassion. He has no help and no remedy, and he is headed for hell. If one asks why: Śāriputra, because that person, terrified and doubting before the Buddha's teaching, completes the evil path in full. If one asks how: to explain that what I have taught is permanent and that something exists is a portion of the evil path. If one asks how: Śāriputra, in the Dharma attained by the Buddha there is no "it is" or "it is not," and no difference. Were there difference, there would be attainment.

Śāriputra, it would be acceptable for a person even to commit the grave portion of the five heinous wrongs, but it is not acceptable to cultivate the view of a self, the view of a sentient being, the view of a person, the view of a lifespan, the view of a life force, or the view of aggregates, sense bases and elements.

Desire for upholding moral discipline is seeing with attachment to upholding moral discipline. Desire for samādhi is attachment to seeing samādhi. If one relies on the perception of the Buddha, one acquires a perception of the Dharma. If one makes determinations about the Saṅgha, one accomplishes the view of a body. If one asks why: if within the Buddha's Dharma one accomplishes the view of a body, one is not counted among the Saṅgha.

Śāriputra, the disciples of the Buddha have no conceptual scrutiny in their minds. Śāriputra, among the disciples of the Buddha there is no non-virtue, no broken moral discipline, no view of anything as broken, and no broken rite.

Śāriputra, what is it that is called evil and non-virtuous? Within the Buddha and the Saṅgha, whatever is not included among the Saṅgha bears the name evil and non-virtuous. The dharma in which mind counts mind is a coming together of conditions; it has no genuinely true meaning and does nothing but conceptualize. Because it engages in conceptuality, it grasps attainment as existing: from the attainment of a person up to everything that is expressed in words, mind links up with mind until it arrives at virtuous and non-virtuous dharmas. Within the dharma of illusion, this is given the evil name of non-virtuous dharma. If one asks why: Śāriputra, wherever there is pleasure there is, without doubt, affliction. In the Dharma of the Tathāgata there is no such pleasure and pain.

Śāriputra, in what the Tathāgata attained there is no desire, nor even absence of desire; no pleasure and no affliction; no intention, no perception, no activity;

up to and including not even the perception of emptiness. If it is asked why: Śāriputra, if there were a perception of emptiness, it would be a perception that views a self, a perception that views a sentient being, a perception of permanence, a perception of annihilation. If one asks why: Śāriputra, if one follows on account of there being perception, all signs arise, and one has fallen entirely into the crooked.

Śāriputra, the name "emptiness" means mindlessness; that is called emptiness. The mind of emptiness too is empty; that is called emptiness. Śāriputra, within emptiness there is neither good nor bad, up to and including not even the perception of emptiness. Therefore it is named emptiness.

Śāriputra, all dharmas that involve activity can be cognized and can be known. Emptiness cannot be cognized, cannot be known and cannot be thought; therefore it is named emptiness. Śāriputra, the perception of emptiness is not attained by thinking. If one asks why: because emptiness is without perception. Therefore it is named emptiness.

Śāriputra, if one asks why the practice of the action of emptiness is spoken of: not thinking of any perception at all, up to and including not thinking even of the perception of emptiness, is called practicing emptiness. Śāriputra, as for the name "perception," whatever thought there is in the mind is called perception. Having no thought whatsoever is non-perception; because it is free of perception, it is named non-perception. To follow the taking up of perception is entirely crooked view.

If one asks why: Śāriputra, if within the dharma of illusion one grasps empty peace as something attained, one falls into entirely crooked view. What need is there even to mention verbal expression and explanation? What practice of such a Dharma of emptiness could be explained?

Śāriputra, why does the Buddha call everything expressed in speech and words a crooked name? The inability to comprehend all dharmas is the consequence of being obscured by verbal explanation. Therefore the Tathāgata knows that all spoken words are crooked, and not even the slightest spoken word can be true.

Śāriputra, in the unsurpassed, true and perfect awakening of the buddhas there is neither perception nor mind. If one asks why: because the Tathāgata has no attainment of an essential nature in dharmas, nor any attainment of mind.

"Śāriputra, why did the Tathāgata teach that there is an abode of recollection? Śāriputra, the scripture of the Dharma explains it this way. If some person were to obtain an actual abode of recollection, that person would be able to obtain the essential nature of all phenomena. He would be able to obtain his own body, he would obtain the view of a self, and he would obtain a person. But none of that is true at all. The marks of phenomena are distinct, and emptiness is distinct. It is in order to show emptiness that the abode of recollection is taught.

"The essential nature of the abode of recollection has no essential nature. There is no abode, there is no recollection, there is no teaching, and there is no attachment either. If even the essential nature of mind does not exist, what need is there to say that there is no abode of mind? Therefore the Tathāgata taught it under the name 'abode of mind.'

"Śāriputra, if all phenomena truly had an essential nature even as small as a hundredth part of a tenth of a strand of hair, then the words of the buddhas would not come about in the world, and in the end the essential nature of all phenomena would not be taught as empty. Śāriputra, all the Buddha's dharmas are truly empty. They have no essential nature and are of a single mark, and all the tathāgatas see that as without marks. That is why the Tathāgata taught that there is an abode of recollection.

"Śāriputra, the abode of recollection is called 'no abode,' and it is also called 'not even the absence of an abode.' There is no recollection, and no action of recollection either. There is no perception, and no conceptual examination either. There is no mind, and no mental action either. There is no recollection, and no action of recollection either. There is no dharma, and no mark of dharmas either. Since all of this taken together does not exist, it is called subtle and wondrous, free of conceptualization, and its name is 'abode of recollection.' That is why the Tathāgata taught that there is an abode of recollection. Because there is nothing whatsoever, it is called the abode of recollection. Because it is the recollection of the Buddha, it is named the abode of recollection.

"Śāriputra, how is it that something is named recollection of the Buddha? Seeing nothing whatsoever is named recollection of the Buddha. Śāriputra, all the buddhas are immeasurable, inconceivable, and beyond expression. Therefore, on this principle, seeing nothing whatsoever is named recollection of the Buddha, and in truth there is no conceptualization of names. Since the

Buddha does not conceptualize any phenomenon at all, it is when the mind is free of conceptualization that it is truly called recollection of the Buddha.

"Moreover, if one sees the true mark of all phenomena, that is named seeing the Buddha. What is it that is named the true mark of all phenomena? It is that all phenomena are ultimately empty and nothing whatsoever. Therefore the dharma that is ultimately empty and nothing whatsoever is recollection of the Buddha. Moreover, within such a dharma not even the slightest mind can be obtained, and that is named recollection of the Buddha.

"Śāriputra, that is named the dharma of recollecting the Buddha. The path of words and speech is cut off, and it has gone beyond all minds. That in which mind cannot be obtained is named recollection of the Buddha. Śāriputra, all minds without exception are empty of marks and at peace. If one does not go against the Dharma that is thus, that is named the purifying practice of recollecting the Buddha.

"One may not recollect the Buddha by engaging with color either. Why is that? Thinking of color, grasping at form, and being attached to taste is called consciousness. When there is no form, no color, no condition, and no intrinsic nature, that is named recollection of the Buddha. Therefore, when there is no conceptualization, no taking up and no casting away, it is evident that this is genuine recollection of the Buddha."

This is the third chapter, the chapter on recollecting the Dharma.

At that time Śāriputra asked the Buddha, "Blessed One (the Buddha), in what way is one who explains this Dharma to others called a bad spiritual friend? Blessed One, in what way is one who explains this Dharma to others called a virtuous spiritual friend?"

"Śāriputra, suppose some person teaches another monk, saying: 'You should understand this. Recollection of the Buddha is emptiness. It is not right to recollect a basis of conditions. If you recollect emptiness, the recollection too is empty, and that emptiness without intrinsic nature is able to cut off the perception of color and able to cut off the grasping of perceptions.' If that person at that time does not obtain even the absence of perception, what need is there to mention mind? At that time that person is stilled into emptiness with regard to anything at all, existent or nonexistent, and since there is no intrinsic nature, perceptions do not gather. When all phenomena have been stilled, that is called the purifying practice of his recollection.

"The name 'Buddha' means the stilling of all virtue and nonvirtue, of all feeling and examination. When there is no feeling and no examination, when there is emptiness and no perception, that is named recollection of the Buddha. Why is that? It is not right to recollect the buddhas by engaging in feeling and examination. When there is no feeling and no examination, then, because impurity has been purified, it is called recollection of the Buddha. Within that mind there is not even the mental action of the subtlest recollection, so what need is there to say that there is no action of body or mouth?

"Further, what is called recollection of the Buddha is free of all perceptions. No perception at all abides in the mind. There is no conceptualization, no one who names, no obscuration or obstruction, no desire and no attainment, and feeling and examination do not stir. Why is that? Śāriputra, all perceptions that stir in accordance with thought are a seeing that is entirely crooked.

"Śāriputra, just as there is nothing at all, so there is no feeling, no examination, no arising and no cessation. To realize it thus is named recollection of the Buddha. Within such a mind there is no desire, no attachment, nothing mistaken and nothing unmistaken, no name and no mark.

"Śāriputra, it is when there is no perception and no speech that it is truly named recollection of the Buddha. If within it there is not even the smallest, subtlest mind, what need is there to mention coarse mind, or actions of mouth, body and mind? There is not even a basis for actions of body, mouth and mind. There is no grasping, no gathering, no fighting, no dispute, no recollection and no conceptualization. That emptiness which is unmoving and without intrinsic nature, in which all feeling and examination are stilled, is named recollection of the Buddha.

"Śāriputra, if some person accomplishes such wealth of mind, then even if he wished to transform the ground of the four continents, he could transform it at will."

If one is able to overcome even hundreds, thousands and hundreds of thousands of māras, what need is there to speak of those obscured by ignorance? Whatever arises from conditions deceived by what is untrue: the unchanging, the signless, such is that dharma. It has no perception and no recollection, no arising and no cessation. It cannot be spoken of, and it cannot be examined conceptually. It has no darkness and no light. If even Māra and all the hosts of Māra cannot take its measure, then ordinary people of the world make use only of verbal explanation in order to teach and to train. That

is why the words are spoken in this way, and nothing more.

When you contemplate the Buddha, do not take up even the slightest perception. Do not produce recollection. Do not engage in conceptual examination. Why is that? All those dharmas are empty. There is no sign of duality, nor may one contemplate a sign of oneness, for it is signless. That is called contemplating the Buddha in true seclusion. It has no arising and no cessation; it is signless.

Why is that? The Tathāgata is not called "color." He is not called "form." He is not called "mind." He is not called "conceptual thought." He is neither inverted nor uninverted. He is neither taken up nor cast aside. He is not the Sage, nor is he wisdom; he is not knowledge, nor is he ignorance. The Tathāgata cannot be spoken of and is beyond thought, for he has no perception.

Now, do not crave fine signs. Do not give voice to recollection. The Buddha has no attachment to any dharma whatsoever, and he does not see any dharma that exists and could be attached to or could be measured. If for such a person even the Buddha cannot be obtained, what need is there to speak of mind?

Śāriputra, one who teaches in this way is called a spiritual friend. Yet within the supreme doctrine there is no fixed determination that this one is a spiritual friend and that one is a bad friend.

Again, Śāriputra, a certain monk taught another monk, saying, "Monk, discriminate and examine phenomena closely, and do not think even of the sign of phenomena." By training and practicing in this way, that monk's mind became unobstructed and unattached, and so he understood the signs of all phenomena as one. That is signlessness. If the perception of phenomena does not arise in such a person, what need is there to say that the perceptions of the view of a self and the view of a person do not arise?

"Śāriputra, what do you think? Can a person who thinks with the perception of phenomena bring all phenomena to peace?"

"Blessed One, he cannot."

"Śāriputra, for example, can a tree without roots ripen branches, leaves, flowers and fruit, or can it not?"

"Blessed One, it cannot."

"Just so, Śāriputra, if a certain person has not obtained the root source of all phenomena, can that person give rise to the perception of all phenomena, or

can he not?"

"Blessed One, he cannot."

"Śāriputra, when a certain person does not think with the perception of phenomena, can that person bring all phenomena to peace?"

"Blessed One, he cannot."

"That person does not obtain any phenomena, does not obtain the sign of phenomena, and does not obtain peace. Nor does he conceptualize. If there is no arising and no cessation, then, because at that time that person neither arises nor ceases, he is not called 'one who has attained nirvāṇa.' Nor is he called 'one who previously attained nirvāṇa.'

"Śāriputra, one who teaches in this way is called a spiritual friend. Yet within the supreme doctrine there is neither spiritual friend nor bad friend.

"Śāriputra, if a certain person accomplishes such a sign, he is rare in the world. Because he has obtained what is not inverted, he sees the true reality, and that is called straight view. Further, Śāriputra, straight view is called acting straight, practicing straight, the straight path, and knowing straight. Because it sees without inversion, as things truly are, the Tathāgata calls it straight view.

"Śāriputra, when certain beings realize without inversion, as things truly are, there is straight view. When certain others give rise to the perception of a view of self, the perception of a person, and the perception of a sentient being, all such people are plainly traveling a crooked path.

"Śāriputra, the buddhas and their disciples have not taught that there is a self. They have not taught that there is a person. They have not taught that there is a sentient being. They have not taught that there is a life or a life force. They have not taught permanence or annihilation. Therefore the buddhas and their disciples are called those of straight view. Why is that? Because they examine straightly and are not inverted.

"Śāriputra, none of the ordinary people are able to enter into this. Why is that? None of the ordinary people have straight view at all. They have only a straight view that follows their own minds. Even if they obtain gentle, conforming patience, they are not able to see as things truly are.

"Śāriputra, that is called the difference between straight view and crooked view. Because one sees as things truly are, it is called straight view. The view

that arises incidentally, as worldly happiness, wealth and profit arise and increase, is worldly straight view. All of that is contemptible deception, and it does not free one from birth and death.

"Śāriputra, in what the Buddha has taught, the straight view of the world is declared to be a dharma of laziness and slackness, base and feeble. The wise and skillful do not think in such a way as, 'This is straight view; that is crooked view.' Why is that? Everything whatsoever that is seen arises from illusory, untrue conditions.

"Śāriputra, if one thinks in this way and considers, 'This is straight view,' that person has crooked view. Śāriputra, within the Dharma of the wise, the root source of all views is pulled out and severed, and the path of all spoken words is cut off. It is like a hand in the midst of space, which touches nothing and is obstructed by nothing. The Dharma of the śramaṇas is all of this kind."

This is the fourth chapter, the chapter on contemplating the Saṅgha.

Śāriputra asked the Buddha, "Blessed One, what is it that is called the holy Saṅgha?"

"Śāriputra, suppose some person is able to trust, to know and to fully understand that all phenomena whatsoever have no arising, no cessation, no rising up and no characteristic. Having accomplished such forbearance, he does not obtain even me. What need is there, then, to speak of attaining stream-entry, once-returning or non-returning? What need to speak of arhatship? What need to say that he does not obtain the Dharma? What need to say that he does not obtain the basis? What need to say that he does not obtain the path? What need to say that he does not obtain any such aims as these? That is called the holy Saṅgha, and it too obtains nothing.

"Moreover, Śāriputra, few sentient beings trust and know the Dharma of non-arising, non-cessation and signlessness. If some are able to trust the Dharma that has no arising, no cessation and no sign, there is no distortion in their minds. Knowing one another, they practice the Dharma, and through their accomplished aspiration they will not afterward experience existence. Because they know that the whole world arises solely from illusory, unreal conditions, from then on those people do not abide in the present body. For these causes and conditions they may rightly be called the holy Saṅgha. In the words such a person speaks there is nothing to be obtained. Though one may recall what is assembled from names and signs, there is no meaning to signs or to recollection. This is called the Saṅgha Jewel, worthy to receive offerings;

it has attained the undistorted principle of genuine truth. When that person, practicing such a means, contemplates the Saṅgha, that meaning too is empty. Śāriputra, one who teaches in this way is called a spiritual friend.

"Śāriputra, when the path of all spoken words is cut off, that is called the holy Saṅgha. Why is that? Because within the holy Dharma, even if the principle of virtuous truth is explained by means of spoken words, such spoken words cannot be obtained. Therefore it is evident that the cutting off of spoken words is what is called the holy Saṅgha.

"Śāriputra, suppose some person were to say, 'In this Dharma there is no explanation by words. If there is nothing definite, how can it be named the Saṅgha?' Śāriputra, in this teaching of mine there is this reply: if the name 'Saṅgha' is said to show its meaning according to truth, that meaning too cannot be definitely obtained. That the community of learners together have a single forbearance and a single taste, that meaning too is conveyed by explaining in the ordinary words of the world; it is not the supreme principle. In the supreme principle there is definitely no truth to the names 'Saṅgha,' 'self,' 'Dharma,' 'permanent,' or what is called 'imperishable.'

"If a holy person has said, 'This phenomenon exists,' that is for a purpose. If you ask why: one examines such a person in this way: 'Is it a man? Is it a woman? Is it a god? Is it a nāga? Is it a yakṣa? Is it a gandharva? Is it a kumbhāṇḍa? Is it Dharma? Is it not Dharma?' Having made such examinations, one obtains many kinds of meaning, and because one obtains many kinds of meaning, one speaks such words as these. People say, 'He is sitting, he is lying down, he has gone, he is staying.'

"The holy person, because he has obtained the true characteristic of all phenomena, does not conceptualize. He does not conceptualize 'it is a man,' 'it is a woman,' 'it is a god,' 'it is a nāga,' and so on up to 'it is Dharma' and 'it is not Dharma.' Because he does not conceptualize, he does not obtain any phenomena at all. Since he does not obtain any phenomena, is he able to say, 'He is sitting, he is lying down, he is going, he is staying,' or is he not able?"

"Blessed One, he is not able."

"Śāriputra, if some person says, 'It is a man, it is a woman, it is a god, it is a nāga,' and so on up to 'it is Dharma' and 'it is not Dharma,' is everything that person says illusory and unreal?"

"Blessed One, it is illusory and unreal."

"Śāriputra, what is not included within that illusory unreality is called the holy Saṅgha. Being free of distortion is what is called the holy Saṅgha.

"Śāriputra, whatever is non-virtuous, whatever can be known, and all such non-virtuous phenomena are given their basis by the use of names and signs. In this wise and holy Dharma, names and signs are cut off. One does not even think of names and signs. If someone says, 'If names and signs are obtained, how is it the holy Saṅgha?', then when names and signs are entirely cut off, that is called the holy Saṅgha. If there were a locus of phenomena, it could be destroyed or it could be cut. In the holy Dharma there are no names, no signs and no spoken words; all spoken words are cut off, and there is neither gathering nor separating.

"If some say, 'There is no Saṅgha,' that destroys the holy Saṅgha, and that too is unacceptable. That is the consequence of perceiving names and signs, which are illusory and unreal. Those with crooked views become attached to many things. As the result of those crooked views they take on a later body, and because they are attached to what they see, the five aggregates arise. Śāriputra, the five aggregates are entirely attachment to what is illusory and unreal. That is called the evil path; that is called the crooked path. In the wise and holy Saṅgha there is nothing of the kind. They know that the three realms arise solely from illusory, unreal conditions. Because they know such a meaning, they are called the holy Saṅgha.

"Śāriputra, there are crooked views.

Such ways are not to be found at all within the noble Saṅgha: seeing in terms of a self, in terms of a sentient being, in terms of a life, in terms of a person; seeing a man, seeing a woman, seeing a god, seeing a hell being, seeing an animal, seeing a hungry ghost; seeing aggregates, perceptions and elements. It is seeing the sound of a conch, seeing the sound of a drum; seeing the word "earth," and the words "water," "fire" and "wind"; seeing the words "upholding moral discipline," seeing the words "broken discipline"; seeing the words "the straight path," seeing the words "the crooked path"; seeing the word "defilement," seeing the word "purity"; and the words "mastery of meditative concentration," "meditative absorption," and "the eightfold noble path." It is seeing the words "the fruit of stream-entry," "the fruit of once-returning," "the fruit of non-returning," and "the fruit of arhatship"; seeing the word "liberation," seeing the words "attaining the fruit," seeing the word "Buddha," seeing the word "Dharma," seeing the word "Saṅgha," seeing the word

"cessation," and seeing the word "nirvāṇa."

Śāriputra, this is called seeing untrue words, speech and the like. The wise and noble Saṅgha does not come to such seeing in the supreme teaching. It understands every kind of word and speech as having a single characteristic, so that there are no conflicting characteristics and no dispute. Because it has accomplished patient acceptance of the unerring Dharma, it is called the noble Saṅgha.

Śāriputra, that patient acceptance of the unerring Dharma is signless. Because it is signless, there is nothing to take up and nothing to discard, nothing inverted and nothing uninverted, no arising and no cessation. Within it there is no practice inclined toward an intrinsic nature, no destruction, no rising and no attainment. Because it does not even conceive of "this" and "that," the mind is always in a state of relinquishment. Why is this? Within such patient acceptance there is no far shore and no near shore; there is no conceptual thought, nor is there any absence of conceptual thought. Because it has understood and accomplished signlessness, it is called the noble Saṅgha. Because it has broken apart what is assembled, it is called the noble Saṅgha.

Śāriputra, when the writings of my Dharma are explained to others, if some person grasps at seeing the Dharma, that is a view of self. The Tathāgata is not a dharma, nor is he not a dharma. Why is this? Foolish Devadatta and all the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) engage with the body of color and say, "We see the Buddha." Śāriputra, it is not right to see the Tathāgata by engaging with the body of color. Nor is it right to see him by engaging with sound and speech. Śāriputra, if someone sees the Buddha by engaging with the body of color, he is far from the Buddha. If one asks why, it is because the Buddha is not named by the seeing of color; and that is what is called seeing the Buddha.

Śāriputra, suppose some person can trust and see that all dharmas are without signs, without names, without contact, without mindfulness, without mind, without arising and without cessation, without elaboration; that he does not think of all dharmas, does not think of nirvāṇa, does not form the thought of passing into nirvāṇa, and is not attached to nirvāṇa; and that all dharmas are of a single characteristic. That is characteristiclessness. Śāriputra, this is called truly seeing the Buddha. If, with regard to all dharmas, there is no seeking and no elaboration, and with no arising one does not think even of that meaning and does not conceptualize, this is called seeing the Buddha.

Suppose some person, with regard to this Dharma, has no examination by means of the perceptions of mindfulness, no taking up, no discarding, no conflict, no perception, no action through perception. He explains in words, yet is not attached to the explanation. He knows that it is not the name or image of the Dharma, and that there is nothing whatsoever. The path of spoken words is cut off and there is no differentiation; there is no expressing of elaboration and no knowing. He is called "without arising, without the activity of perception," and in the world he is called the noble Saṅgha.

Śāriputra, what dharma, when seen, is called seeing the Buddha? It is without perception, without conceptual thought, without the expressing of elaboration: it is not taking up any dharma at all. One who practices the gate of emptiness, and the gate that is free even of the gate of peaceful emptiness, does not think of seeing. He does not obtain seeing, nor does he obtain its meaning; that is beyond the one who names. Nor does he obtain its abode; that is nirvāṇa. Why is this? Śāriputra, since even I do not think of nirvāṇa, how would I tell you and the others, "Think of nirvāṇa!" and teach the attainment of nirvāṇa?

Śāriputra, if some person thinks, "I have attained nirvāṇa," that person has not gone forth from home following the Tathāgata; he has gone forth from home following the six teachers. Śāriputra, know this! He is an enemy of the Dharma who has entered my Dharma. It is evident that such a person has not cultivated my Dharma. It is evident that such a person is a great enemy, like a great enemy present within a city and a great country. How so? If such a deluded person holds that nirvāṇa is attained, what need is there even to mention the view of self, the view of a person, and the grasping at attainment? Śāriputra, such a deluded man I push away with my hand: he is not my disciple, he is not counted among the Saṅgha, and I am not his preceptor.

Śāriputra, if someone knows all dharmas to be without arising, without cessation, without thinking, and without perception, and by obtaining such patient acceptance of the Dharma does not obtain nirvāṇa, what need is there even to mention that he does not obtain a view of self or a person? Śāriputra, in what the Buddha has taught, such a one is called one who sees the Dharma; because he is able to see that meaning, he is called one who sees the Buddha.

Śāriputra, what kind of one is called a buddha? If there is a person who is unmoving and undifferentiated with regard to all dharmas, he is called the Tathāgata. If some person has no doubt and no regret concerning such a

Dharma, he is called the noble Saṅgha.

Śāriputra, long ago, in a former life, there was a deluded man who did not know what monkeys really were. He went into a great grove and saw a troop of monkeys gathered together in one spot. That man had once heard that there are gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, so he blurted out, "These are the gods of the Thirty-Three!" He came straight out of the grove, went back among the many householders of his old village, and spoke these words: "Have you all ever seen the gods of the Thirty-Three, or not?" The ordinary people answered, "We have never seen them." At once he said, "Now that I have seen them, do you want to see them, or not?" They all said, "We want to see them." So he immediately led the crowd into that grove, showed them the monkeys, and said, "All of you, look at these gods! These are the gods of the Thirty-Three!" Then all the ordinary people said, "These are not the gods of the Thirty-Three. These are monkeys, who like to live in groves. You are so deluded and mistaken that you not only fail to recognize monkeys, you do not know the gods of the Thirty-Three either." Śāriputra, that man went into that grove with the crowd to no purpose.

In just the same way, Śāriputra, in the future there will be a monk who goes to the homes of the white-clad laypeople and says these words: "Do you want to see the Buddha and the miraculous Saṅgha and to hear the Buddha's Dharma, or not?" Among those white-clad people, all who have faith in the Buddha's Dharma will say, "We want to see them. We will listen to the Buddha's Dharma and take it to heart." Śāriputra, among them are white-clad people who are attached to the words that are spoken and crave them. When they go into stūpas and monasteries, there are monks there who explain things in words and are skilled in letters. These monks rely on spoken words and also crave written letters and drawings. Such a monk explains things to others in the same way, and the others, thinking, "This is the pure path," enter the ranks of the Saṅgha.

Such people are like cowherds. They merely crave reading the letters of the Dharma, but they do not enter the true realm. They merely prize pleasing people and a fine reputation. To teach the Dharma with clever craft for worldly ends is impure. Being skilled in crafted words, they merely practice the worldly path and have none of the splendor of goodness. Having destroyed the cause of nirvāṇa, they abandon that cause. They have no faith in silent meditative concentration. Day and night they constantly talk and chatter, quarrel and dispute, grow lax, and crave sleeping on thick cushions. If they do not have

even for an instant a mind that resembles meditative concentration, what need is there to say that they cannot attain the accomplished fruit of the śramaṇa? Even when such a person falls asleep, he is always in tune with the ordinary mind. In the evening and at dawn he does not practice the patience that is free of conflict, but craves base things. Yet even such a person receives many robes as offerings and much food. Why is that? Because that person, deceived all around by the evil Māra, craves words that are close at hand and not profound, and he cannot train so as to succeed in the supreme and holy scripture. He cannot hold the letters of the supreme and profound Dharma in memory through recitation. When he hears it he is terrified, casts away its white essence, and turns a deaf ear. When he sees other ordinary people gaining profit for their livelihood, thoughts of desire arise, and he thinks to himself, "It is fitting for us too to learn to speak such words."

Śāriputra, such a person has cast away the unsurpassed jewel of the Dharma, has fallen into crooked views, and stays there. He is an enemy of the śramaṇas. He goes to white-clad people who are well off, and such wicked people teach them the Dharma for the profit of their livelihood. They praise the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha in sweet words solely in order to seek the wealth that sustains life, and servants and slaves. Wanting clothing and food and holding them dear, they give praise according to their own cravings and say, "By practicing giving you will be reborn in the heavens." Within the Buddha's Dharma, giving is a teaching of the lower stages, yet they praise it, and ordinary people call it the supreme inner teaching. In saying, "Through the cause and condition of great giving one is reborn in the heavens," they do not understand the words and syllables. Not knowing the direction of the scripture, they know only teachings for beginners that are close at hand, shallow and ordinary. Therefore they hold the view of self and are attached to the notion of a person, and they cast away the supreme scripture.

Śāriputra, through the teaching of such a Dharma, now and then some people gain faith, go forth from home, gather together with those wicked people, and cannot diligently seek the supreme and profound scripture. They teach that there is attainment, they hold the view of self, and they teach that there is a person, a life span and a life force. With mindfulness and perception they conceptualize dharmas that are nothing at all. They explain the section of marvels and the section of sūtras in their own way. At times they teach permanence and annihilation; at times they teach that there is no action.

Śāriputra, at that time there will be many teachings of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) within my Dharma, and they will destroy the minds of beings that see straight. Thus, Śāriputra, through such causes and conditions my pure Dharma will gradually wane and be exhausted. Śāriputra, I dwelt for a long time in birth and death, afflicted by sufferings, before I accomplished awakening; yet when it is taken up by those who hold to a person, at that time it will dwindle and be destroyed.

Śāriputra, if some monk who sees attainment, who sees with the view of self, and who sees a person cannot give these up, he does not know how to teach in accordance with the way the Tathāgata practiced. If he says that there truly is a view of self, a person, and dharmas, such a man should not be allowed to take even a single sip of water. If that man hears the teaching of emptiness, has faith in it, his mind becomes pure, and he is neither frightened nor doubtful, then that ordinary person should at once be guided back, and it is fitting that he enter the scripture of the true characteristic. He should again go forth from home and receive moral discipline with the complete rite. Why is that? Śāriputra, if some person has not given up such views, he is called a tīrthika. Śāriputra, when I make use of the ordinary causes and conditions of the world and speak of an illusory "I" as existing, that is not the supreme scripture.

Again, suppose some person says, "I too, employing the ordinary causes and conditions of the world, teach that there is a self." That person has not been able to realize the Dharma of non-arising, non-cessation, and signlessness. And since he contradicts all that has been taught, he is not my disciple.

Śāriputra, suppose some person says: "Why does the Tathāgata, in keeping with worldly causes and conditions, teach that nonexistent dharmas are without defilement? It is not fitting for the Tathāgata to teach in untrue words for the sake of the world. Besides, in other Dharma texts too there are many teachings that a person exists. What the Buddha taught cannot be false." Śāriputra, the reply to such a one is this: all the dharmas of the Buddha are empty. There is no owner, and there is no intrinsic nature. The ordinary is illusory and untrue; it is not the ultimate principle. The Tathāgata teaches that ultimate principle. He has not taught the view of self, nor that a person exists. A holy person has no desire for or attachment to spoken words. A person without wisdom is neither the equal of the Buddha nor his superior.

Śāriputra, the wisdom of the Tathāgata is inconceivable. By exercising that wisdom, mind knows mind. So if some person claims to be equal to the Buddha, it is not right for him to contradict the supreme Buddha, the great nāga, the great king of Dharma, by saying, "The Buddha taught that a person exists." The whole world always disputes with me; I never dispute with the world.

Śāriputra, if one teaches that a self exists, that is greatly to be pitied. Within this there is no dharma and there is no self, yet many beings do not understand what the Tathāgata has taught in accordance with conceptual elaboration. Turning against the Jewel of the Dharma, many fall into the bad paths.

Śāriputra, what I know as crooked seeing is called crooked seeing. To know crooked seeing as crooked seeing is straight seeing. Śāriputra, if crooked seeing should in the end become straight seeing, one does not understand seeing.

Śāriputra, the unsurpassed, immutable, perfect awakening of the tathāgatas, the buddhas, is hard for the whole world to believe. Among the gods and the whole world, I am one to be trusted; I am not one to be distrusted.

Śāriputra, all the Dharma I teach is for the sake of reaching the far shore, yet within it there is no reaching of the far shore. All the Dharma I teach is for the sake of the exhaustion of activities, yet within it there is no exhaustion of activities. All the Dharma I teach is for the sake of emptiness and peace, yet within it there is no emptiness and peace. All the Dharma I teach is for the sake of bringing beings across to extinction, yet within it there is no bringing across to extinction. All the Dharma I teach is for the sake of freedom and liberation, yet within it there is no freedom and liberation. All the Dharma I teach is for the sake of the wise, yet within it there are no wise ones. All the Dharma I teach is for the sake of purifying stains, yet within it there is no purifying of stains.

Śāriputra, when the Tathāgata teaches the Dharma for the sake of gods, there are no gods. When he teaches the Dharma for the sake of humans, there are no humans. When he teaches the Dharma for the sake of sentient beings, there are no sentient beings. Śāriputra, when the Tathāgata teaches knowledge and liberation, within it there is no knowledge and liberation. I teach recollection of the Buddha, yet the Buddha cannot be thought of. I teach the practice of emptiness, yet emptiness cannot be taught, nor can it be

thought of.

Śāriputra, this is what is called "in the chapters and words of all the Dharma texts taught by the Tathāgata, nothing is taught." Yet evil people, having obtained these chapters and words, teach them to others and set themselves up as their preceptors. They say that the Tathāgata and the holy Saṅgha have no good meaning either, and they count themselves among the Saṅgha.

Śāriputra, a gathered troop of monkeys, for example, is not like the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. Just so, such vile, common people are not like the holy Saṅgha. Śāriputra, such evil people say, merely by means of sounds and spoken words, "I am a renunciant." It is just like a deluded person who sees a troop of monkeys and says, "They are the gods of the Thirty-Three."

Śāriputra, among them there may be a person gone forth from home who searches critically and has keen longing. He meets a learned preceptor who, for him, stills name and form into emptiness, and teaches him the Dharma in which, though the path of spoken words is explained, there is nothing to reject and no emptiness either; and he realizes signlessness. If, on hearing such a Dharma of non-arising, non-cessation, and signlessness, he is not alarmed and not afraid, it is evident that such a person has already made offerings to countless buddhas. Because he is able to understand my Dharma, he is called the holy Saṅgha.

This is the chapter of the Buddha's Treasury, the chapter on Purity.

The Dharma Text of the Buddha's Treasury, second fascicle. The fifth chapter of the Text of the Buddha's Treasury, the chapter on Pure Moral Discipline.

The Buddha said to Śāriputra: "A monk who has broken his moral discipline has ten arrows of grief and turmoil, which are hard to bear and endure. If a monk is fully possessed of these ten arrows of grief and turmoil, he does not obtain the delicious taste of the Buddha's Dharma. He resents the teaching of the Dharma and has no longing to draw near to it.

"If one asks what the ten are: Śāriputra, when a monk of broken discipline sees the Saṅgha in harmony, no joy arises in his mind. Why is that? He thinks, 'If they assemble and hold the poṣadha, I will be driven out and expelled.' Indeed, that bad monk, knowing that he has faults, constantly nurses grief and turmoil, and he resents those who uphold moral discipline and takes no delight in them. Śāriputra, this is called the first arrow of grief and turmoil of the troubled monk, and he truly falls into the bad paths.

"Again, Śāriputra, a monk of broken discipline is resented and unwanted by nearly everyone, so no one likes to be near him. He is like a vicious ox given to butting with sharp horns, which all people abandon and keep at a distance. That bad monk, knowing that he has faults, constantly nurses suspicion, grief, and turmoil."

Śāriputra, this is called the second arrow of grief and torment of the monk of broken discipline, and he truly falls into the evil path.

Again, Śāriputra, when a monk of broken discipline meets the community, he knows for himself that his evil mind is out of harmony with them and that he has been cast out. Ashamed and full of vexation, he does not dare to go among the community. Śāriputra, this is called the third arrow of grief and torment of the monk of broken discipline, and he truly falls into the evil path.

Again, Śāriputra, because the mind of grief and torment grows strong in the monk of broken discipline, he is unfit for the treatises. If he does not have even the rules of conduct that the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) keep, what need is there to say that he lacks pure moral discipline? Because he engages in such causes and conditions of broken discipline, people do not come near him or keep company with him. Śāriputra, this is called the fourth arrow of grief and torment of the monk of broken discipline, and he truly falls into the evil path.

Again, Śāriputra, if a monk of broken discipline uses the wealth and goods of others to nourish his own body, this has no place in what I have taught; he is said to be carrying a heavy burden. Why is that? It is one who both practices and has attained who is said to know how to receive offerings. The monk of broken discipline neither practices nor has attained. Therefore, Śāriputra, for a hundred, a thousand, ten thousand, a hundred thousand countless eons, the monk of broken discipline will cut and chop the flesh of his own body to repay his donors. And even when he is born in the body of an animal, he will always carry heavy loads. How so? If a monk of broken discipline cannot digest even an offering as small as one part in a thousand hundred-thousand parts of a three-thousandth of a single drop of water on a single strand of hair, what need is there to say that he cannot digest the clothing, food, bedding and medicine of others?

Śāriputra, even if a monk of broken discipline wears the wondrous Dharma robe, it is not fitting for him to take even a single step inside the monastery. What need is there to say that he has no right to a single sip of water, or to sit on a seat or anything else? Why is that? Śāriputra, such an evil man is called a

great enemy even among the gods, and he is fit to be shunned and cast away by the whole world. A person so degenerate is the enemy of all. Even if the Tathāgata were to allow the whole world to come before me, the man of broken discipline the Tathāgata would hold back with his hand. What need is there to say that, as my disciple, he should not enter my Dharma for even a single day?

Śāriputra, consider a dead man, a dead snake and a dead dog rotting together in one place. When the gods of the Pure Abodes are playing and laughing, they cannot bear to see them, and even if they have seen them, they keep far away. Just so, Śāriputra, the monk of broken discipline is like those three rotting corpses. Because he is impure, the wise shun him and keep far away, and they do not perform the poṣadha or the pravāraṇā together with him.

Śāriputra, it is not that the monk of broken discipline goes unrecognized within my Dharma: when a monk who keeps moral discipline sees such a breaker of discipline, he at once shuns him and keeps far away. Why is that? Whatever goods the monk of broken discipline touches with his hand and takes become a vile poison to the one who keeps moral discipline. Śāriputra, the keeper of discipline could bear to practice according to my rites in a place filled with those three rotting corpses, but he could not bear to stay even an instant together with this monk of broken discipline.

Why is that? Śāriputra, he is the very worst of the bad among śramaṇas. Among śramaṇas he is the rotten one, the very worst. Among śramaṇas he is empty chaff. Among śramaṇas he is a stain. Among śramaṇas he is turbidity. Among śramaṇas he is filth. Among śramaṇas he is saṃsāra. Among śramaṇas he is a stagnant pool. Among śramaṇas he is one who has lost the wondrous path. When people such as these leave home and seek the path within my Dharma, they incur heavy evil.

Śāriputra, such a person is called a perverse enemy within my Dharma. He is called an enemy of the Dharma. He is called a person who deceives with contempt and practices guile and deceit. To keep himself alive he thirsts greedily for clothing and food, and so he is also called one who craves the world's servants and attendants.

Śāriputra, he is like a eunuch, who is neither a man nor a woman. The monk of broken discipline is the same, and so he is not called one who lives in a household, nor is he called one gone forth from home. Once his life is spent, he goes straight to hell.

Śāriputra, he is like a bat. When birds would seize it, it goes into a hole like a mouse. When mice would seize it, it flies into the sky and acts as a bird. Yet in truth it does not live as a great bird; its body stinks, and it craves only the darkness where nothing can be seen. Śāriputra, the monk of broken discipline is the same. He is not admitted to the poṣadha or the pravāraṇā, nor is he admitted to the ranks of those the king puts to service. He is not called one who wears white, nor is he called one gone forth from home. He is like the wood left over from burning a corpse, which afterward cannot be used for anything at all.

Such a monk has no aggregate of moral discipline, no aggregate of concentration, no aggregate of wisdom, no aggregate of liberation, and no aggregate of the knowledge and vision of liberation. He has only the aggregate of broken pure discipline and corrupted conduct. He cannot utter the very profound sound of the holy, the sound of moral discipline, the sound of concentration, the sound of wisdom, the sound of liberation, or the sound of the knowledge and vision of liberation. He gives voice only to the evil sounds of broken discipline. Together with other evil companions he utters evil sounds, and speaks only of clothing, food, beds, receiving gifts, timber, flowers and fruit, and of making much of these. He sends people on errands, and he speaks of the good and bad within the body, of comfort and discomfort, of matters of play and frivolity, and other unwholesome words.

If a monk, constantly, day and night, is impure in his bodily action, impure in his verbal action and impure in his mental action, he falls into hell.

Śāriputra, that monk of degenerate mind, who speaks in a darkness where nothing can be seen, is like a bat. When he hears the straightforward Dharma text explained, he becomes troubled and sorrowful. Why is that? Because it is explained just as it truly is. Worldly people take no delight in hearing the truth told; they crave only what does not go against their own minds. Such a monk's mind is impure and closed toward the teaching of the Dharma. His sins grow ever heavier, and this serves only to bring about rebirth in hell. Śāriputra, such a monk of broken moral discipline is called "the five arrows of troubled sorrow," and he truly falls into hell.

Again, Śāriputra, the monk of broken moral discipline has neither shame nor embarrassment. Stirred up by his senses, he carries out impure actions of body, speech and mind, and impure rites. Though he wears the robes, all that he does is out of accord with the Dharma. He delights in false words and

craves them. He cannot guard his mouth, and since his mind is always agitated, he clings to stains and defilement.

Śāriputra, it is like this. Suppose one were to fill a new clay pot with excrement and filth and with stinking, rotten pus and blood, then throw the filth out and fill it with incense and sandalwood. If afterward one were to throw out the incense and sandalwood as well, would such a clay pot give off a fragrance?

"Blessed One (the Buddha), if such a new clay pot is filled with stinking excrement and it sets hard, there will be only the stench, and no scent of sandalwood."

Śāriputra, a person may exercise the pure faculties, such as faith, and go forth from the household; but if, not having trained in the Dharma, he meets a bad spiritual friend, he follows whatever that friend teaches.

Śāriputra, who is called a bad spiritual friend? A bad spiritual friend is always craving games and frivolity. He is giddy and shameless, agitated in his speech, and does not restrain his senses. His mind does not settle into one-pointedness, and he is as deluded as a sheep. If one associates with such a bad spiritual friend, one loses even the fruit of stream-entry, the fruit of the once-returner, the fruit of the non-returner, the fruit of the arhat, and everything down to rebirth among the gods. What need is there even to mention the path to nirvāṇa? Such a one is skilled only in carrying out sinful deeds that destroy the Dharma, and he keeps company and dwells with those who destroy the Dharma.

Because that person has carried out impure bodily action, impure verbal action, impure mental action, and impurity in holding moral discipline, when his body dies he enters the bad paths. If one asks what the bad paths are, they are named the paths of the hell beings, the hungry ghosts, the animals and the asuras. There are also further bad paths: the asuliṅga worm, the bakla boka worm, the jintseu jaka worm and the jigokka worm. That person is born many times among those worms.

Śāriputra, because that person follows a bad spiritual friend, even when he is born among humans he is parted from his father and mother while they still live, and they die and perish. He brings harm to his household and relatives, and his homeland falls to ruin. He comes to be born in the eight unfavorable states. He wishes to cast away the eight favorable conditions. He has many desires, is angry and foolish, and always craves games and frivolity. Inwardly he is giddy and has no shame. He speaks rashly and cannot collect his mind.

Deluded as a sheep, through attachment, aversion and delusion he becomes deaf, mute, blind, and crippled in hands and feet, and through that bad spiritual friend he is born where there is no buddha.

Even if he happens to meet with the time of a buddha, he does not wish to see the Buddha himself, does not wish to hear the Dharma, and does not stay together with the Buddha and the Saṅgha. Such a bad one consorts with bad people everywhere, and a craving for the lowest and worst of people arises in him. Toward what is seen as straight, the perception of it as crooked arises; toward what is seen as crooked, the perception of it as straight arises. He is called "one of base desire."

Śāriputra, one of the lowest wisdom cannot, in the end, bring his mind, which has no weariness of worldly existence, to such weariness, so as to turn toward cessation, the path and nirvāṇa.

Śāriputra, a person who has met a bad spiritual friend and has contracted such diseases of ruin and sorrow, a person who bears such signs, is terrified, suspicious, afraid and alarmed when he hears this profound Dharma text, as if he were falling into a deep pit. And so he falls into the deep pit of great sin. Why is that? Śāriputra, it is because it is taught in this Dharma text that the monk of broken moral discipline carries very great and heavy sin.

For what reason is he called one of broken moral discipline? He breaks all the precepts he has taken, and in whatever is done as commanded in the teaching set out in words, he makes no examination. He calculates much and turns back much. In secret he engages in the conduct of desire with much pretense. Because he practices attachment, aversion and delusion and craves the pretense of other words, he is called one of broken moral discipline.

Further, he craves many desires for his livelihood, craves recitation by mere lip service, and craves deep sleep. All that he says is contradictory and without order. He teaches impurely, and because he holds the view of a self and is attached to a person and to life, he is called a bad monk.

He knows neither proper speech nor moderation; he does not know the conduct of a renunciant (śramaṇa), nor does he know the conduct of a brahmin. He craves practicing medical diagnosis, trading, and seeking profit. He craves acting as an envoy for the country and getting others to cling to him with attachment. He craves running errands for the livelihood of the white-clad laypeople, and doing conjuring tricks with the leaves of trees, with flowers, and with pebbles. He craves teaching the doctrines of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas)

to the white-clad laypeople, and in his mind he has always cast aside the Dharma of going forth from the world.

Having received the full precepts before reaching twenty years of age, there are among those who have received the precepts some who are weak and deficient: impaired in body, impaired in appearance, incomplete in their faculties, unsuitable, and not in accord with the Dharma. He accepts raw millet and rice, coins, silk, gold and silver. He does not act in accordance with the treatises. He talks back to the words of his preceptor and turns them aside. He knows neither himself nor others. He is unable to keep the order of senior and junior. He delights in and craves false speech.

In taking the precepts, he is thrown into turmoil by every matter of indulging desire, and his mind is not gathered into one. His face bears an angry look; he is stingy, greedy and faithless, and does not know how to reflect according to the scriptures. He fosters much greed and longing, sleeps a great deal, and craves games and frivolity. He is full of doubt and regret, abuse and resentment. Hiding and covering up his evil deeds, he craves self-importance. His envy and flattery are great. He has no shame and no gratitude, his self-regard is great, and he indulges in the laziness of arrogance, the laziness of "I," great laziness, and crooked laziness. He craves contempt and deceit. He praises himself, saying "I am good." Using many devices, he opens doors of profit for his livelihood. He despises and insults the white-clad laypeople. If he makes friends with deceitful people, then by associating with them he incidentally obtains wealth, and he shows off before ordinary people. For him the stages of moral discipline, of concentration, of wisdom, of liberation, and of the knowledge and vision of liberation have declined and been destroyed. His mind has no firm thought toward the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha. He has no faith in the retribution of karma: he prizes immediate profit and says, "There is no later time." He has many kinds of doubt and regret, and because the nature of his mind is thin and weak, he is always prone to fright and fear.

Śāriputra, his name is "evil monk." Such a deluded person is, within my Dharma, filth and mud, stinking and impure. That person accomplishes evil actions of body, speech and mind in abundance, and because he is impure and unclean, after his life is spent he falls into the evil destinies and goes to the great hell. Such a monk is always kept at a distance and shunned by the Tathāgatas, the buddhas, and by their disciples. Others too, who long for the path of the Dharma and who experience peace and nirvāṇa, none of them associate with him.

Śāriputra, it is like sandalwood incense placed in a clean vessel together with filth: afterward it is fit for no use at all. Now, Śāriputra, if some householder or one who has gone forth from home associates with that person and learns and trains in whatever he does, before long he too joins the ranks of those of broken discipline and carries on their evil. The radiance of his complexion fades, he straightway ruins and loses the Dharma, and after his life is spent he is born among the beings of hell.

Śāriputra, such an evil person is kept at a distance and shunned by all the Tathāgatas, the buddhas, by their disciples, by others who seek the Dharma, and by all who long for peaceful liberation. Śāriputra, it is like sandalwood incense poured into an impure vessel: afterward it is fit for no use at all. Thus, Śāriputra, whether one dwells in a household or has gone forth from home, though one anoint the body with it, it is still mixed with filth.

Śāriputra, the evil monk is just like that. Though he dwells among the general Saṅgha and wears the wondrous robes of the Dharma, the form of an evil monk is still evident. When monks who practice pure conduct see this impurity, they keep their distance and do not associate with him. Seeing that he is kept at a distance and shunned by others, he harbors abuse and resentment in his mind, and through that cause and condition, when he dies he goes to hell. Śāriputra, such a person, a monk of broken discipline, is called "the six arrows of grief and turmoil," and he truly falls among the beings of hell.

This is the latter part of the chapter on pure moral discipline.

Again, Śāriputra, when a monk of broken discipline hears such Dharma texts, all that the Buddha has taught, his mind is impure and unclean. He is displeased, faithless and without devotion. Because he knows that he is at fault, he has no faith in this Dharma text and thinks, "This was spoken about people like me, not about others. Why? Because people like me have long been in just that condition."

Śāriputra, the monk of broken discipline reviles such holy, supreme and incomparable Dharma. When there is much true disbelief toward the teaching of the Dharma, then, having heard all that the Buddha taught, he opposes it and will not accept it, and says, "These are not the true words. This the Buddha spoke, but it is not a word to be taught to other people." Why? Because for a monk of broken discipline, practicing the path is impossible, while a monk who practices the path does not oppose the words of the

Buddha. All of these are of broken discipline, foolish and dull, doers of evil things, with faithless minds. Such monks, who oppose the words of the Buddha, know for themselves that they are at fault, and so there arise in them abuse and resentment, arrogance and laziness, ferocity and self-importance, crooked evil, and laziness, and they mock and disparage the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha.

Śāriputra, when that monk hears all those Dharma texts, he opposes them and has no faith in them, and because his mind has not realized unsurpassed awakening, he declares to other people, "This is not what the Buddha taught." Śāriputra, such a person is called a disparager of the Dharma with regard to what the Buddha taught. He is not a renunciant, he is not a son of the Śākya clan; he is of the lineage of those who set out to establish nonexistence.

Monks such as these, even if hundreds, thousands, tens of thousands and hundreds of thousands of buddhas were to turn the teaching three times and set it forth plainly, would be unable to understand it or to attain the fruit of the path. Why? Śāriputra, such an evil person is called one who has obscured his own path in this Dharma. He has no fortune for a good birth and no mind of faith; he craves only clothing and food and covets worldly profit. Therefore I, the Tathāgata, have declared that this person falls among the beings of hell.

"Śāriputra, I now declare this to you plainly and in detail. If some people are perverse toward such a Jewel of the Dharma and oppose it, they will never have the fortune to be born in a good state. They are born only in bad states, and they are always blind, without eyes.

"Śāriputra, those monks are arrogant, and their laziness grows. They multiply, and since they cannot teach with certainty, they destroy my upright Dharma. Other ordinary people cannot harm it, but these destroy my Dharma for the sake of livelihood and profit.

"Śāriputra, at that time such a Jewel of the Dharma will be destroyed until nothing is left. Why is that? Such a Jewel of the Dharma is revered by all the buddhas. What pratyekabuddhas, arhats and all the rest must revere is not taught with certainty by monks of broken discipline in whom laziness grows. At that time the other monks and the rest all despise my Dharma and grow lazy. They all keep it at a distance and abandon it. They crave greatly, in stinginess and greed, think single-mindedly of the business of making a living, and cling hard to wealth, profit and price. Bound by jealousy, they always delight in quarrels and disputes, grudges arise among them in turn, and they show no

respect to one another. They are never satisfied. The nature of their minds is as restless as a monkey's. Altering and fabricating the rites, they engage in bad deeds. They draw back from the dharma of a monk and keep far from the wise and the skillful.

"Śāriputra, such evil people hide and conceal such faults. With many desires and much seeking they enjoy wealth and nourish themselves. The evil Māra, knowing their minds, uses stratagems to set them at odds, splits them apart and divides the Jewel of the Saṅgha, which is of one taste, into five groups. Because there are five groups, quarrels and disputes arise, and they speak of one another's right and wrong, faults and errors.

"Śāriputra, the monks of the present teach and train one another, respect one another, and act in harmony with one mind. They do not contravene what the Buddha has taught. The monks of that time, however, do not teach or train one another and do not respect one another. When they see someone doing evil, they fear him, let it pass and treat it as Dharma. They cannot teach and train one another. Some of them, though they have great learning and profound wisdom, are nonetheless arrogant and fond of laziness. Despising and disparaging others, each goes his own way and sets up his own assertions. If they do not even like to see one another, what need is there to say that they cannot receive the teaching?

"Śāriputra, while the Tathāgata dwells in the world, the Three Jewels are of one taste. After I have passed away and am gone, they will be divided into five groups.

"Śāriputra, even now the evil Māra, hiding his body, incites Devadatta and destroys my Dharma and my Saṅgha. But because the Tathāgata of great wisdom is now still dwelling in the world, the great evil Māra cannot succeed. In the future, the evil Māra will transform his body, take the form of a śramaṇa, enter the Saṅgha and teach many kinds of crookedness. Having led many beings to take up crooked views, he will teach them a crooked dharma, saying, 'In meaning it is equal to the Byileu Palgapa.' And he will say, 'While one contemplates the meaning of the five consciousnesses, there is the meaning of peace; the meaning of all things also exists; there is the attainment of the meaning of existence. This is the meaning of everything that is.' At that time the evil Māra will teach such crooked meanings of attachment and the like. Such meanings were not taught by the buddhas or by the buddhas' disciples. At that time evil people, corrupted by Māra, will each cling to whatever they

themselves see, saying, 'This is mine,' and 'They are not the Father's sons.'

"Śāriputra, because the Tathāgata foresaw that in the future there would be such things that destroy the Dharma, he deliberately taught this profound Dharma, cutting off every point by which the evil Māra breeds attachment.

"Śāriputra, at that time there will also be many people in Jambudvīpa in whom laziness grows. Having done only a little good, they will suddenly say, 'I have attained the path of Dharma,' and when their lives are over they will fall into the lower paths. Why is that? These very people claim the name for themselves, saying, 'I have attained the path,' and they declare and proclaim that others say of them, 'He has attained the path.' They boldly accept the offerings made by deceived people. Such a person is called the great evil enemy of gods, humans and the whole world. When such a person, in his delusion, hears the teaching of the supreme truth explained, he is alarmed, doubtful, frightened and terrified, like one falling into a deep pit.

"Śāriputra, other monks have a craving for such things. Gathering together, they tear apart and destroy the unsurpassed awakening of the buddhas. At that time many lazy people will be attached to crookedness, and the evil Māra will corrupt and agitate the minds of householders and of those who have gone forth, making them attached to what is not Dharma. Because few give support to those who teach the upright Dharma, it will suddenly split apart and can never be reestablished.

"Śāriputra, at that time there will be many young monks in the world, and they will have sharp faculties. How so? Others who had gone forth, because they still had a remainder of evil disturbance, will be reborn among humans and then go forth once again. Those monks, delighting in and inclined toward investigating and inquiring, will follow up and seek the Buddha's teaching of the supreme truth of the Dharma.

"Śāriputra, the lazy ones, corrupted and agitated by Māra, seek only to sustain their lives. Though they are in truth ordinary people, they say, 'I am an arhat,' and they say to the young monks and others: 'If body, speech and mind are virtuous, that is the teaching of the supreme truth of the Buddha's Dharma. If one guards pure discipline well, recites and reads the texts of the Dharma, and diligently cultivates great learning, that is called the cause for being spoken of without contradiction. That is a pure mind and faith in the Buddha. Moreover, there is the teaching of the supreme truth, as examined within the mind. Moreover, if one contemplates nirvāṇa, the three kinds of suffering cease, and

one is able to become weary of and free from the five aggregates, the twelve sense fields and the eighteen elements. You and the others, in solitary places, should examine these phenomena of the aggregates, elements and sense fields, and then there is no conceptualization at all.

"If one examines one's own body, it is impure in many ways. If you and the others can examine it in that way, you will attain the fruit of stream-entry. Furthermore, if one deeply realizes that these phenomena, the five aggregates and the rest, are impermanent, suffering and empty, that there is no true 'I' and nothing solid in them, then one attains once-returning. If one turns and realizes this still more deeply, one attains non-returning and arhatship. That is the supreme true doctrine," they say.

Then a young monk among them questions them in turn: "In the Buddha's Dharma, is the fruit of arhatship simply called the supreme doctrine? We too know its meaning, and arhatship is not the supreme doctrine. Do these present five aggregates arise through recollection and thought, or do they arise through thought without recollection?"

The reply is: "The five aggregates arise through recollection and thought. Without recollection and thought they do not arise."

He asks again: "Are recollection and thought different from the five aggregates, or not different?"

The reply is: "They are the same as the five aggregates. Recollection and thought are likewise."

He asks again: "If they are the same as the five aggregates, and recollection and thought are likewise, then who is it that thinks the five aggregates?"

The reply is: "If there were no one who thinks the five aggregates, there would be no nirvāṇa either. In truth, there is no one who thinks the five aggregates. Therefore, by practicing the straight noble eightfold path, there is entry into nirvāṇa," they say.

Śāriputra, in the future there will be many monks who have attained acceptance such as this. Śāriputra, at that time there will be many gods in the assembly. Delighting to hear the supreme true doctrine of the Buddha's Dharma, when they hear the explanation given by that lazy and careless one, doubt and regret arise in their minds, and as though falling into a deep pit, they all say this: "Alas! The Dharma of the Buddha Śākyamuni will now quickly come to nothing!"

Śāriputra, because there is among them a monk accomplished in virtue, he says this to that monk: "Foolish man, grown old in vain, lazy and careless one! If the marks of the five, the marks of the five aggregates, the twelve sense bases and the eighteen elements really existed, then I would listen to those words." So he says, and displeased, he rises from his seat and leaves.

Śāriputra, at that time the gods, their minds greatly delighted and joyful, cry out to the four directions, saying: "There is still a wise disciple of the Buddha Śākyamuni!"

At that time other people too, because their roots of virtue are not few, are not pleased to hear that impure teaching, for it is a view of self and a view of a person. When the gods hear this, they are all greatly delighted. They praise that one of sharp faculties in sweet words, and because they delight in asking questions and receiving answers, all of them attain acceptance of the unborn nature of phenomena. So it is truly said.

People such as these dwell together in one place, gather and keep company together, but being few in number, even when they join their strength they are weak. Śāriputra, at that time even my true sons, though there is no error in their words regarding the family line, will not receive offerings; what need is there even to mention that they will not dwell in stūpas and monasteries? Śāriputra, look at this for a moment!

Then the Tathāgata was openly scorned and disparaged. After I have passed away, even through my sons and the others who are skilled in the peaceful acceptance that nothing whatever is attained, I will at that time be scorned and disparaged. Therefore, for countless eons I subdued enemies, taught all the kings of the gods and the kings of humans, and made their minds pure. Only then did my sons come to obtain their father's place in comfort.

Śāriputra, the Tathāgata brought all the humans and gods of the world under his power, and the Tathāgata, in accordance with the Dharma, attained unsurpassed, true and perfect awakening and turned the unsurpassed wheel of Dharma, which no ascetic or brahmin, no god, māra or Brahmā is able to turn. Śāriputra, this has thus been clearly shown. After the Tathāgata has passed away, if my disciples spread this unsurpassed, true and perfect awakening of mine widely and make it pervade everywhere, other evil people will be able to exert open power over them, but they will not be able to give fearlessness.

Śāriputra, it is like a jar of honey placed at a crossroads, with these words proclaimed: "If anyone dares to eat even as much as the tip of a single hair, he will forever not age and not die." Then gods and humans of the world, each holding swords and weapons, stand beside the jar as guards, and at that time each of them proclaims: "If anyone eats even a single hair's worth, we will kill him!"

Śāriputra, among them a certain man, being clever, thinks thus: "If by eating even as much as the tip of a single hair of the honey in this jar one does not age and does not die, why should I fear death and not eat it? Even if I got it and did not eat it, the guards would surely keep watch without letup. If it is possible to attain freedom from aging, sickness and death, then so be it." Subduing his mind in this way, not sparing his life, he suddenly goes to the jar, and the guards, each carrying swords and weapons, rush at him to kill him. Śāriputra, if that man, untouched by the swords and weapons, manages to dash in and eat a single drop, he is freed from the sickness of decline, and for him there is no more aging and death.

Just so, Śāriputra, because there are many evil people, Māra and the hosts of māras set about destroying my Dharma. After the Tathāgata has passed away, if someone is able to grasp emptiness in accordance with the Dharma, comprehending it without doubt, then his mind is not obstructed by any phenomenon whatsoever. He accomplishes the supreme acceptance. At that time, although evil people scorn him and tear apart and destroy that path of Dharma, if that person is able not to spare his body and life, and constantly practices diligence, he comprehends all phenomena: there is no birth and nothing to be done, and freed from birth, aging and death, he attains liberation.

Śāriputra, the jar of honey is the doctrine of the Buddha's Dharma. The gods and humans of the world who guard the jar are evil people who crave the aims of Māra. They lose their own great merit, and they also obstruct other people who practice the true marks, causing them to lose great merit.

Śāriputra, the arising of laziness is in every way a friend of Māra. It shows the fulfillment of Māra's aims, and it wholly disparages and reviles the Dharma of non-arising.

Again, Śāriputra, teaching what is impure means the view of a self, the view of a person, the view of a sentient being, and viewing things as the five aggregates, the twelve sense bases, and the eighteen elements. Such people

say, "We have attained seeing," hold in their minds that they have attained the path, and hold that they have attained nirvāṇa; and all of them disparage and drive away so straightforward a Dharma as this. Why is that? Because those people are attached to an empty house. Although they are not themselves māras, they have been corrupted and agitated by Māra, and so they have turned my straightforward Dharma to Māra's ends.

Śāriputra, whether one lives in a household or has gone forth from it, if on hearing the Dharma that there is no view of a self, no view of a person, no sentient being, that all is ultimately empty, one is alarmed, doubtful and terrified, then such a person has plainly been instructed and trained by Māra. He is a monk in a painting only. His is the evil way of those who steal the Dharma.

Śāriputra, such a person holds the view of a self and the view of a sentient being; he sees things as existent and sees them as nonexistent, sees them as permanent and sees them as annihilated. All such people are Māra's folk, not disciples of the Buddha. Why so? Within the scriptures of my Dharma it is taught that the whole world is entirely empty: there is no "I" and no place for a "mine," there is no person, no sentient being, nothing permanent, nothing unchanging, nothing indestructible. This being so, if such evil people, though they all read the scriptures of the Dharma, recite them, and explain them to others, still cling to sentient beings, to the view of a self, and to the view of a person, such a deluded person is called one who creates the cause of suffering.

He is called one who turns things upside down, reversing both ends.
He is called one who quarrels and splits the Saṅgha.
He is called a mantra-man who meditates on the teachings of the path.
He is called a mere speculator among the śramaṇas.
He is called a wicked, evil pollution.
He is called one who has only verbal explanations.
He is called an illusory śramaṇa.
He is called a pauper among the śramaṇas.
He is called one who carries a heavy burden.
He is called one who despises and deceives the buddhas.
He is called one who sees in a wrong and evil way.

Śāriputra, such a person is called a great, perverse and evil enemy.
He is called a bad spiritual friend.

He is called one whose moral discipline is broken.
He is called one who gains by crookedness.
He is called one who lingers on the margins.
He is called one who has no practice of truth.
He is called a bad companion.
He is called a murderous demon.
He is called a leprous sore.
He is called a stinking pollution.
He is called one burned by heat.
He is called a prattler and deceiver.
He is called one who has fallen into pitch darkness and remains there.
He is called one who has entered a dense thicket.
He is called one who keeps sinking through birth and death.
He is called one who is born among the lowly ranks.
He is called a hell being.
He is called an animal.
He is called a hungry ghost.
He is called an asura.
He is called one who does not enter the path.
He is called one who despises and deceives people.
He is called one who is empty in his own body.
He is called one who consorts with women and with signs.
He is called one who shouts loudly and mingles in crowds.
He is called one who seeks profit on top of profit.
He is called one who leads others on and clings to them.
He is called one who is always flattering.
He is called one whose mind is agitated and confused.
He is called one greedy for everything harmful.
He is called one who reviles and harms.
He is called a vessel of delusion.
He is called one who craves wealth and gain.
He is called an abode of degenerate, evil people.
He is called one without release or liberation.
He is called one bound by sorrow and turmoil.
He is called not a śramaṇa in body but a painted śramaṇa.
He is called an enemy of śramaṇas, a stinking pollution among śramaṇas, the chaff of śramaṇas.

He is called one hard to satisfy.
He is called one hard to cure.
He is called one whose conduct is ruined.
He is called one without shame.
He is called one whose head has been chopped off.
He is called one whose bodily form is destroyed.
He is called one who wears the Dharma robe tied around his neck.
He is called one who has himself entered darkness.
He is called one of much attachment.
He is called one of much aversion.
He is called one of great delusion.
He is called one obscured and covered by the five coverings.
He is called one who is sunk.
He is called an illusion.
He is called empty.
He is called befogged.

Śāriputra, as for such a one being called empty: because he has turned away from and lost the marks of a person whom the Buddha praised as virtuous in all dharmas, he is called one who is lost. Because he has turned away from and lost the excellent aims of all śramaṇas and the aims of the śramaṇa's Dharma, he is called one who is lost.

How is it that he is called an illusion? Because he stays outside the noble Dharma, he is called an illusion. Because he has kept far from and abandoned the Dharma of emptiness, signlessness and wishlessness, he is called an illusion.

Śāriputra, such an evil person is able to delight Māra. Because he can persist in attachment to illusory and untrue things, he is like an ordinary worldling; and because all the marks of a sinful, evil person are complete in him, he is unlike one who has attained forbearance toward the Dharma. Of the aims of the śramaṇa's Dharma and the excellent aims of a śramaṇa, he has not even one part in a hundred, a thousand, or ten thousand. Śāriputra, that is why he is called empty, and why he is called an illusion.

Attached solely to craving for worldly profit, he says, "I myself am a śramaṇa," though he is no śramaṇa; and though he is not fit to receive offerings, he receives them. This is called the enemy, impermanence, planting the victory

banner bearing the enemy's emblem. Again, he is called an enemy who by his own will kills and harms people. Of every mouthful of food that person eats, none is pure or proper. Only those who are directed toward the path and those who have attained the fruit of the path are able to accept the offerings that are made; since that person has no such thing, he is called one whose eating is impure. Śāriputra, that is why he is called empty, and why he is called an illusion.

"Śāriputra, what do you think? Suppose some person kills, steals, engages in sexual misconduct, lies, speaks divisively, speaks harshly, engages in idle talk, and is covetous, envious, hateful, and holds wrong views. Does that person kill all the time, or does he not take life all the time?"

"Blessed One (the Buddha), he does not. When he is at home he kills, but because he does not take life all the time, the times when he kills are few and the times when he does not kill are many."

"Śāriputra, what do you think? If some person steals, are the times when he steals many?"

"Blessed One, the times when he does not steal are many."

"Śāriputra, what do you think? If some person engages in sexual misconduct, are the times when he engages in sexual misconduct many?"

"The times when he does not engage in sexual misconduct are many."

"And the times of lying, of harsh speech, of divisive speech, of idle talk, of covetousness and envy, and of aversion: are they many?"

"Blessed One, the times of aversion are many."

"Śāriputra, among these ten unwholesome paths, which is the heaviest wrongdoing?"

"Blessed One, among the ten nonvirtues, wrong view is the heaviest wrongdoing. If one asks why: Blessed One, wrong view constantly fastens stains upon the mind, so that the mind is impure and unclear."

"Śāriputra, I now tell you this. Suppose some person in a single day killed hundreds, thousands, tens of thousands and hundreds of thousands of sentient beings; in a single day stole gold and silver and hundreds, thousands, tens of thousands of kinds of wealth and jewels; never gave up sexual misconduct, day or night; in lying, constantly scorned and deceived people, so that because the deeds of his mouth were impure there was no truth in his

words; in divisive speech, constantly destroyed harmony and wrought ruin and devastation; in harsh speech, constantly spoke vile and perverse things with his mouth and never uttered a single gentle, kindly word; in idle talk, made the very mother of all roots, so that when people heard of the matter they spoke countless words and confusion arose; in covetousness and envy, gave rise to unrighteous thoughts toward the wealth of others; in aversion, had anger flare up suddenly without cause or condition, his mind filled with nursing grudges; and in wrong view, craved purification by what is not the path. Śāriputra, what do you think? If some person carried out such unwholesome deeds, would his wrongdoing be great or not?"

"Blessed One, it would be exceedingly great."

"Śāriputra, I tell you: greater than the wrongdoing of a person who for a hundred years carried out such wrongs of the ten nonvirtues is the wrongdoing of a monk of broken discipline who accepts the offerings of others for a single day and night. If one asks why: that killer is recognized by many other people and known by many other people. He is the loathsome enemy of all people. Everyone knows that he kills and takes life, and he does not speak of his wrongdoing as anything else. He is defiled and attached to what he dwells on, and because he is unwholesome and untamed, all people shun him.

"Moreover, Śāriputra, because that killer takes the lives of many others, from time to time remorseful thoughts arise in him, and he himself knows that he is not right and has in the end taken the path of wrongdoing. Everyone too knows that he is wicked, without moral discipline, and tainted. Not even a hundredth part of a tenth of the tip of a hair of goodness touches that man, so what need is there to say that he does not receive the offerings due to a field of merit? Moreover, Śāriputra, the wife and children of that killer are known and recognized by everyone; no one shows them respect or even offers them a seat, so what need is there to say that no one gives them offerings?

"The killer supports himself with wealth and raises his wife and children. From time to time he makes offerings to śramaṇas and brahmins, and in return for this he meets a wise and skilled śramaṇa. That śramaṇa teaches him the Dharma of the path and shows him how to give up killing, and he abandons the work of killing. He goes forth from home into the Buddha's Dharma without obstruction or hindrance. Having gone forth, he relies closely on a spiritual friend and attains the fruit of a śramaṇa. In this present life that man obtains a path on which his wrongdoing becomes light, and by accomplishing the path in

this present life he is freed from the three lower realms.

"Śāriputra, within my Dharma there are certain monks who, though they are not monks, call themselves śramaṇas, and who, though they do not live the pure life, say, 'We live the pure life.' They cut off the roots of virtue, obstruct their own entry into nirvāṇa, and later, through delusion, lose the path. Through the causes and conditions of a ruined path they destroy wholesome dharmas, pursue the aims of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), and enter upon evil paths, so that their evil enemies are many. Having received an empty birth, they are like a dead man: the color of the body faded and cold, they have lost the upright Dharma. Within my Dharma they are called the soiled and stained. They are called enemies of the Dharma. They are called perverse people. They are called those employed by Māra. They are like a cesspit, like a human corpse, like a dog's corpse, like a painted śramaṇa, like a śramaṇa in robes alone: though they conform outwardly, they have nothing of what a śramaṇa means.

"Śāriputra, it is like a fox dwelling among a pride of lions. Or again, it is like a dwarf dwelling among wheel-turning kings. It is like a monkey dwelling among the gods. Or again, it is like a donkey dwelling among many lordly bulls. It is like a blind man dwelling among those with the divine eye. Or again, it is like a bat dwelling among garuḍas.

"Śāriputra, when a monk of broken discipline dwells within the Saṅgha, most of the hundreds, thousands, tens of thousands and hundreds of thousands of gods, on seeing that monk dwelling within the Saṅgha, are all greatly distressed and say these words: 'What need is there to sustain and give to such a wicked man, a companion of Māra and of his realm?' If such a one, wishing to see the unsurpassed path of the buddhas, should explain it to laypeople, and if there is someone who trusts and has faith in the Buddha's Dharma, the nāgas, gods, demons and others call out with great voices and praise that person highly, saying: 'Why does that wicked monk hide himself? He is like a bad horse dwelling among tame and gentle ones. Such a deluded man says, "I myself see and know everything, and I have no wrong view of a self." Concealing himself there and deceiving gods and humans, he is the enemy within all humans and gods. So the many see him, and no one at all praises him.'"

Śāriputra, even the gods know that such an evil, sinful monk is an enemy. Because he does not look like those who wear the white garments of

laypeople, he accepts offerings, and others go out to welcome him and see him off, bow to him, join their palms and pay him respectful honor. That bad man, like a corpse dead of delusion, has got by theft every robe he wears. All the food in his alms bowl he has taken by theft; no one has given it to him. Even a little water he has got by theft.

Śāriputra, wherever the immoral monk goes, whether he goes east, or south, west or north, he goes as a thief. Why is that? Because all the rites and all the Dharma practice that this man has are theft and deceit. Walking, standing, sitting, lying down, going, coming, looking, bending and stretching, leaning back and bending forward, wearing his robes, carrying his alms bowl, everything he does, to put it briefly, every act of body, speech and mind that he engages in, is all the work of a thieving enemy. If someone shaves the head of such a man, he is shaving the hair of an enemy; it only breeds one more torment. Whatever the immoral monk does is all done by an enemy.

Śāriputra, for a bad monk, even defecating, urinating and washing his hands are the doings of an enemy. Why is that? Śāriputra, throughout Jambudvīpa, that bad monk has made himself an enemy to all the great kings, the great ministers, the common people, the realm of nonhumans, and all that exists.

Śāriputra, kings and ministers expect nothing good from a wicked enemy. They do not say, "He is our equal." They do not say, "He is superior to us." But because the immoral monk wears the robes of the noble ones, they hope to gain some good from that man, and so they allow him to stay and live in their land. Once they know him for what he is, they will not allow him even to spit on the ground.

Therefore, Śāriputra, whatever a bad monk does in moving his body is all done by an enemy. His name is Constant Enemy; his name is Great Enemy. Raising the banner of an enemy, he is called one who defiles and harms all the people of the world. Why is that? Because there is no evil he has not done. Therefore, Śāriputra, that bad monk is the great enemy of all the gods and humans of the world.

"Śāriputra, since he is the great enemy of humans, gods and the whole world, can such a man accept even a single sip of offered water, or can he not?"

"Blessed One, he cannot."

"Śāriputra, what do you think? Is such a man not a very bad person?"

"Blessed One, he is."

"Śāriputra, the immoral monk commits great and evil wrongs against the whole world of gods and humans, and for that reason I spoke this verse:

Better to eat red-hot stones,
Or drink molten copper,
Than, lacking moral discipline,
To dare to eat the food of the faithful.

Śāriputra, that immoral monk has no radiance, no goodness, not even an aspiration of a pure mind. Because his body and mind are malicious, he sees evil dreams. Though he lives as though at ease, if he happens to go somewhere unforeseen, his body shakes with fear. When he sees someone of pure moral discipline, he hides on a side path and slips away. Ashamed of himself, his mind trembles, and he does not like to meet such a person. When he accepts offerings he is anxious, suspicious, afraid and terrified. His mind is always running and fleeing, and his perceptions give rise to all manner of thoughts. He greatly craves the profit of wealth, and he delights in and craves tasty food. Such a monk, after his life is over, will surely go to hell. Śāriputra, this is called the seventh of the immoral monk's arrows of sorrow and turmoil; he surely falls into hell.

Again, Śāriputra, the immoral monk lives among the crowd and craves much divisive and quarrelsome talk. By nature he delights in envy. He makes friends and intimates of the immoral, and always craves to speak and talk of the evil things of immorality. He considers himself happy, knows no shame, and turns away from the profound Dharma texts. His mind is doubtful and he does not understand. When now and then he hears such Dharma texts being explained, he believes wrongly. He listens to fights and disputes, but has no desire to receive the teaching. He turns east and west and looks about, and his mind does not settle on one point. He covers his mouth with his hand, gazes up at the sky, gets up from his seat, disparages the Dharma taught by the Buddha and stirs up enmity, and turns his back on those who teach the Dharma. Because he engages in such foolish and evil causes and conditions, after his life is over he falls into the deepest hell. Śāriputra, this is called the eighth of the immoral monk's arrows of sorrow and turmoil; he surely falls into hell.

Again, Śāriputra, the immoral monk delights in honoring and praising preceptors, teachers and ācāryas, and praises their good qualities for show. Seeking the profit of a name, he calls himself a keeper of moral discipline, and by that means he supports himself. As his attachment to wealth grows, he

becomes skilled at crafts and is shameless; he is like a crow. On account of the Saṅgha he seeks many robes, and since he eats food as much as he likes, his bodily strength grows. He knows neither shame nor gratitude and is harsh. He has no regard for seniority. His hands and feet are coarse and rough, and the color of his complexion fades. He craves looking at women and does not keep company with men. Such a bad man is despised and reviled by all the common people. Gods, nāgas and asuras do not praise him. The buddhas, too, do not speak well of him. His mind is rash and fickle, and he always craves anger. When the Saṅgha settles a matter, he is arrogant in the strength of his faction.

Śāriputra, such an immoral monk is always seeking power and honor within the Saṅgha. He answers without being asked and always looks for faults in others. When he sees someone of pure moral discipline, he says, "He is arrogant and a deceiver." When he sees someone diligently seeking the path, he delights in and has faith in others whose Dharma differs from that person's. When he sees a dispute, he is pleased and eggs it on.

Śāriputra, this is called the ninth arrow of sorrow and turmoil of the monk of broken discipline, and truly he falls into the hells.

Again, Śāriputra, the monk of broken discipline craves what belongs to others. He holds to his own doctrine as he pleases, and when there is quarreling and dispute he takes delight in it. He adorns his body with clothing and food, learns the rites of others, and seeks out fine bedding. He lives on gain, makes his body comfortable, and craves the praise of other people. He is greedy toward donors and possessive of his dwelling place. Fearing that if a monk preceptor comes he will see his faults, he hates those who uphold moral discipline, but keeps close to those of broken discipline. He always praises those who practice giving, but he does not praise the upholding of moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, or wisdom, nor does he praise emptiness and peace. He keeps far from dwelling alone and abandons it, and he always craves to speak of the faults of those who uphold moral discipline and to mock them. Nor does he speak well of those who keep the qualities of ascetic purification. From time to time he speaks of my teaching with mockery. From time to time, with foul speech, he gives rise to what is improper. From time to time he tells lies about his mindfulness and perceptions. Proud of relying on a good family, he asks after his father's kin one after another. Engaging in petty causes and conditions, when he teaches the Dharma to the poor, because his mind is never upright, he frightens them and stirs up their doubts, so that everyone hates him and grows weary of him, and this serves

only to bring him lasting contempt and disparagement. He always craves to speak mockingly of those who uphold moral discipline. He does not wish to keep close to those who teach the definitive truth, and in his mind he does not enjoy hearing such Dharma texts. Others who love to retain such Dharma texts in memory, to read them and recite them, and who rejoice at heart on hearing such Dharma texts explained, such people he does not even like to see. Above all he does not like to hear praise of the Dharma of upholding moral discipline. When Dharma texts such as these are explained, he may or may not come to listen and receive them; and even if he has come to listen and receive them, before long he goes off again and makes many friends among the white-clad laity. He always craves to talk about and discuss the monks who uphold moral discipline, and, being conceited, he indulges in contempt and barbed words. Śāriputra, this is called the tenth arrow of sorrow and turmoil of the monk of broken discipline, and truly he falls into the evil destinies.

Śāriputra, after I have passed away and am no more, Jambudvīpa will be filled with people such as these, who will engage only in seeking gain and in making their own livelihood.

The Dharma Text Explaining the Buddha's Treasury, third fascicle. The Dharma text in which the Buddha explains the Buddha's Treasury, chapter six: the chapter on the pure Dharma.

The Buddha said to Śāriputra: Long ago, the Buddha Merit Protector prophesied to me in former times, saying, "When the Buddha Śākyamuni accepts many offerings, his Dharma will quickly disappear." Śāriputra, because truly many offerings are made to my Dharma, later it will quickly disappear. Śāriputra, it is like a poor man who finds a treasury of precious jewels: his mind is overjoyed. Thus, Śāriputra, in the future there will be many monks who keep close to the white-clad laity and accept offerings. Gradually one teaches another and trains him, and having become companions, they are glad at heart and hold it as faith and happiness. Like a poor man who finds a treasury of precious jewels, such deluded people prize worldly gain and crave worldly servants and retinue. When they see a monk who enjoys many offerings, they say on the spur of the moment, "He has attained arhatship." When they see one with few friends, they say at once, "He is one of bad name." Such monks, for the sake of gain for their livelihood, abandon the unsurpassed path of the buddhas, and just as they crave something, so its aim is accomplished.

Śāriputra, it is because of that delusion that the Tathāgata explains Dharma texts such as these. Why is that? When a monk of broken discipline hears such a Dharma text explained, a mind of regret arises in him; recalling again the moral discipline he had abandoned, he will no longer act as a great enemy and will not accept the offerings of others.

Śāriputra, some monks, having heard such a Dharma text, are impure and not open in mind, unhappy and displeased; such are called bad monks. Why is that? Śāriputra, for a monk of pure moral discipline there is no particular Dharma and no particular delight: whether giving is explained, or moral discipline, or patience, or diligence, or meditative concentration, or wisdom, when such sobering and awe-inspiring Dharma texts are explained, he delights at heart in them all.

Śāriputra, there are three kinds of people who, on hearing this Dharma text explained, are troubled in mind with sorrow and turmoil. If one asks which three: first, the monk of broken discipline; second, a person in whom laziness grows; third, one who teaches the Dharma impurely. Again, there are three kinds of people who, on hearing this Dharma text, are troubled in mind with sorrow and turmoil. If one asks which three: first, one who views things as a person; second, one who views things as a life; third, one who views things as a self.

Śāriputra, I now instruct you to make distinctions. A gentle spiritual friend, with a loving and compassionate mind, is like one who seeks merit and happiness for others. You and the others, listen single-mindedly to my words, always seek virtuous merit, and do not be conceited in your minds!

Śāriputra, the impure teacher of the Dharma has five disturbances. If one asks which five: first, he says of himself that he knows the Buddha's Dharma completely. Second, when explaining the Buddha's Dharma texts, he errs by contradicting what appears in other Dharma texts. Third, in his mind he doubts and disbelieves other teachings. Fourth, he acts on whatever he himself knows and does not follow other Dharma texts. Fifth, he teaches the Dharma to others for the sake of gain for his livelihood. Śāriputra, of one who teaches the Dharma in this way, I have declared that such a person in the end falls into hell and does not reach nirvāṇa.

Moreover, Śāriputra, a monk who teaches the Dharma dwells among a great crowd of people. When, out of trust and faith in the Dharma, they spread a high seat for him, he abandons the straightforward Dharma of the Buddha and

teaches what is adorned with the letters and words of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas). For a long time I strove and labored to seek that precious jewel, the Dharma, yet this bad man sets it aside and does not teach it. He uses nothing but treatises whose words contradict the scriptures of the Dharma, arguing back and forth over what is so and what is not. Against the straightforward Dharma, he expounds the noble Dharma according to his own conceited and self-important mind, because he seeks the profit of a livelihood.

Śāriputra, some monks teach the Dharma mixed with the treatises of the non-Buddhists. If there is a monk who strives in seeking the path of virtue, it is right for him to rise from his seat and leave. Why? Śāriputra, when white-clad laypeople, out of faith, spread a high seat, it is not right to cite and expound the words of the non-Buddhists. One who does otherwise is not a virtuous monk. Nor should one say of it, "This is just as it was taught in what is called the Buddha's teaching."

Śāriputra, teaching the Dharma is very difficult. I have said that one who teaches in that way is called a disciple of the non-Buddhist Nirgranthas, and is not a disciple of the Buddha. One who teaches the Dharma in that way, after his life is spent, is born on the path of the Nirgranthas. If it is asked what the path of the Nirgranthas is, it is wrong view. If it is asked what wrong view is, it is the hells, the animal realm, and the realm of hungry ghosts. Why? Śāriputra, one who sits upon a high seat without having accomplished the Dharma in his own body, and teaches the Dharma to others without knowing it in his own person, falls into hell.

Śāriputra, the Tathāgata knows the causes and conditions of this completely: my disciples employ many kinds of approaches, many kinds of causes and conditions, and many kinds of views, and so they bring my straightforward Dharma to nothing.

Śāriputra, if there is someone who, on hearing the Dharma of emptiness and of nothing whatsoever, the treatise of such a supreme scripture of the Dharma, is glad and joyful at heart, it is evident that such a person is truly my disciple.

Śāriputra, in a time long past there were five hundred blind men who, traveling along the road, arrived at a great city. Being very hungry and thirsty, they left one blind man outside to guard their belongings, while the others went into the city to beg for leftover food. Before long, a deceitful man came up to the one guarding the goods and spoke these words: "Hey, why is this man sitting outside all alone?"

He answered, "I have many companions, and they have gone into the city to beg for food."

The deceitful man said, "Do you know or not? Over there someone is holding a great giving. One may obtain clothing, food, jewels for ornament, flowers, incense, and goods and possessions, as much as one likes. If you want, I can lead you there."

He answered, "That will do."

Then the deceitful man led the blind man a little way off from where he had been sitting, and stole all the goods. When the other blind men, having obtained the food they begged, came back, the deceitful man said to the rest of the blind men, "You have gathered a great deal. Did you meet with the one who is holding the giving, or not?"

They answered, "We did not meet him."

The deceitful man spoke these words: "Leave whatever you have here, and I will lead you to where the great giving is being held."

Then the blind men all left their goods and went after the deceitful man. The deceitful man led all five hundred blind men to the edge of a deep pit and spoke these words: "This ground is fine and level, and the great giving is assembled here. Each of you, face toward the east and go, and take the goods he gives you." So he instructed them, and at once they all fell together into the pit and perished.

Śāriputra, in the future, monks who crave reading the scriptures of the non-Buddhists will, when they teach the Dharma, adorn it with counterfeit words and so win the faith of other people. At that time the evil Māra will frighten and corrupt the crowd, obscuring and cutting off the virtuous Dharma. If there are some who have desire for sounds and voices, for eloquent speech, and for contrived praise, or again if there are some people who crave reading the scriptures of the Dharma of the non-Buddhists, Māra corrupts and disturbs them all and makes their minds uneasy. If there are some monks who practice the Dharma of the Buddha, he causes doubt to arise in them, and causes ordinary people not to make offerings to them.

Meanwhile, whether it be two monks or three, having finished reading the scriptures of the Buddha's Dharma, they seek out the scriptures of the non-Buddhists, and praise them, saying, "What I saw before is good and excellent." Such people, corrupted by Māra, the eye of their wisdom covered

and obscured, are exceedingly greedy for the profit of a livelihood. Their looking into the scriptures of the non-Buddhists is like the flock of blind men deceived by the liar, who all fell into the deep pit and died.

Śāriputra, the blind men are the monks who abandon the unsurpassed path of the Buddha and seek the scriptures of the non-Buddhists. The deceitful man is the evil Māra. The deep pit is the path of wrong views.

Śāriputra, it is like the flock of blind men: when told, "Leave all the goods you have gained and go to where the great giving is held," they fell into the deep pit. My disciples too are like them. Abandoning coarse robes and poor food, they follow after a great giving. If they seek fine offerings and cater to what the world says, they lose great wisdom and fall into the deep pit, the Avīci hell.

Moreover, Śāriputra, an impure teacher of the Dharma does not know how to aim his exposition at the intent of the Tathāgata. If he teaches the Dharma to others without being learned himself, that person incurs five faults in this very life, which other people do not perceive; only monks who have attained the divine eye and the gods perceive them. If it is asked what the five are: first, when he teaches the Dharma, he harbors fear and dread in his mind, worrying that others will refute him. Second, while harboring inwardly the anguish of fear, he outwardly teaches the Dharma to others. Third, he is an ordinary common person without genuine wisdom. Fourth, everything he teaches is impure, consisting of nothing but words. Fifth, his words have no order, being sūtra passages gathered from here and there. Therefore, sitting among the crowd, he harbors fear and doubt in his mind.

Such ordinary people have no wisdom, and their minds have no certainty. Arrogant and lazy, they practice with slight causes and conditions, seek to make their names renowned, and, with doubt and regret dwelling in their minds, they teach the Dharma to others. Day and night such a person takes into himself the poisoned arrows of attachment, aversion, and delusion. Why is that? Śāriputra, that person teaches the Dharma to others without being able to know the categories of the Dharma with certainty. His mind is not glad and not happy, and even if he does become happy, it is quickly lost.

Śāriputra, the one I have called impure has such faults and evils: he does not know how to attain the straight path. The meaning of this is not known by any of the monks, nor is it known even by the gods. I alone know it.

Further, the monk who teaches the Dharma impurely does not know how to explain things as the Tathāgata elaborated them. What is taught to others in

other Dharma texts is this: "There is no view of a self, there is no view of a person, there is no sentient being, there is no life." But that person, using words of his own, teaches: "There is a view of a self, there is a view of a person, there is a sentient being, there is a life." He thereby disparages the Buddha, disparages the Dharma, and disparages the Saṅgha. The evil of disparaging the Three Jewels cannot be known by the gods or by the people of the world; only the Buddha knows it. Śāriputra, that person is also called an impure teacher of the Dharma. I know his fault. Others, those with miraculous powers and all the gods, cannot know it; only the Buddha knows it.

Śāriputra, now I shall explain this to you by way of an example, to make it clear. If some person, not knowing the characteristics of the system of the Buddha's path, teaches the Dharma impurely to others, how much that is unwholesome does that person bring about? Śāriputra, what do you think? Are the sentient beings of Jambudvīpa many or not many?

"Blessed One, they are very many."

"Śāriputra, if some evil person were to take the lives of every one of them, would the evil that person incurs be much or little?"

"Blessed One, it would be very much."

"The impure teaching of the Dharma to others by such a deluded person, who does not know the Buddha's path, is a greater evil than that. Why is that? By teaching the Dharma impurely, that person destroys the unsurpassed path of the buddhas, and he also disparages the buddhas of the past, the future, and the present. Why is that? Śāriputra, the future buddhas too have taught that all phenomena, every one, are ultimately and entirely empty: there is no view of a self, there is no view of a person, there is no sentient being, there is no life. Śāriputra, for the future buddhas too, all phenomena are ultimately empty: there is no view of a self, there is no view of a person, there is no sentient being, there is no life. Śāriputra, the present buddhas of world systems as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges in the ten directions also teach that all phenomena are ultimately empty: there is no view of a self, there is no view of a person, there is no sentient being, there is no life.

"Śāriputra, this is called the unsurpassed Dharma of all the buddhas. All phenomena are without characteristics; being empty and nonexistent, there is nothing to be attained. Since in their fundamental nature they are empty and at peace, there is no arising and no cessation either. There is no mark of their own and no mark of intrinsic nature either. Because all is empty, the

Tathāgata, solely in order to cut off the conceptualizations that arise from recollection and perception, taught that in the awakening of the buddhas there is no conceptual analysis.

"Śāriputra, what is called conceptualization? All conceptualizations are these: the view of a self, the view of a person, the view of a sentient being, the view of a life, the seeing of annihilation, and the seeing of permanence. Ordinary people bring about conceptualizations such as these. If some person has no such conceptualizations and is able to know, discerning each distinctly, that all phenomena are entirely empty, that there is no view of a self, no person, no sentient being, no life, then, when he reflects in this way, his mind attains joy. Having attained the supreme system of emptiness, he is neither frightened nor terrified. That person understands that the five aggregates are illusions, untrue, without any genuine truth. He understands that the twelve sense fields and the eighteen elements are illusions, untrue, without any genuine truth.

"That person does not conceptualize even nirvāṇa. He does not think of nirvāṇa, and he does not say, 'I am able to think of nirvāṇa; by practicing the Dharma I have attained empty peace.' He does not conceptualize even the abode of that Dharma's empty peace, nor does he conceptualize its non-attainment. Śāriputra, this is called the conforming forbearance. Within this supreme system of conforming forbearance, that person obtains no mark of his own.

"Śāriputra, what is called the mark of forbearance? Where there is no mark, that is the forbearance which is the mark of conforming forbearance. Śāriputra, what do you think? If some person does not obtain a mark even in such forbearance, would that person obtain the mark of a view of self, the mark of a person, the mark of a sentient being, the mark of a lifespan, or the mark of a life?"

"Truly, not at all."

"If someone has accomplished such wisdom, he is worthy to receive offerings. He is called a son of the Buddha. He is called one who has entered the state of the unattached sage. Śāriputra, this is called the gateway to the system of all the dharmas of the Buddha: there is no conceptual analysis arising from recollection and perception, there is nothing called 'this' and nothing called 'that.' Yet out of delusion some dwell among the many ordinary people, speak crooked views, and, employing their own conceptualizations arising from recollection and perception, show people, saying, 'This is the Dharma of the

Buddha; this is the noble path.' Such delusion reproaches and disparages the buddhas of the past, the future, and the present. Such a deluded person is called a bad spiritual friend; he is not called a virtuous spiritual friend.

"Śāriputra, though an enemy may take one's life, only a single body is lost. But the impure teaching of the Dharma by such a deluded person makes him a thief of sentient beings who causes great sorrow for thousands, tens of thousands, and hundreds of thousands of eons."

"That person, with the Buddha's awakening covered by the darkness of delusion, longs once again for desire, the source of the mind. One thing follows on another, and he clings to it. Because he indulges in desire, he goes and comes along the five paths of rebirth. He has no path of shame, and his birth and death do not cease. Therefore, Śāriputra, teaching the Dharma impurely brings a great deal of evil. Such a person also becomes a bad spiritual friend to sentient beings. He also disparages the buddhas of the past, the future, and the present.

"Śāriputra, leave aside the sentient beings of that Jambudvīpa. The evil of teaching the Dharma impurely is greater than if someone were to take the lives of all sentient beings in the great trichiliocosm. Why is that? Because that person utterly destroys the unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening of the buddhas. He sets beings toward the aims of Māra, and makes them suffer the sorrows of thieves for hundreds of thousands of myriads of lifetimes. He can only bind; he cannot set free. Such a person is clearly a bad spiritual friend to sentient beings. With his false words he disparages and tears down the buddhas in the midst of the great assembly. Through such causes and conditions, beings fall into the great hells. He teaches beings many crooked views, and so he is called by the evil name 'crooked view.'

"Śāriputra, viewing things as a self, viewing things as a person, and viewing things as a sentient being lead many to fall into crookedness. Yet even those who have not seen peace cut through quickly, and many attain the path. Why is that? Because for them it is easy to see. Therefore understand this! It would be better for such a person to sharpen his own keen sword and cut off his tongue than to teach the Dharma impurely in the midst of the assembly. That is not fitting."

This is Chapter Seven, the chapter on the ancient past.

The Buddha said to Śāriputra, "Long ago in the ancient past, immeasurable and endless, inconceivable, countless eons ago, there was a buddha of

excellent name, called the Tathāgata, the Worthy of Offerings, the Perfectly All-Knowing, Endowed with Knowledge and Conduct, the Sugata, the Knower of the World, the Unsurpassed, the Tamer of Beings to Be Tamed, the Teacher of Gods and Humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One. That buddha lived in the world for eight hundred and sixty myriads of hundreds of thousands of years, and he had a great assembly of disciples numbering eight hundred and sixty myriads of hundreds of thousands. After that buddha passed away, his relics were widely distributed, just as will happen after my passing; there is no difference. The true Dharma also remained in the world for five hundred years, just as will happen after my passing; there is no difference.

"After the Buddha passed away, from among that great assembly a hundred monks entered nirvāṇa in a single day. Two hundred, three hundred, four hundred, and five hundred entered nirvāṇa. At times ten myriads of hundreds of thousands of monks entered nirvāṇa in a single day. In this way, one after another, that buddha's disciples of great knowledge, of many stages, and of great miraculous power all entered nirvāṇa within three months.

"Śāriputra, while the Buddha Great Excellent Ornament was spreading the true Dharma widely, many gods and humans all made offerings. Śāriputra, after the Buddha Great Excellent Ornament and his great disciples had passed away, there were many people who gradually came to know the Dharma of renunciants and, out of contentment, left home and trained in the path. Yet they could not understand the Buddha's Dharma texts, the extremely profound and incomparable teaching on emptiness that he had drawn forth and explained, for many were corrupted and confused by the evil Māra. At that time even those who taught the Dharma could not keep their minds on one point, so their teaching was impure and unclear. They taught views of a self, views of a person, and that there is a life, but they did not teach that all phenomena are empty and peaceful.

"A hundred years after that buddha passed away, his disciples divided into five groups. The name of the first was Pervasive Meaning, the name of the second was Spreading Suffering, the name of the third was All-Protector, the name of the fourth was Tsangki, and the name of the fifth was Bardanta.

"Śāriputra, the monk Pervasive Meaning, the monk Spreading Suffering, the monk All-Protector, the monk Tsangki, and the monk Bardanta: these five monks became preceptors of the great multitude. The one called Pervasive Meaning understood all the Dharma the Buddha had taught, the genuine and

true teaching of emptiness in which there is nothing at all. The other four monks all fell onto the crooked path. Many of them taught that the view of self is real, and many taught that the person exists.

"Śāriputra, the monk Pervasive Meaning was scorned by the four groups. Because he lacked supporters and power, many people disparaged him. The four bad monks trained most of the multitude to look to the crooked path. They did not show respect for one another regarding the Buddha's Dharma, and because they contradicted one another, the Buddha's Dharma became divided into many.

"Śāriputra, if someone easily understood and faithfully accepted the Dharma of emptiness taught by the monk Pervasive Meaning, and did not contradict it, I see clearly that such a person had made offerings to five thousand buddhas in former lifetimes. There were sixty-eight hundred thousand nayutas of such people, and they have already entered nirvāṇa. Why is that? Śāriputra, those people had generated roots of virtue with the buddhas of the past. They were of the kind who practice and train in the Dharma of emptiness, in which nothing whatsoever is attained, and so enter nirvāṇa.

"Śāriputra, the monk All-Protector, the monk Tsangki, and the monk Bardanta all held that there is attainment, and they taught that there is a self, a person, a sentient being, and a life. Because they had many companions and their sūtras spread widely, those four bad men made many householders and renunciants attached to crooked views. Abandoning the supreme teaching in which there is nothing at all, the Dharma that is ultimately empty, they put their faith in and became attached to the Dharma taught by the non-Buddhist Dzigen. Śāriputra, those four bad men constantly led their householder and renunciant disciples along behind them until the Dharma came to its end."

Śāriputra, among them, some people take what is not the meaning of the Dharma to be its meaning. Having taken it up, they make it their Dharma and practice it with a diligent mind. Yet if they do not attain conforming patience, needless to say they do not attain the fruit of stream-entry. Such people are not even able to digest the offerings given to them; needless to say they cannot give rise to conforming patience.

Śāriputra, at that time the lay and renunciant disciples fell into the bad paths and did not go on the path of virtue. Those evil people obstructed the straight Dharma of the Buddha. They brought people the great sorrow of ruin, and brought the sorrow of utter ruin to many. On top of this, when their lives were

over, those evil people fell into the Avīci hell. For seven times a hundred thousand myriad years they lie on their backs. For nine hundred times a hundred thousand myriad years they lie face down. For nine hundred times a hundred thousand years they lie on their left side. For nine hundred times a hundred thousand myriad years they lie on their right side. They are burned inside hot iron until they are scorched and destroyed. When they die there, they are born again in the Ash hell and the great Ash hell. In the Killing hell and the Black Thread hell, in all of them, for the same number of years as above, they are tormented by every kind of suffering. When they die in the Black Thread hell, they are born once more in the Avīci hell.

Śāriputra, because of such causes and conditions, among householders and renunciants, those who were close to these people, their spiritual friends and their patrons, numbered altogether six hundred and four times a hundred thousand myriad people. They are born together with these four preceptors and die together with them, and they dwell in the great hells, tormented by every kind of burning. Śāriputra, all who acted toward those people as spiritual friends, patrons, disciples or preceptors are included within that number, and every one of them is born in hell. Śāriputra, you and those like you cannot know how many or how few they are. Only the Tathāgata is able to know it.

Those evil people fell into hell and were born together, and those who die together with them number altogether six hundred and four times a hundred thousand myriad people. In this way, passing from one to the next, they are tormented for an eon, and until the great eon is burned up they still remain in hell. Why is that? Śāriputra, the sin of destroying the Tathāgata's unsurpassed, true and perfect awakening is extremely heavy; it is not light. Even when the great eon has been burned up, those four evil men and the six hundred and four times a hundred thousand myriad people are born again from this great hell without respite, and dwell in the great hells of other regions. Why is that? Śāriputra, because that heavy sin is complete in every respect and its retribution is not small, in other regions they dwell tormented by great suffering for countless hundreds, thousands, myriads, hundreds of thousands of nayutas of years.

Even when they are reborn in a world-system, those four sinful men, the six hundred and four times a hundred thousand myriad ordinary people, and the other people not free from sin, when their lives end there, are born once again in the great hells. Śāriputra, although those four sinful men and the six hundred and four times a hundred thousand myriad ordinary beings are finally

freed from the suffering in the hells, when they gain birth among humans they are blind from birth for five hundred lifetimes. Only after that do they meet the Buddha All-Illuminating, the Tathāgata, the Worthy One, the perfectly and fully awakened, endowed with knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed tamer of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One.

Śāriputra, the Buddha All-Illuminating had a hundred thousand nayutas of śrāvaka disciples. At that time all people had bodies three hundred and ninety-six cubits tall. The Buddha's body was taller than that by half again. His constant, circular radiance shone for up to ten times a hundred thousand myriad leagues. Śāriputra, those people went forth from home in the Dharma of the Buddha All-Illuminating and practiced diligence for ten times a hundred thousand myriad years, striving as though to save a head on fire. Yet they did not attain conforming patience, let alone the fruit of the path. Why is that? Śāriputra, such is the nature of the causes and conditions of the sinful karma set in motion by destroying unsurpassed, true and perfect awakening. When that life is over, they are born once more in the great Avīci hell.

Śāriputra, the retribution set in motion by the conditions of their former heavy nonvirtuous karma is met in this way by those people and the others, one after another. In the meantime they met ninety-nine hundred thousand buddhas, yet even from those buddhas they did not attain conforming patience. Why is that? Whenever the profound Dharma texts of the Buddha were taught, those people did not believe them; they tore them apart and opposed them. They mocked and slandered those who were wise and skilled, and they brought evil accusations of faults against monks who kept moral discipline. Such is the nature of the causes and conditions of the karma set in motion by destroying the Dharma.

Śāriputra, look at this for a moment. If one mocks and slanders noble persons and does not believe the words of the noble ones, one is tormented in this way by immeasurable, boundless suffering and does not attain release and liberation. Śāriputra, there are countless, immeasurable other beings who set in motion the sinful karma of destroying the Dharma, oppose it and do not believe it; and among them, through ninety-nine hundred thousand buddhas and for countless eons, not a single one comes to enter nirvāṇa. Śāriputra, those who are able to destroy the Dharma of the buddhas, to disbelieve it and to oppose it are the ordinary, foolish, evil monks in whom laziness keeps growing, and the monks whose teaching is impure.

Why is that? Śāriputra, those three kinds of people are not called practitioners, nor are they called ones who have earned the name. Because they do not believe in the Dharma of the Tathāgata, they revile it, disparage it, and turn against it.

Śāriputra, the monk Spreader of Suffering, whose teaching of the Dharma you call impure, is none other than the deluded man Devadatta. The monk you call All Exists, whose teaching you call impure, is none other than the monk Kokālika. Śāriputra, the monk Tsangi, whose teaching of the Dharma you call impure, is none other than the monk Kapila. The monk Bartada, whose teaching you call impure, is none other than the naked monk Rimada.

Śāriputra, the one of whom you say that, purely, honestly and in accord with the truth, he explained the awakening of the buddhas and benefited immeasurable sentient beings, is none other than Pūrṇa Maitrāyaṇīputra. Because all that he taught was pure, his other disciples likewise met five thousand buddhas, and six million eight hundred thousand nayutas of people all attained peace and were liberated.

Śāriputra, if one asks which person speaks words of truth: it is one who rightly sees directly the scriptural system of the supreme inner Dharma and explains it purely. The one who explained it, who taught at that time, was Pūrṇa. Śāriputra, all that Pūrṇa taught, he taught from direct realization in order to tame minds; though people took no joy in it and did not believe, he was born to teach and to liberate.

Śāriputra, if one asks which person speaks words of truth: it is the one who, as a Dharma master, at that time explained all causes and conditions, and that was Pūrṇa. Śāriputra, Pūrṇa, in life after life, wherever he is born, always does the work of the buddhas for the sake of sentient beings. Within the Dharma of all ninety buddhas, too, he always served as a Dharma master. Having taught the Dharma purely, under all those buddhas he always lived the pure life of celibacy until his bodily life was spent, and he taught the Dharma purely. Śāriputra, Pūrṇa also served as a Dharma master within the Dharma of six buddhas. Within my Dharma, too, he serves as a great Dharma master; having become an arhat, he has attained the liberation of mind, freedom.

If one speaks of a person who tells the truth, the kind of person who in life after life made offerings to the buddhas and created roots of virtue, the one who taught at that time, is Pūrṇa. Śāriputra, because Pūrṇa diligently sought out and trained in the Dharma of nine million buddhas, his teaching to beings

is not of one kind only, and so he has profound wisdom. Therefore the Tathāgata has declared him foremost among Dharma masters.

Śāriputra, even if one were to spend a day and a night explaining the excellent qualities of this Pūrṇa, they would not be exhausted; even if a day and a night went by, they would not be exhausted. Why is that? Because Pūrṇa's gift of the Dharma has no worldly causes and conditions, and he is not attached to gain for his livelihood, he is a Dharma master. Pūrṇa has attained the four unobstructed wisdoms, and apart from the Tathāgata, there is no one in all the world who can attain his mastery of words and of the system of meaning.

Śāriputra, I instruct you. If any person wishes to attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, then by teaching the Dharma to others he will gain immeasurable, boundless virtuous merit and will be able to benefit countless sentient beings. Śāriputra, if anyone does not believe in this Dharma, but destroys it, tears it apart and turns against it, he gives rise to the causes and conditions of immeasurable heavy evil. Why is that? Śāriputra, for the bad there is a bad path, and for the good there is a good path. Therefore I now entrust this Dharma text to you. Explain it extensively to the fourfold assembly, making clear its distinctions!

Śāriputra, whoever hears this Dharma text, believes it in his mind and rejoices in his heart will obtain immeasurable glorious merit. Whoever hears it and does not believe, does not rejoice and has no faith will obtain immeasurable heavy evil. Śāriputra, know this! Such a person is called a monk of broken moral discipline; he gives rise to laziness, and his teaching of the Dharma is impure. Śāriputra, if anyone turns against the teaching in this way, in life after life, wherever he is born, he will always be blind and without eyes.

Śāriputra, I now command you to make these distinctions. All that I now teach is not like a potter tending pots that have not been fired. When I teach extensively to the fourfold assembly the Dharma of the supreme scripture, empty to the very end, making clear its distinctions, those who can bear it remain, and those who cannot bear it are destroyed. Why is that? Śāriputra, the Buddha who has attained unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening does not teach the Dharma to the wicked who see crookedly. He does not teach the Dharma to those who hold the view of a self, the view of a person, the view of a sentient being, or the view of a life-force. Why is that? All who are attached in this way are called attached ones who see crookedly.

Śāriputra, if through the view of a self and the view of a person one does not even obtain conforming forbearance, what need is there to speak of obtaining the fruit of the path? Śāriputra, if one cannot fully obtain conforming forbearance while holding the view of a self, the view of a person, the view of a sentient being, the view of a life-force, the view of annihilation and the view of permanence, and yet says that one can obtain the fruit of the path, there is no truth in it at all.

Therefore, Śāriputra, if anyone fully holds such views, I do not permit him, within my Dharma, to receive the offerings of others. He is neither a practitioner nor an attainer; he merely uses my Dharma to sustain his own life. Śāriputra, according to what I have taught, if a non-Buddhist wishes to enter the Dharma of the Buddha, it is proper to test him for four months. Why is that? Because non-Buddhist people have many views of a self, views of a person, views of a sentient being, views of a life-force, and views of permanence.

"Śāriputra, among my disciples there is no view of a self, no view of a person, no view of a sentient being, no view of a living soul, no seeing of annihilation and no seeing of permanence. My disciples teach only emptiness, signlessness, wishlessness and the nonattainment of anything whatsoever, and they explain that there is no place for the mind to enter.

"Śāriputra, if there is someone who has accomplished such an acceptance, I permit such a person to go forth from home and to receive the precepts, and it is proper for him to accept the offerings of robes, food, bedding and medicine that are presented to him. A person who lacks such acceptance should first be awakened: first establish him in the absence of 'I' in all phenomena.

"Śāriputra, suppose someone takes no delight in such an acceptance, and on hearing the supreme teaching of emptiness explained, he is alarmed and full of doubt and reviles it with sidelong mockery, while on hearing the view of a self taught, he takes it up with delight. Such a person is plainly being used by Māra, and he goes even beyond the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas).

"Śāriputra, it is not fitting for the wise to give rise to anger toward such a person; it is fitting to give rise to a compassionate mind toward him. Why is that? Śāriputra, a person who has accomplished such wickedness has obtained an evil path. Teach the Dharma tirelessly: give rise to a meritorious attitude toward that person, and show him that there is no 'I' in any phenomenon, that all phenomena are empty and peaceful, that there is no activity in any

phenomenon, and that there is nothing to attain.

"If that person receives the Buddha's Dharma, hears this meaning, and is glad at heart and has faith, then it is fitting for a monk who practices emptiness to go on teaching him and training him in the whole of nonattainment, helping him and gladdening him, glad at heart himself. If he hears the emptiness in which no phenomenon is anything whatsoever explained, and is alarmed and frightened, he says before the assembly to his preceptor, teacher or ācārya, 'It ought to be explained in the manner of the practice of emptiness set down in the scriptures.'

"If he is able to know directly the distinct characteristics of phenomena, I make him a preceptor. One who holds the view of a self, the view of a person, and perverse, crooked views, and who is attached to keeping the precepts, is not to be called a preceptor. Those who rightly possess straight seeing are permitted to perform the poṣadha together. A person whose discipline is broken and whose observance is broken is not permitted to perform the poṣadha with them.

"If an elder and venerable disciple, hearing the Dharma of emptiness, peace and the nonattainment of anything whatsoever taught, does not believe it and has no faith in it, and his mind dwells with the non-Buddhists, then the Buddha does not permit him to perform the poṣadha, as with a non-Buddhist. If that person does not give up such a view, it is fitting not to permit him to remain within the Saṅgha. If he does not take up the proper wish, and even when this has been done he still does not give it up, then that person is plainly unfit to remain on the path. He is to be cast out entirely, and it is not proper for the preceptor, teacher or ācārya to agree to take him back again.

"Śāriputra, in this way I have set forth for the Saṅgha what concerns offerings, and I am skilled in destroying the views of the crooked paths of the non-Buddhists. This is called the teaching of discipline and the pure poṣadha.

"Śāriputra, I now instruct you to make distinctions. If some person holds such a view of a self, view of a person, view of a sentient being, or view of existence and nonexistence, such a person is not to be called 'one who makes offerings to me,' nor is he to be called 'one who has gone forth from home after me and received the precepts.' He is to be called one who has gone forth from home following the six teachers, one for whom the six teachers have acted as preceptor.

"Śāriputra, if some person is unable to gain acceptance of such a pure, true Dharma and yet accepts offerings, whatever that person obtains is called a crooked receipt.

"Śāriputra, a person may go forth from home within my Dharma and keep and guard pure discipline, and yet not believe or understand the Dharma of the supreme teaching of emptiness and the nonattainment of anything whatsoever, and be alarmed, frightened, doubtful and remorseful. Such a person plainly clings to keeping the precepts, to great learning and to mastery of meditative concentration as something exalted. Śāriputra, such a person is not to be called 'one who honors me with weighty reverence and respect and makes offerings to me.' Why is that? Śāriputra, from lifetimes without any so-called beginning until now, sentient beings have not attained the four dhyānas; but since there is no monk's acceptance brought about merely by attaining the four dhyānas, how could such a one be called 'one who makes offerings to me'?

"Therefore, Śāriputra, I instruct you to make distinctions. People of the future, with many kinds of attachment toward my Dharma and many kinds of crooked views, will destroy and tear apart my Dharma.

"Śāriputra, some people cling solely to keeping the precepts, to great learning and to mastery of meditative concentration as something exalted. Such people are plainly unable to practice the dharmas of a śramaṇa purely, and I have not called such a person a śramaṇa, a brahmin, or a brahmin.

"Śāriputra, if a person knows all phenomena to be without 'I,' as being without 'I' in accordance with truth, and is able to know that all phenomena from the very beginning are an emptiness in which there is nothing whatsoever, as an emptiness in which there is nothing whatsoever in accordance with truth, then he does not hold that he is supreme in keeping the precepts, does not hold that he is to be called supreme in learning, and does not hold that he is supreme in attaining meditative concentration. Why is that? Śāriputra, in the true characteristic of all phenomena there is no arising and no possession, and within it there is no phenomenon called supreme. Śāriputra, within the suchness of all phenomena there is no keeping of the precepts; and if there is no breaking of the precepts, what need is there to speak of there being nothing called supreme with regard to desire?

"Śāriputra, that is called the unsurpassed, true and perfect awakening of the buddhas. All phenomena have no characteristic and no own-characteristic;

they are empty, without the view of a self or the view of a person. When one has such an acceptance, that is called practice, and that is called attainment. That person is called one who practices faith and has gone forth from home, one worthy to receive offerings and one who performs the pure poṣadha. That person is called a god among humans.

"Śāriputra, the unsurpassed, true and perfect awakening of the buddhas is solely a single way, and it is called separation. If one asks what it is separation from, it is from all desires and all views; and desire is ignorance."

Views are mindfulness and intention. Why is that? Because all phenomena are patterned by mindfulness and intention, whatever perception there is in the mind is called a view, and a view is crooked. Śāriputra, even within virtuous dharmas, a view is still called a crooked view. Why is that? Śāriputra, within the Dharma that is free of desire, empty and at peace, there is no dharma, nor is there any non-dharma. There is no virtue, and there is no evil. All objects are entirely empty, free of the letters of the Dharma and free of all sentient beings, and therefore it is called freedom.

Śāriputra, within the unsurpassed, desires are completely pacified. What are called desires? The "I," the crooked unwholesome mind, "I" and the place of "I," the sign of an agent, and the sign of an object. That is why it is said that within unsurpassed, perfect awakening all desires are completely pacified.

This is the eighth chapter, the chapter on seeing purity.

The Buddha said to Śāriputra, "I recall that in times past, when I was seeking unsurpassed, perfect awakening, I met three million buddhas, all of whom were named Śākyamuni. At that time I was a wheel-turning king (cakravartin) over all, and for as long as my life lasted I offered to them all and to their disciples robes, food, bedding and medicine. Yet because I was seeking unsurpassed, perfect awakening, those buddhas did not prophesy to me, 'In the future you will attain buddhahood.' Why was that? Because I practiced with something to attain.

"Śāriputra, I recall that in times past I met eight thousand buddhas, all of whom were named Unchanging Light. At that time I was a wheel-turning king over all, and for as long as my life lasted I offered to them all and to their disciples robes, food, bedding and medicine. Yet because I was seeking unsurpassed, perfect awakening, those buddhas did not prophesy to me, 'In the future you will attain buddhahood.' Why was that? Because I practiced with something to attain.

"Śāriputra, I recall that in times past I met sixty thousand buddhas, all of whom were named Radiant Light. At that time I was what is called a wheel-turning king over all, and for as long as my life lasted I offered to them all and to their disciples robes, food, bedding and medicine. Yet because I was seeking unsurpassed, perfect awakening, those buddhas too did not prophesy to me, 'In the future you will attain buddhahood.' Why was that? Because I practiced with something to attain.

"Śāriputra, I recall that in times past I met three hundred thousand buddhas, all of whom were named Puraśa. At that time I was a wheel-turning king over all, and when I made offerings of the four requisites, none of them prophesied to me, because I practiced with something to attain.

"Śāriputra, I recall that in times past I met eighty-eight thousand buddhas, all of whom were named King of Mountains. The name of that eon was Supreme Eight. In the presence of all those eighteen thousand buddhas I shaved my head, put on the Dharma robes and trained in the practice of unsurpassed, perfect awakening, yet none of them prophesied to me, because I practiced with something to attain.

"Śāriputra, I recall that in times past I met five hundred buddhas, all of whom were named Supreme Flower. At that time I was a wheel-turning king over all, and I offered them all everything I had, yet none of those buddhas or their disciples prophesied to me, because I practiced with something to attain.

"Śāriputra, I recall that in times past I met five hundred buddhas, all of whom were named Excellent Splendor. I offered them absolutely everything, yet none of them prophesied to me, because I practiced with something to attain.

"Śāriputra, I recall that in times past I met two thousand buddhas, all of whom were named Kauṇḍinya. At that time I was a wheel-turning king over all, and I made every kind of offering to them all, yet none of those buddhas prophesied to me, because I practiced with something to attain.

"Śāriputra, I recall that in times past I met nine thousand buddhas, all of whom were named Merit Protector. I provided the four requisites as offerings, yet none of those buddhas or their disciples prophesied to me, because I practiced with something to attain.

"Śāriputra, I recall that in times past, during ten thousand earlier eons, no buddha appeared. In the first five hundred of those eons there were ninety thousand pratyekabuddhas, and for as long as my life lasted I offered to every

one of them robes, food, bedding and medicine, and praised them as venerable and weighty. In the five hundred eons after that, too, I provided the four requisites as offerings to eighty-four thousand pratyekabuddhas and praised them as venerable and weighty.

"Śāriputra, when those thousand eons had passed there were no pratyekabuddhas either. At that time I died in Jambudvīpa and was born in the Brahmā realm, where I became a great Brahmā king. In this way, for five hundred eons one after another, I was always born in the Brahmā realm and became a great Brahmā king, and was not born in Jambudvīpa. When those five hundred eons had passed I descended and was born in Jambudvīpa, and in Jambudvīpa I taught treatises. When that life ended I was born as a king of the gods of the four quarters. When my life there ended I was born in the realm of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three and became their lord (Śakra, that is, Indra). In this way, one after another, when five hundred eons were complete I was born in Jambudvīpa. When five hundred eons there were complete, I was born in the Brahmā realm and became a great Brahmā king. Śāriputra, for nine thousand eons I was not born in Jambudvīpa even once; for nine thousand eons I was born only in the realms of the gods. When the eon came to an end and was consumed by fire, I was born in the realm of the Ābhāsvara gods (the gods of Radiant Light).

When the world system had come into being once more, I was again born in the Brahmā realm. For nine thousand eons I was not born in any lowly state among humans. Śāriputra, throughout those nine thousand eons there were neither buddhas nor pratyekabuddhas, and many sentient beings fell into the evil paths and remained there.

Śāriputra, when those ten thousand eons had passed, a buddha appeared in the world named Universal Protector, the Tathāgata, worthy of offerings, rightly and perfectly awakened, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Well-Gone One, knower of the world, unsurpassed, tamer of those to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One. At that time my life in the Brahmā realm came to an end and I was born in Jambudvīpa. I became a wheel-turning king, and my name was Universal God. The human lifespan then reached ninety thousand years. Until the end of my bodily life I made offerings with every kind of comfort to that buddha and to nine million monks. For ninety thousand years I sought unsurpassed, eternal, perfect awakening, yet that buddha, Universal Protector, did not prophesy to me, "In the future you will attain buddhahood." Why was that? Because at that

time I was not able to comprehend the true mark of all phenomena. I was attached to holding a view of self, and I saw that there was something to be attained.

Śāriputra, in that eon a hundred buddhas appeared, each with a different name. At that time I became a wheel-turning king under each of them, and until the end of my bodily life I made offerings to all of them and to their disciples, seeking unsurpassed, eternal, perfect awakening. Yet those buddhas too did not prophesy to me, "In the future you will attain buddhahood," because I practiced with the notion that there was something to be attained.

Śāriputra, as I recall, in past times, seven hundred incalculable eons ago, I met a thousand buddhas, all of them named Jambūnada. Until the end of my bodily life I made offerings to them with the four kinds of requisites, yet again there was no prophecy, because once more I practiced with the notion that there was something to be attained.

Śāriputra, as I recall, in past times, seven hundred eons ago, I again met six million two hundred thousand buddhas, all of them named Seer of All Rites. At that time I became a wheel-turning king under each of them, and until the end of my bodily life I made offerings with every kind of comfort to them all and to their disciples, yet they did not prophesy to me, because I practiced with the notion that there was something to be attained.

Śāriputra, as I recall, in past times, again seven hundred eons ago, I met eighty-four buddhas, all of them named Royal Mark. At that time I became a wheel-turning king under each of them, and using every kind of comfort, until the end of my bodily life I made offerings to them all and to their disciples, yet they did not prophesy to me, because I practiced with the notion that there was something to be attained.

Śāriputra, as I recall, in past times, again seven hundred incalculable eons ago, I met fifteen buddhas, all of them named Sunlight. At that time I became a wheel-turning king under each of them, and using every kind of comfort, until the end of my bodily life I made offerings to them all and to their disciples, yet they did not prophesy to me, because I practiced with the notion that there was something to be attained.

Śāriputra, as I recall, in past times, again seven hundred incalculable eons ago, I met sixty-two buddhas, all of them named Virtue. At that time I became a wheel-turning king, and using every kind of comfort, I made offerings until the end of my life, yet they did not prophesy to me, because I practiced with

the notion that there was something to be attained.

Thus it went on, one after another, until at last I met the Buddha Dīpaṃkara. Only then did I attain the forbearance of non-arising, and he prophesied to me, declaring: "In the future, when incalculable eons have passed, you will attain buddhahood, and your name will be Śākyamuni, the Tathāgata, worthy of offerings, rightly and perfectly awakened, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Well-Gone One, knower of the world, unsurpassed, tamer of those to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One."

Śāriputra, as I recall, in past times there were one million two hundred thousand wheel-turning kings, all of them named Mūrdhaja. Again, Śāriputra, as I recall, in past times there were three million wheel-turning kings, all of them named Last of the Many. Śāriputra, as I recall, in past times there were four million wheel-turning kings, all of them named Field-Plougher. Śāriputra, as I recall, in past times there were ten thousand wheel-turning kings, all of them named Manifest Light. Śāriputra, as I recall, in past times there were twenty thousand wheel-turning kings, each with a different name. Śāriputra, as I recall, in past times there were one million six hundred thousand wheel-turning kings, each with a different name. These kings and the others I have described elsewhere to Nanda and the rest. Śāriputra, what do you think? These kings were not other people; they were my own bodies.

Śāriputra, as I recall, in a still earlier past time there was a buddha named Light of Virtue. At that time the bodhisattva Maitreya was a wheel-turning king named Manifest Light, and it was then that he first generated the unsurpassed awakening mind. At that time the lifespan of beings reached eighty-four thousand years. That buddha, Light of Virtue, convened three assemblies and taught the Dharma. At the first assembly nine million six hundred thousand people attained the path at once. After that, at the great assembly, nine million four hundred thousand people attained the path at once. At the last of the three, the great assembly, nine million two hundred thousand people attained the path at once.

That king, seeing that the Buddha had convened three assemblies and taught the Dharma and that countless people had been liberated, was overjoyed in his mind. For ten thousand years he made offerings of every requisite to the Buddha and his disciples, and generating the resolve, he sought unsurpassed, eternal, perfect buddhahood, so that in the future it would be easy to liberate sentient beings, saying: "Whenever I attain buddhahood, the length of life, the

number in the Saṅgha of monks, and the assembly that gathers around me will be just like this."

Śāriputra, what I know of that matter goes far beyond this; it is immeasurable.

Śāriputra, the Buddha Maitreya generated the mind of awakening first. Only after forty eons had passed did I first generate that mind. I first planted roots of virtue in the presence of the Buddha Invincible. For a thousand years I made offerings to that buddha of every comfort and requisite, and I presented five hundred bolts of cloth. After that buddha had passed away, I built a stupa of the seven precious substances, one league high and half a league wide, made entirely of gold, silver, beryl, emerald, agate, mother-of-pearl and red pearls. In my mind I constantly made this aspiration: "Suffering beings have no one to rescue them. Many meet with evil teachings and fall into evil paths. At that time, may I attain buddhahood!"

Śāriputra, consider this for a moment: to practice and train for unsurpassed, true and complete awakening is extremely difficult. Śāriputra, whoever practices and trains for unsurpassed, true and complete awakening is tormented by sufferings for countless lifetimes. Were I to tell of it, on hearing it you would surely be dismayed and lose heart. All the torment I endured through suffering and turbulent grief was for the sake of seeking unsurpassed, true and complete awakening.

Śāriputra, look: the bodhisattva Sadāprarudita, the bodhisattva Dharma Seeker, the bodhisattva Ever Compassionate, the bodhisattva Unsparing of Self, and the bodhisattva Ever Diligent made offerings to as many buddhas as I did. Though they were tormented by every kind of suffering, unsurpassed, true and complete awakening was still hard for them to attain. What need is there, then, to speak of other deluded people, who do not seek nirvāṇa even for an instant? Śāriputra, even practicing in that way it was extremely difficult; what need to speak of not practicing at all?

Therefore, Śāriputra, I instruct you in drawing distinctions. One cannot attain the higher Dharma by practicing the lower Dharma; only by practicing the higher Dharma does one attain the higher Dharma. What, then, is the lower Dharma? It is bad action of body, bad action of speech and bad action of mind. The lower Dharma is what is called being unable to practice and train so that virtuous qualities are accomplished in the mind. The lower Dharma is what is called being lazy and indolent and breaking all the precepts one has taken.

Śāriputra, the lowest among the low is this. Those called the lowest among the low are those who have gone forth from home into my Dharma and yet give rise to the view of attainment, the view of a self, the view of a person and the view of a sentient being. Why is that? Śāriputra, the Tathāgata knows what is manifest in them. Those who hold that there is attainment do not even have the patience of conformity; what need, then, to say that they do not attain the fruit of the path?

Śāriputra, once someone holds that there is attainment, even if hundreds, thousands, tens of thousands and hundreds of thousands of buddhas were to turn the wheel in its three phases and teach him directly, if that person does not abandon his view, he cannot digest even a single mouthful of another's food. What need, then, to say that he does not attain the fruit of the path?

Śāriputra, if nirvāṇa were attained through the view of a self and the view of a person, it would follow that all ordinary people without exception had passed into peace. Why is that? The view of a self and the view of a person are entirely crooked views. Ordinary people have many grounds for the view of a self and much attachment to the view of a person. Therefore it would follow that all ordinary people attain nirvāṇa; so it was said.

Śāriputra, suppose some person thinks, "There is a self, there is a person." If such a person, without abandoning that view, could enter nirvāṇa, it would follow that all ordinary people had obtained the noble path. Why is that? All ordinary people without exception hold the view of a self and the view of a person. Therefore, if nirvāṇa were entered through the view of a self and the view of a person, all ordinary people would enter the wondrous path, and the noble ones would be no fewer in number than they.

Śāriputra, suppose some person thinks, "If there is nirvāṇa while there is the view of a self, then that person attains the noble path, and there is no need to consider anything else." Why is that? Because the view of a self and the view of a person are by no means slight in ordinary people, such deluded people fall into this kind of error, and they say, "All ordinary people enter the noble path." Since there is no bondage on the wondrous path of the noble ones, it would follow that, while practicing it, such a person could take up the five acts of killing and commit the evil of the five heinous deeds. Therefore, for deluded people, the evil of the five heinous deeds would exist on the noble path. Why is that? All ordinary people without exception declare, "There is a self, there are sentient beings." If one speaks such words to people, the evil of the five

heinous deeds is fully accomplished, and one does not enter nirvāṇa. If someone says that one enters nirvāṇa by settling upon the view of a self and the view of a person, those are false words, and they are also slander of the Buddha. In short, such a one is also called one who went forth from home in purity into my Dharma and yet was unable to attain anything.

The Dharma Text Explaining the Buddha's Treasury, fourth section. The Dharma Text Explaining the Buddha's Treasury: the latter part of the chapter on Seeing Purity.

Śāriputra, I instruct you in drawing distinctions. For all who hold that there is attainment, there is no nirvāṇa. Were it not true that all who hold that there is attainment are without nirvāṇa, buddhas would not even appear in the world, and all ordinary people would enter nirvāṇa as well. Why is that? All ordinary people without exception have the view of a self and the view of a person. None of them is without grasping at attainment, and all of that is crooked view.

Śāriputra, consider for a moment how long it took me to succeed. All who hold to attainment and views are not acting wisely and skillfully. So long as I did, the buddhas did not prophesy to me, "In a future time you will attain buddhahood."

Śāriputra, if even I, practicing in that way, still did not receive a prophecy, what need is there to say that such deluded people will not obtain one? They practice only the keeping of moral discipline, much learning, ability in meditative concentration, and the like, while the view of a self, the view of a person, and the view of a sentient being arise in them.

Śāriputra, I declare that such a one is not called "one who practices," nor is he called "one who has attained." Why is that? Śāriputra, day and night they are attached to such crooked views, and so they do not attain passing into peace. Such deluded people think, "We and others like us have trained in a practice without Dharma, by way of a self and a person; even so, it may well be that we put an end to our many sufferings." Śāriputra, they are like a man blind from birth who runs from a man-eating dog, escapes, and falls into a deep pit of fire.

Śāriputra, I say this: such deluded people train in the view of a self, the view of a person, and the view that sees attainment as existent. Practicing such views, they desire and hope for purity, yet they are bound by desire and attachment. If they wish to attain nirvāṇa by practicing such things, I declare that in the end they will fall into the lower realms.

Śāriputra, it is like a blind man who feels happy about a deep pit of fire. In the same way, such deluded people feel happy about the views of a self and of a person and about the view that sees attainment as existent. Bound day and night by attachment, they are deceived and cheated, and they cling to those things again. Having accepted offerings within my Dharma, such deluded people, day and night, through the sorrow of their decline, fall into the lower realms.

Śāriputra, it is like a great king of the ordinary worldly kind. Within the lands of his realm he wields the power of majesty as he pleases, and he says, "Such a person deserves to be stripped of his goods; such a person deserves to be put to labor." Some of the common people go against the king's will and speak evil of the king's faults. The people's minds become divided and fall apart, so that they cannot attend to the defense of the city. The king, knowing that those who plotted wrongly are great enemies, beats the drum of ill tidings before the whole populace, punishes their offenses severely, and banishes them, and they become outcasts. If one searches for the heart of the matter, it was because they could not attend to the defense of the city that they met with such suffering.

Śāriputra, the Buddha is like that as well. Through countless eons he practiced and trained in unsurpassed, everlasting, perfect awakening, and so became a great king of Dharma. He holds the lands of the Dharma's domain and has great power of majesty. Among his disciples are those who know the taste of the Dharma, and even at the cost of their lives they do not let my teaching decline. Neither gods nor the people of the world are able to destroy it. Among those who have received the teaching there is none who is hostile to me or who turns against me, and they do not reveal it to others. Because he has great power of majesty within his glory, he establishes the Dharma by his own sovereign power. He guards the defenses of the city of Dharma, so that evil enemies cannot tear it down or breach it. Those who have taken to heart the secret Dharma taught by the Tathāgata speak of it, seeing hostile people as great enemies.

Śāriputra, because the Tathāgata abides in this way, he is skilled in the defense of the city of Dharma, and those four great disciples are profound and far-reaching in wisdom, so there is now no fear that his city of Dharma will fall into ruin. If some obscure and obstruct the city of Dharma, they are great enemies: in order to tear down the city of Dharma, they gather up my secret

Dharma and explain it to non-Buddhists.

At times such a person comes to me and converses with me. When I teach him the Dharma without explaining what is pure and precious, that person goes forth from home in order to seek the teaching of the Dharma and takes the precepts. Then, knowing that this person will later attain the path, I permit him to go forth, and I test him for four months. Why is that? It is in order to guard the defenses of the city of Dharma. It is also so that enemies in the future do not rise up again. In this way the Tathāgata, skilled in guarding the city of Dharma, made sure that no opening could be found; and such people, having received the Buddha's teaching, came to see their former evils as crooked. Many monks, all rejoicing, were permitted to go forth, and once they had received the precepts, neither gods, nor humans, nor the world could shake or change them.

Śāriputra, when someone is said to be fit to be tested, that is a name for non-Buddhists and for those who crave the doctrines of non-Buddhists. Śāriputra, who are those who crave the doctrines of non-Buddhists? They are those who grasp attainment as existent and who hold the view of a self, the view of a person, and the view of a sentient being. They are attached to what is crooked. They give rise to doubt toward the Dharma whose very characteristic is emptiness. With crooked, illusory, untrue minds they take up and practice many kinds of illusory doctrines. They do not dare to enter the supreme scripture of emptiness, and they follow crooked paths. Such a person is called one who craves the doctrines of non-Buddhists.

Śāriputra, as for those not fit to be tested, whether a person who wears many colors, a layman in white clothes, or one who wears the Dharma robes, such people have obtained what is untrue. All who see things as existent are called non-Buddhists. Such a person who has come forth within my Dharma and taken the precepts deserves to be tested. Why is that? Grasping attainment as existent is, within my Dharma, a crooked view, and such a person is called a great enemy. He is an enemy of gods and humans throughout all the worlds. He is called the hated foe of the whole world, the great enemy of the buddhas. Śāriputra, I do not permit a crooked person such as this to go forth from home and take the precepts.

Śāriputra, in all phenomena there is no view of a self. Suppose someone cannot develop acceptance of this, and cannot believe and understand that all phenomena are empty, that there is no view of a self, no view of a person, no

sentient being, and no living being, and yet accepts offerings within this Dharma. Such a one is called impure. Making no offering to the Buddha, making no offering to the Dharma, and making no offering to the Saṅgha, that person forces his way into my Dharma. His body is that of a renunciant, but his mind is that of a non-Buddhist, and he is called a thief of the Dharma.

Śāriputra, in a future time there will be śramaṇas who do not train their bodies, do not practice moral discipline, do not train their minds, and do not practice wisdom. They will ridicule and despise everything the Tathāgata has taught and everything the Tathāgata has practiced. The Tathāgata always reveres and honors the emptiness of the supreme scriptures and delights in practicing it constantly, yet those monks mock even the Tathāgata's practice of the Dharma in which the true realm is ultimately empty. Śāriputra, at that time, if some monk practices deeds of affliction, everyone despises and ridicules him.

Now, if there is a disciple of mine who practices emptiness, I praise him, saying, "I am pleased," and my mind settles in ease. But at that time those people will despise even those who practice emptiness, and will seek their aims only through what is flimsy and unsound. They practice the view that a self exists and that all phenomena exist, and with notions such as these they gladden the minds of ordinary people. If someone teaches that all phenomena are empty, they despise that person as well. Why is this? Śāriputra, the Dharma is of such a nature that when the roots of virtue in the mind are cut off, the outward form becomes manifest. Yet while the true, genuine sacred Dharma remains in the world, no harm comes to it. It is like a deluded man who holds sandalwood incense and worthless wood to be alike.

Śāriputra, the Buddha Merit Protector said: "In a future time, when disciples of the Buddha Śākyamuni, for the sake of profit to sustain themselves, explain the empty supreme scriptures to the white-clad laity, then many deluded householders and renunciants will not accept it. Turning against it, they will not believe, and in turn will deride and disparage it, and so lose great merit. Having engaged in such causes and conditions, they will in the end fall into the evil paths."

Śāriputra, at that time there will be much contention. They hold to disputes, hold to the view of a self, hold to a person, hold to a sentient being, hold to the grasping at a lifespan, and hold to the grasping at a life force. Doing few virtuous deeds, they crave only the profit of their sustenance. Though in truth

deluded, they claim of themselves, "We have wisdom." Opposing one another, they constantly quarrel and fight and long to cut down whatever has meaning. Giving rise to resentment and jealousy, these people abandon the mind of a śramaṇa and seek nothing but the profit of their sustenance. They crave many means of livelihood, and do not apply themselves to just one. Always they delight in searching out the faults and failings of others; hiding their own wrongdoing, they speak and talk of their good points. The monks of the present, by contrast, conceal their good points and bring their own bad faults into the open. At such a time no one will be able to guard and uphold moral discipline with due weight, and there will be no understanding. Destroying the merit of the scriptures, they mock, saying, "All phenomena unchanging and empty of their own characteristics: what could one possibly do with that?"

When a performer swiftly changes his cloths and puts on many displays, those who know nothing of it laugh heartily on seeing it. Why is this? Because, not knowing the ways of the show, they are taken aback and think it a marvel; a sense of wonder arises in them, they are startled and alarmed, and they laugh loudly. Just so, Śāriputra, at that time, when a monk of true reality teaches the Dharma of peaceful emptiness, all those who seek profit to sustain their lives will sneer and laugh. Why is this? Because these people, ignorant of the scriptures of the Buddha's Dharma, are startled, alarmed and terrified when they hear the Dharma of emptiness taught.

Śāriputra, look at these people. In a place of happiness and well-being, the grief of ruin arises in them; in a place of the grief of ruin, a happy mind arises in them. Being inverted, these people treat virtuous things as wrong and practice evil things as though they were right. Śāriputra, such deluded people nurture avarice, desire, anger and delusion in abundance, and, complete in every way, they practice the three roots of non-virtue.

Śāriputra, in order to benefit monks who uphold moral discipline, I taught the code of the two hundred and fifty precepts. Such deluded people, engaged in petty worldly causes and conditions, explain it to householders, even write it down, and show it to the white-clad laity as well. Śāriputra, such deluded people mock what has been taught, saying, "How could one ever make all phenomena empty, together with their own characteristics?" Why is this? If such deluded people cannot even clear away clinging, greed and the turmoil of grief, what need is there to speak of their inability to deal properly with ignorance in all its forms?

Śāriputra, at that time the monks who hold to the rules of moral discipline will be unable to train in virtue. They will not train well in the emptiness of all phenomena either, nor will they train well in reciting the sūtras. Śāriputra, it is said that the monks who hold to the rules of moral discipline will be unable to train well. In the Dharma texts of the Tathāgata three trainings are taught: training in virtuous discipline, training in a virtuous mind, and training in virtuous wisdom. These people will be unable to train virtuously in the three trainings. Pursuing only the causes and conditions of great learning, they despise others as well. These people obscure and cut off the virtuous Dharma. If such deluded people cannot even answer and ask questions in accordance with the Dharma, what need is there to speak of their inability to exert diligence in that which is ultimately nothing at all?

Śāriputra, at such a time monks whose moral discipline is broken will act as servants to the white-clad laity, will be sent as their messengers and kept under their control, and will sustain themselves by the practice of medicine. Śāriputra, look now: these wicked people went forth from home into my Dharma, received the precepts, obtained offerings, and then in turn regard me as an enemy. Śāriputra, at that time the divine kings of the four directions, Indra, the great king Brahmā, and all the other gods by the hundreds, thousands, tens of thousands and hundreds of thousands, seeing such decline within my Dharma, will all grieve deeply and be unhappy, weeping and shedding tears. Śāriputra, in truth, it is not right for those who rely on me to take on the marks of the white-clad laity and act accordingly.

Why is this? It is fitting that the disciples of the Buddha Śākyamuni be served by gods, nāgas and asuras, and be treated by them as masters. If the nāgas and asuras do not serve my disciples and treat them as masters, and someone then says that by attending on such deluded, white-robed people one can study the empty doctrine of all dharmas and come to understand it, there is no truth in this at all.

Śāriputra, at that time, if a monk of broken discipline gets even a single cup of liquor, he will cite the Buddha to justify it when he speaks to the white-robed laypeople.

What do you think? Can such a person, full of attachment, aversion and delusion, full of craving for reading books of doctrine, greedy for the profit to be had from worldly writings, and impure and unclean in conduct, have faith in the Dharma that is empty through and through, in which there is nothing

whatsoever? Can he attain the fruit of the renunciant in its complete form, or can he not?

"Blessed One, he cannot."

Śāriputra, suppose a monk, whatever robes, food, bedding and medicine he obtains, keeps his discipline pure and clean. He has no craving for crowds and idle talk and is not attached to outside texts. He is as diligent day and night as one putting out a fire on his own head. With a single-pointed mind he diligently practices the straight and wondrous eightfold path. Even for such a person it is hard to understand the empty Dharma in which nothing whatsoever is attained. Then what need is there even to mention such deluded people, who have no wish for the profound, no faith and no understanding?

Śāriputra, look! Because such people do not know the unsurpassed teaching of the Tathāgata, they destroy my straight Dharma and cause great grief, the ruin of themselves and of others. Such a great enemy is the great enemy of the world, and in this Dharma text too they are called the kind who are wholly cut off. Such people do not even know the kindness of the Buddha. They think to themselves, "We and others like us have gone forth from home," and they think, "The things in this Dharma that are improper to do are improper to do."

Therefore, Śāriputra, the Tathāgata teaches a Dharma such as this in order to cut off whatever evils will arise in the future. If some monk who has broken every precept he received, who has torn the Dharma apart and destroyed right view, hears this Dharma text, he will be frightened and will turn back to discipline. Why? Because a person of broken discipline should not remain, even for the time of a single finger-snap, among those of noble form who wear the Dharma robes.

If someone hears this Dharma text and his mind rejoices, the buddhas acclaim that person's name, and he is called "one who guards the path of the Buddha and serves it." Why is this? Śāriputra, his name is "the true sphere of the buddha path."

If some pure man or virtuous woman wishes to hear the Dharma of the renunciant, let them listen to this Dharma text. It is fitting to cross even hundreds, thousands, tens of thousands and hundreds of thousands of leagues for it. Why? Because only after a very long time has passed do the tathāgatas, the buddhas, appear in the world; and though they do appear in the world, it is only now and then.

This is the ninth chapter, the chapter on distinguishing doubts.

The Buddha said to Śāriputra: There are three kinds of people who, on hearing this Dharma text taught, are not glad at heart and have no faith. Which three? The first is a monk of broken discipline. The second is a monk who grows ever more lax. The third is a preacher of the Dharma who is impure and attached to the view of a self. Such people wholly abandon this profound mark of truth, which is in harmony with the Dharma text, and they multiply until they fill the gatherings of the blind and their companions.

Therefore, Śāriputra, I have taught you this Dharma text of mine and I entrust it to you. Why is this? After the Tathāgata is gone, this Dharma text should always be gathered and upheld by monks of pure discipline, monks who keep their discipline pure and clean and in whose minds delight and faith can arise toward so profound a Dharma text. Those of broken discipline should always be kept far off and rejected. Why? Because when the deluded hear the straight words of true reality taught, they take them to be suffering.

Śāriputra, the Tathāgata has already explained in detail and at length what sort of appearance a monk of broken discipline has. Śāriputra, a monk who has destroyed his discipline has no faith in the rules for keeping the discipline of the Dharma. A deluded person does not delight in wisdom. A miserly person does not like to hear generosity explained. One who grows ever lazier is haughty and does not like to hear this teaching of non-laziness, and even if he has heard it, his terror is like that of falling into a deep pit. One who craves worldly gain is attached to delicious flavors, and when he hears of turning away from food in disgust, his mind is troubled with sorrow. If some person craves reading worldly writings, the notion arises from that that he is accomplished and has grasped the truth. Attachment to words is craving to engage in idle chatter. Those who crave composing poetry of their own invention have no pure mind toward the teaching of the supreme Buddha, and besides that, they neither believe in this Dharma nor respect it.

Śāriputra, it is like the case of a eunuch. Lacking manly conduct, when he goes among men the notion of being a eunuch arises in him, and he thinks to himself, "There are none among these other people who are not just like me." In the same way, one who craves worldly writings and is attached to them always craves self-made poetry adorned with words, and in his mind he has not the slightest respect for the supreme teaching of the Buddha. Śāriputra, if among them there is someone who holds the pure Dharma text, he has not

the slightest respect for that person either, and he treats lightly and disparages even the monk who keeps pure discipline. Why is this? Śāriputra, in the Dharma texts of the non-Buddhists there are no true words of reality. They are the kind who are puffed up by their doctrines, lazy, opinionated and eager to be great. Why is this? Because that meaning is not for people who lack weariness with the world.

It is not for the sake of nirvāṇa. Because that person has lost the four roots, such as faith, he does not believe that any state at all has a good purpose. He is like a eunuch who says of all other people, "They are the same as I am."

Śāriputra, it is like a blind man who does not see colors. Of black and white colors, he has never seen black or white. He has never seen beautiful colors, and he does not see ugly colors either. He does not see blue, yellow, red, or white, nor the colors of vermilion and azure. He does not see shapes such as long, short, thick, and thin. He has never seen the stars, the sun, or the moon. Such a blind man, who has never seen the sun, the moon, and the stars, rashly thinks: "There are no white and black colors. There is no seeing of white and black colors. There are no beautiful or ugly colors. There are no colors of blue, yellow, red, or azure, of long and short, thin and thick, deep and shallow, of the sun, the moon, or the stars." Because he has no sight of the sun, the moon, and the stars, he takes it that everyone else is the same as himself. With the inverted mind of a blind man, he says that every place everywhere is pitch dark.

Śāriputra, a monk of broken moral discipline, in whom laziness keeps growing, falls into the teachings of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas). Such a monk is like that blind man: he does not believe in the profound Dharma of the Buddha, has no faith in it, and cannot comprehend it. When he hears that all phenomena are empty and nothing whatsoever, he does not believe and has no faith; he cannot comprehend it. Śāriputra, I fear that you and the others too, like other people, may fall into the realm of the crooked and not attain the straight Dharma. One who practices this straight Dharma is called by name "a śramaṇa of genuine truth." That person's disbelief in all that you have attained is like the blind man saying, "There are no colors such as white and black."

Śāriputra, that person, dwelling in such a crooked realm, seeks out the teachings of the non-Buddhists and craves their many fearsome words; an evil nature of sorrow and turmoil and evil dharmas arise and increase in him. If that person does not even come to believe that all phenomena are empty,

what need is there to speak of comprehending it?

Śāriputra, what do you think? If a jackal acts like a lion, has it roared, does it roar now, or will it roar later? If it takes the lion's gait, can it go now, will it go later, has it gone? Is it able or not?

"Blessed One, it is not able. If one asks why, a jackal has not the color, the strength, or the voice of a lion. A jackal can make only a jackal's cry. Whenever it tries to make a sound, only a jackal's cry comes out, not a lion's roar."

"That is so. Śāriputra, a monk of broken moral discipline, in whom laziness keeps growing, takes himself to be a monk of the ultimate. Such teachers of impure Dharma take up the teachings of the Nirgranthas, cling to a single meaning, grasp it tightly, and do not let it go. Greedy for worldly profit and costly things, and craving to read ordinary writings, they cannot comprehend the truth of all phenomena. If one asks whether they can believe in and accept the Dharma of signlessness, there is no truth in it at all.

Śāriputra, there is a certain monk who is old in years and endowed with goodness, a nāga among monks, possessed of profound wisdom. Such a person is able to believe in the Dharma of emptiness, which is the mark of nothingness, in the absence of the view of a self, and in the Dharma of no person. How is that? That person does not crave the many words of bustling crowds or company. He does not crave reading books, sleep, or many affairs. He does not take up the livelihood and affairs of white-clad laypeople. He does not serve as a messenger, carrying and delivering letters. He does not practice medicine, and he does not read medical treatises. He does not engage in trade for profit. He does not crave uttering and talking worldly talk. He has faith and delight only in teachings that transcend the world. Such a person is able to believe that all phenomena are empty, that all phenomena do not exist, are not possessed, and are not entered into. Such a person is then able to be established in the realm of genuine truth, and is able to roar the genuine lion's roar that accords with truth, not a jackal's cry.

Śāriputra, if there is a certain monk who is attached to the texts of ordinary writings, that person has abandoned the profound, sacred, supreme teaching of the Buddha; he is called one who recites the dharmas of the non-Buddhists and grasps at form. Even when he teaches for the sake of the multitude, he utters only a jackal's cry. Śāriputra, such an evil person is called by name 'a rotten śramaṇa.' Why? Because his is a non-Buddhist text, not the Dharma of

the Buddha. Śāriputra, a monk attached to the dharmas of the non-Buddhists ought not to say, 'I myself am a disciple of the Buddha.' Why? Because a monk who is a son of the Śākya does not teach the dharmas of the Nirgranthas; in the midst of the multitude he teaches only the Dharma of the Buddha. If a certain person is attached to impure words, even the lion's roar is taken for a jackal's cry, and that person cannot know the supreme texts of the Buddha's Dharma.

Śāriputra, I instruct you to discern this. A certain person keeps moral discipline, is accomplished in meditative concentration, and is complete in wisdom and right conduct. He is not miserly and not greedy; he is not attached through aversion or delusion; he does not nurture hypocrisy; he has a mind that has turned away from evil. He speaks words of genuine truth and always loves to dwell alone. He does not crave lying down and sleeping. He craves the practice of emptiness, signlessness, wishlessness, and non-cessation. A mind longing for the profound arises in him, and he seeks to know the supreme texts of the Buddha's Dharma. He takes no delight in worldly words but has faith in words that transcend the world. Holding the precepts of moral discipline completely, he keeps far from and abandons all evil affairs and all evil friends. By dwelling in such a Dharma, he is able to know the Dharma of emptiness, of nothing whatsoever. Why? Śāriputra, that practice is called the practice of a great person. It is not greed for the profit of a livelihood, nor craving for gain; it is not the conduct of deluded, foolish ordinary people. It is not the conduct of corrupt and ruined śramaṇas. It is not the conduct of straw-thatch śramaṇas. It is not the conduct of illusory śramaṇas in name only.

Śāriputra, the true characteristic of all dharmas, ultimately empty, is the path of the buddhas. One who craves worldly wealth and gain, and whose dharma is impure, cannot attain it. Śāriputra, it is called the ground of great wisdom. It is not the dharma of the greedy and craving non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), which is the ground for the view of a self and for teaching a person.

Śāriputra, if the view of a self were true, if there really were a view of a person, then, since there would be a true characteristic, it would be right to question those who teach the view of a self and the view of a person as one questions something real. If there were a self, what color would it be? Would it be blue, yellow, red or white? Does it dwell inside the body? Does it dwell outside the body? Does it pervade the body? Is it like butter in milk? Śāriputra, butter in milk can be drawn out and can be shown. If the self dwelt within, then those who teach that a self exists ought to explain it and ought to show it, just as

butter is drawn out of milk and the butter is shown. But in the supreme scriptures, though one searches for a self, it cannot be found.

Therefore, understand this. The person who teaches that a self and a person exist does not have even the discipline of a renunciant, let alone that of a monk. Śāriputra, understand this. One who desires what is crooked is attached to the view of a self, attached to sentient beings, attached to life, and falls into the state called the summit. Since such a person desires what is crooked, he cannot even examine his mind greedy for gain and offerings, let alone the subtle workings of sorrow and turmoil.

Śāriputra, if anyone says that one who has realized emptiness is covered by attachment, aversion, delusion and gain and offerings, that is not true at all. He will never fall into the state called the summit.

Śāriputra, attachment to a mind that views a self means saying that there is a life. Through the causes and conditions of a life, one is entangled by gain and offerings, and the path is obscured and cut off.

Śāriputra, those who hold the view of a self and the view of a person have gone forth from home in my Dharma, and though they practice the Dharma, such deluded people have not gone forth within what is pure. Why is that? Those who have gone forth from a worldly household are all attached to the idea of "I" and hold that there is something to attain. Śāriputra, holding that there is something to attain, they have always seen things that way through lifetimes without beginning. Even after going forth it is still there, so why would they not proclaim it? Such a person is called one who has gone forth on the side of the non-Buddhists. He is not called one who has gone forth on the side of the noble ones. Why is that? A person who is covered over cannot trust and have faith in the great Dharma; he has no perception of the genuine truth of the pure great Dharma.

Śāriputra, because the remnant of the misdeeds of the heavy sin of destroying the Dharma has not been exhausted, through its causes and conditions such a person cannot trust and understand the true characteristic of all dharmas. Unwholesome karma stirs, and at times he disparages the wondrous eightfold right path. At times he gives rise to evil thoughts toward the monks, and the fault of his falsehood arises: at times he says, "They are corrupt in discipline, corrupt in view, corrupt in livelihood, corrupt in conduct." At times, without seeing any fault in others, he gives rise to false and improper thoughts. At times he indulges in thoughts of aversion and jealousy and speaks ill of others.

At times, because he cannot understand the letters, texts and manner of the Buddha's Dharma, he says, "This is not the Buddha's Dharma." Because such a person has completed the evil path of destroying the Dharma, he cannot be without obstruction of mind toward the supreme scriptures of the Buddha; he does not enter them and takes no delight in them.

Through the causes and conditions of the remnant of retribution for such a heavy sin, although he practices diligence, if he cannot even take up the sign of any condition, how much less can he attain the fruit of the place where the mind is fixed! Moreover, he relies on the view of a self and the view of a person. With such a view, if one cannot even think of reaching the root source of the buddhas and those below them, how much less can one attain its offspring!

Śāriputra, if one sees in such a greedy and attached person unwholesome crookedness, that is the view of a self, the view of a person, the view of a sentient being and the view of a life. Moreover, he is terrified of and doubts the supreme scripture of emptiness; it is evident that this person, in former lives, accumulated the sinful conditions of destroying the Dharma.

Śāriputra, if some person has such evil, crooked, unwholesome desire, he is attached to the view of a self, attached to a person, attached to life. Even if hundreds, thousands and hundreds of thousands of buddhas were to employ the three wheels and teach such a person directly, they could not make him understand nor make him attain the fruit of the path.

Śāriputra, of the two, it would be easier to have one's tongue cut off with a sharp sword. It is not right to look at the affairs of others. Do not speak of their faults: corrupt in discipline, corrupt in view, corrupt in livelihood, corrupt in conduct.

Śāriputra, in the future there will be certain monks who keep the two hundred and fifty precepts well, yet they will give rise to a lazy mind and think thus: "I am a holder of discipline; other people are not like that." So they despise others and have no respect in their minds. They think, "I am learned; that fellow is not learned." Śāriputra, at that time there will be many monks who hold discipline and think highly of themselves, and many who practice the life of the wilderness (araṇya). They will be able to keep discipline well and will practice as it is taught; with a diligent mind they will read the scriptures and pay homage to the Buddha's Dharma. Because many such people become learned, they look at the wilderness dwellers and indulge their aversion. Their

minds always thinking stained thoughts, they are greedy to enter deeply and nurture minds of hateful malice. Arrogant and foolish, they know nothing at all. Acting on small causes and conditions, they stir up great matters. With aversion covering their minds, they bring up faults against one another: corrupt in discipline, corrupt in view, corrupt in livelihood, corrupt in conduct.

Śāriputra, suppose that within such a Saṅgha there are certain monks who live in its midst with no crookedness of mind. Because they live among those bad ones, they too are caught up in endless quarrels as each slanders the other. Those who sit in meditation and those who read the Dharma texts never hear the truth, and those who live at home and those who have gone forth are all thrown into turmoil.

Thus, Śāriputra, when there are many monks of one year, two years, three years, up to nine years, they despise even those seated above them and show them no respect. When people take the precepts, many novice disciples do not act in accordance with the Dharma either, and they show no respect to their preceptors and ācāryas.

Śāriputra, at that time young monks and those who went forth earlier, having no one to rely on, despise one another. Toward a monk of ten years' standing, the disciples who have broken away and all the disciples of others show no respect. Nor do they practice the rules of conduct in accordance with the Dharma.

Śāriputra, at that time bad people, full of desire and anger, despise one another while claiming purity of conduct. Because they have no respect and oppose one another, my Dharma fades away.

Śāriputra, at that time deluded people stir up much evil through the evil karma of destroying the Dharma, and by stirring up evil they fall in the end into the bad destinies.

Śāriputra, I instruct you, making the distinction plain. If he has been seeking his own merit, a good monk at that time should not stay among the ordinary crowd for even a single night. The exceptions are arhats who have put an end to sorrow, and those who have a purpose in being there among the bad monks. Why is this? Śāriputra, the people of that time will abound in the poisons of desire, anger and delusion. Being unwise, they sink to the depths of fear, terror and poverty, and so they do not seek virtue. Each dwells apart in the mountains and in empty, secluded groves, and when life runs out they die like wild beasts.

Śāriputra, I instruct you, making the distinction plain. This true Dharma of mine will not remain long in the world. Why is this? Because the roots of virtue that are the glorious goodness of beings have been exhausted, and the time of turbidity is near. If he has been seeking merit for himself, a good monk should give rise to this weariness of mind: "Whenever I see the Dharma thrown into such disorder, whenever I see the śramaṇas of such a time fallen under the obstacles of an evil age, I shall give rise to a mind of diligence and swiftly attain the fruit of the path."

Śāriputra, in my Dharma there is no other difficult matter: do not concern yourselves with clothing, food, bedding and medicine. You and the others who practice to accomplish the Buddha's path by whatever means, do not prize worldly gain of wealth and offerings!

Śāriputra, now listen well, for I am instructing you. If a certain monk practices the path single-mindedly, all the gods of heaven throughout the trichiliocosm, of one accord, gather every requisite for his comfort and together present him with offerings. Śāriputra, the offerings that other people make to a monk who sits in meditation cannot match the offerings made by the gods of heaven. Therefore, Śāriputra, do not grieve over failing to obtain offerings. Practice without transgression, just as you have been truly trained, and while practicing the supreme scripture of emptiness, let no sorrow over the faults of people arise. Why is this? Śāriputra, the attainment of emptiness is the great obstacle to anxiety.

Some monks, by virtue of practicing my Dharma, go forth from home, take the precepts and practice diligently in this Dharma. Although gods, asuras and humans do not remember them, they are able to practice the path single-mindedly and with diligence, and to the very end they do not worry about what clothing and food they need. Why is this? Because the glorious treasury of the Tathāgata is immeasurable and hard to exhaust.

Śāriputra, after the Tathāgata has passed away, the white hair mark between his brows is divided into hundreds, thousands and hundreds of thousands of parts, and by a single one of those parts offerings are made to his relics and his disciples. Śāriputra, even if all the people of the whole world were to go forth from home and practice in accordance with the Dharma, not even that single part of the white hair mark, out of its hundreds, thousands and hundreds of thousands of parts, would be exhausted. Śāriputra, such is the immeasurable glory and virtue of the Tathāgata, so that when the monks

receive food and whatever goods they need, all who turn toward it can be fully provided in accordance with the rules.

Śāriputra, those monks should think as follows: "It is not fitting to practice bad dharmas for the sake of the goods we need and a crooked livelihood."

Śāriputra, when a monk who wears patched robes gathers old, worn rags from dung heaps and rubbish and takes them up, he should think as follows: "If I use this to cover myself and practice the noble path, then I shall now use these old rags, stitch them into a Dharma robe, and practice with diligence. An ordinary worldling is not fit to wear this for even a single night."

When that monk has washed it clean and worn it for a long time, if a mind of attachment toward it arises in that patched-robe monk, he should discard it immediately. If I do not permit him to wear even this, what need is there to mention other clothing? Why is this? Śāriputra, if that monk gives rise to what is not the dharma of a monk with regard to that robe, and that monk himself holds it unfit to go about in, what need is there to mention other goods? Śāriputra, at that time that monk holds: "It would be easier to have my body bound with a noose of red-hot iron; it is not fitting to wear this patched robe." Why so? Because his mind craves and clings to this robe.

Śāriputra, a monk who wears patched robes should think as follows: "Wearing this patched robe, which shields me from cold and heat, I devote myself to practicing the path. Without putting on another robe, I shall attain the fruit of stream-entry, the fruit of once-returning, the fruit of non-returning and the fruit of arhatship."

Śāriputra, to such a patched-robe monk who seeks the path single-mindedly, I too give permission to wear it.

Śāriputra, a monk who seeks alms does not dwell on any dharmas whatsoever. Constantly gathering his mind, he does not let it fall into regret and agitation.

When entering a village, one practices in keeping with those accomplished in meditation and begs for food with proper composure. Once one has received it, with a mind that is not attached and without asking for anything, one takes whatever food one has received, leaves the village, and sits down by clean water in a place suitable for practicing the path. One sets the food to one side, washes one's feet, and sits down. Then one places the food in front of oneself, and one should give rise to the perception of weariness and detachment, the perception of impurity, the perception of excrement and filth, the perception

of foul rot, the perception of vomit, the perception of salve smeared on a wound, the perception of something received as a protection, the perception of the flesh of one's own child, the perception of rotten fruit, and the perception of a heavy debt to be repaid. Alternatively, one should give rise toward the body to the perception of death, the perception of bluish discoloration, the perception of pus, and the perception of rotting and disintegration. Śāriputra, a monk should give rise to perceptions such as these.

Practicing with a mind free of desire, only then should one eat, and only to keep the body steady and to ward off hunger and thirst. One should achieve the practice of the path. One should think in this way: "I have received this food in order to destroy past suffering and not give rise to future suffering, to attain joy and happiness of mind, to live free of illness, and so that, though the body be weak, it may be refreshed and its movements easy and steady." "Having received this food, I should attain the fruit of stream-entry, the fruit of once-returning, the fruit of non-returning, the fruit of arhatship, and acceptance of the unborn nature of phenomena." Śāriputra, to a monk who eats in that way I give permission to beg for food.

Śāriputra, consider a begging monk in whom a mind attached to the taste of all the food he receives arises, who thinks, "It is delicious and sweet," and who thinks, "By eating this food I will gain a fine complexion and flourishing vigor and strength," but who does not think, "Having eaten this food of mine, I will diligently practice the noble path." To a monk like that I do not give permission even to sip or take water, so what need is there to speak of food? Śāriputra, for one who eats carelessly, not seeing the faults and the harm in food, it would be easier, by comparison, to cut flesh from his own thigh with his own hand and eat it. Why is that? Because I permit the accepting of others' offerings through practice and attainment; I do not permit other people to accept them.

Śāriputra, what is called practice? A certain monk is steadfast and unwavering, and with a single-pointed mind, here in the present time, he cuts off those sent by the evil Māra and practices the wondrous path that enters nirvāṇa without remainder, like one whose head is on fire seeking rescue. Alternatively, cutting off and removing unwholesome, evil dharmas is called practice. Further, alternatively, being able with a single-pointed mind to have faith in and understand emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness, and, in order to attain the fruit of stream-entry, the fruit of once-returning, the fruit of non-returning, and the fruit of arhatship, cutting off the sorrows and agitations of people: that

is called practice. Seeking wholesome dharmas and constantly asking questions is called practice. Further, alternatively, being able to stir the mind toward complete liberation is called practice. There is training in the practice of the dharmas that direct the agitated mind onto the path, practicing in accordance with the teaching of all the dharmas, and in that practice seeking the Buddha's path single-mindedly. Śāriputra, within the Buddha's Dharma, that too is called practice.

As for what is called attainment: attaining stream-entry and being freed from the three lower realms is called attainment. Once-returners, non-returners, and arhats have cut off sorrows and agitations; when all that is called "the seeking of the path has been pacified" has been achieved, one who has become well practiced in the three trainings is called a trainee, and I permit that person to accept offerings. When a person such as this accepts offerings, that is called accepting offerings virtuously.

Śāriputra, there is keeping moral discipline purely, explaining to patrons, and hearing the recitation and reading of the texts of the divisions of the sūtras, namely: the division of sūtras, the division of verses sung in melody, the division of explanations, the division of verses, the division of inspired utterances, the division of introductions, and the dharma of the words "thus it was"; the division of birth stories, the division of extensive teachings, the division of marvels, and the division of narratives.

Further, alternatively, such a person is able to hold moral discipline purely: flawless, unstained, untroubled, unattached and self-governed, praised by the wise, able to complete the rites by himself, not contravening it, just as one accomplished in meditation, and at the proper times delighting to remain in meditation. To a monk like that I too give permission to receive offerings.

Śāriputra, when one knows the Dharma with one's body, there is no doubt and no regret, and to a person like that I give permission to sit on a high seat and teach the Dharma. Though one is an ordinary person, one holds moral discipline purely, the mind is not attached to the doctrines of the non-Buddhists, and one is single-mindedly diligent and virtuous. The best of śramaṇas has cut off concern for results and is not attached to the gain of livelihood; he is skilled in definitive explanation; his vast learning is like the great ocean; even if it comes to losing his life he does not speak lies; he takes no delight in quarrels and disputes; he benefits himself and benefits others as well; he teaches and explains only the supreme, pure doctrine, and he

practices in accordance with that supreme doctrine just as it is. Śāriputra, to one who teaches in this way I give permission to teach the Dharma. He is able to keep whatever the Tathāgata has taught from contradicting or reversing any of the dharmas. He has moral discipline, meditative concentration, wisdom, and liberation, and he is liberated also through knowledge and vision.

Śāriputra, if a monk who seeks gain, having gone forth from home for the sake of the Buddha, breaks the chapter on moral discipline, what need is there to speak of teaching the Dharma? Why is that? Śāriputra, as is explained in the texts of my Dharma, if a certain person who is not himself virtuously at peace and is unable to be careful himself were to say, "I am able to bring other people to virtuous peace and to accomplish this," there would be no truth in it. It is like a person who has himself sunk in a swamp trying to pull another out: there is no truth in it. If a certain person is able to be virtuously at peace himself and is able to get out of the swamp, then his pulling others out has truth in it. Therefore, Śāriputra, I instruct you to discern the distinction.

If someone mocks and disparages the Tathāgata, that evil is not light. A monk who speaks the truth is fit to be permitted to teach the Dharma. A monk who does not lie and who keeps moral discipline is able to give the gift of the Dharma. Śāriputra, to teach the Dharma from a high seat and to cut through doubts truly and decisively is the task of a teacher within this teaching. I have not permitted those whose keeping of discipline is impure and who are attached to the scriptures of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas). Nor have I permitted those who lie, who hold worldly comfort precious, who seek profit from offerings, and who crave quarrels and disputes. Those who keep discipline purely, whose minds are straight and firm, and who have realized the true characteristic of all phenomena, I permit to teach the Dharma from a high seat.

Śāriputra, a monk whose discipline is broken would do better to give up the precepts. Let him not hide and conceal the stain of evil beneath the marks of a noble one and the Dharma robes, doing much that is wrong while clinging to the gifts that others give in faith. Śāriputra, for the sake of small causes and conditions, he will take on the body of a hell being for a long time.

This is chapter ten, the chapter on entrustment.

At that time Nanda said to the Buddha, "Blessed One, in those times, how will the monks apply diligence to virtuous dharmas?"

The Buddha said to Nanda, "Set that aside for now, and do not ask. Why? If the monks of that time cannot even believe all the Dharma texts of immeasurable wisdom that the Buddha has taught, what need is there to say that they cannot practice with diligence?

Nanda, all the wisdom of the Dharma that is the Tathāgata's activity cannot be understood or known by pratyekabuddhas, by all the arhats, or by any others. Nanda, if all the dharmas that the Tathāgata knows were explained to you, even you might well be confused and bewildered; what need is there to say that they could not be believed? As for such Dharma texts as the Tathāgata has taught in this way, if the deluded people of that time do not even believe them, what need is there to say that they cannot believe them and give an answer to their own delusion?

Nanda, that is how things are by nature: being pleased with themselves, they call others bad. The diligent monks of that generation will not be able to equal even the lazy monks of the present day. They will be unable to keep discipline at all or to develop wisdom. If the Tathāgata were to describe all the wicked misdeeds those people have committed, and all the bodies they will turn into and take on, those people would not believe it, and their heavy evil would only be stirred up. Even you and the others would be terrified. All the misery they will undergo cannot be measured.

Nanda, it is difficult to receive the profound Dharma from the Tathāgata. What do you think? Does a pig crave a fine couch, or not?"

"Blessed One, it does not crave it."

"Excellent. Nanda, this Dharma of my unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening is profound and sublime, and it is what the wise long for. But those people are unable to believe it, know it, and understand it. Although they have gone forth from home and call themselves śramaṇas, they cannot receive the teaching and training as it truly is. They cannot reform their minds in this Dharma. Not obtaining its delicious taste, they brush off their hands and leave, falling into bad paths and remaining there. This is like a pig abandoning a fine couch.

Why? Nanda, my unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening is utterly pure and hard to teach, and so it cannot be believed and known. Those who are hard to tame, those without wisdom, those hard to satisfy, those hard to cure, those whose discipline is broken, those hard to advise, those attached to crooked teachings, those who follow crooked conduct, those who make much

of the profit of wealth, those who regard clothing and food as supreme, those whose conduct is ruined, those whose discipline is broken, those who have fallen into the ways of worldly people, those ruined by wickedness, the lazy, those of meager aspiration, the shameless who speak of disgraceful things, those entangled with weapons or worldly affairs, the white-robed laymen among the śramaṇas, the outcasts among the śramaṇas, those among the śramaṇas who walk crooked paths, those who are not śramaṇas yet say of themselves, 'I am a śramaṇa,' those deceived by Māra, those in accord with the scriptures of non-Buddhists, those who do not practice as taught, those who crave to possess much, those who crave idle chatter, those who act in keeping with Māra's aims, those whose minds are stirred up by Māra, those torn by grief and turmoil, those with the view of a self, those with the view of a person, those with the view of a sentient being, and those with distorted views: if it is asked whether such people could believe, know and realize this Dharma of mine, that is never true.

Why? Nanda, because my unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening is pure, satisfying to the heart, and vast, it cannot be matched with these wicked people. Nanda, it is like the wide and long expanse of hundreds, thousands, and hundreds of thousands of great trichiliocosmic world systems. The distance these wicked people have put between themselves and the Dharma of a monk is just like that. What need is there to say that they will not attain conforming patience and nirvāṇa? Nanda, a matter like this could never be exhausted by explanation.

The wicked, lowest śramaṇas of the future will greatly foster stinginess and greed. They will greatly foster aversion. They will greatly foster unbelief. With the three poisons flourishing in their minds, their conduct coarse and their hearts malicious, they will be hard to reform and tame. Nanda, it is like burning, with one's own fire, a fertile field that has ripened well. It is like pouring poison, with one's own hand, into delicious white food. If one were to burn with fire one's own house, filled with everything one owns, would that be right or not?"

"Blessed One, it would not be right."

"Nanda, just so, when the deluded people of the future have obtained offerings by means of my Dharma, then, on top of not believing and not knowing the Tathāgata's excellent meaning, they will be unable to believe Dharma texts such as this one. They will be unable to bear having their faults pointed out as

they truly are.

When the scab of their wound is picked and peeled away, they turn against my words. Such deluded people rely on the Buddha, yet they seek only for themselves and reject that Dharma. Nanda, at that time Jambudvīpa will be filled to overflowing with such deluded people. Nanda, leave that aside for now. What is to be done with such evil and deluded people, who long for birth, long for old age, and seek to pursue evil ends?

Then Nanda asked the Buddha, "Blessed One, what is this Dharma text to be called, and how are we to retain it with respect?"

The Buddha said to Nanda, "This Dharma text is called Buddha's Treasury. It is also called Setting Diligence in Motion. It is also called Subduing Those of Degenerate and Broken Moral Discipline. It is also called Instruction on All Dharmas. Retain it with respect.

"Nanda, if any person recites and retains this Dharma text, the good he gains is immeasurable and boundless. Why is that? Since a monk of broken moral discipline cannot even believe in it, recite it, read it, or teach it to others, how much less can he take delight in it! Why is that? Nanda, it is like an evil thief, who does not dare to show himself before a king or a great king. When he has stolen the goods of others, he does not say, 'I am a thief.' In just the same way, Nanda, when a monk of broken moral discipline has acquired wealth by means contrary to the Dharma of an ascetic, he still does not say, 'I am wicked.' How much less would he dare to declare to others, 'I am a sinner!' Nanda, when a Dharma text such as this is able to unsettle the monk of broken moral discipline, the monks who have a sense of shame and gratitude and who keep moral discipline will themselves arise and flourish."

When this Dharma text was taught, ninety thousand gods all obtained the pure Dharma eye regarding all dharmas. The evil Māra and all his kin and friends were stirred with great grief, as if they had fallen into sixteen kinds of great pit. Weeping loudly, Māra said, "Śramaṇa Gautama, I know, I understand. Day and night I have always aspired that after the Buddha has passed away the keepers of moral discipline would be destroyed, and the breaking of moral discipline would be praised; that evil monks would not understand the Buddha's Dharma and would know only how to recite and read; that they would destroy the sincere mind toward the Buddha's Dharma and say in words, 'This is not the Buddha's Dharma; it has no scriptural basis anywhere in the four directions.' Gautama, in the midst of an assembly of gods, humans,

and a great multitude, you have set a guard over this Dharma and thwarted my aspiration."

When Māra had finished speaking, he was filled with unhappy grief and turmoil, and he vanished at once.

Then, to make this meaning clear, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

All the dharmas I have taught
Accord with the supreme scripture and do not contradict it.
Whatever is conditioned is not firm;
It is like something seen in a dream.

Now I have taught this Dharma text,
Engaging the aims of the future and driving off evil;
In accord with the supreme scripture, not contradicting it,
I have made it an admonition for evil people.

In that evil time,
The minds of monks will be agitated and wavering;
Fighting, disputing, lacking faith,
They will be unable to attain nirvāṇa.

Between monks and the white-robed laity
There will be no difference in all they teach.
At that time this Dharma of mine
Will be no different from ordinary teachings.

What they teach, they will teach for the sake of household life.
They will say to you, "What I have is rare;
Within my Buddha Dharma
One first attains the supreme fruit of the path."

Then a certain monk will say,
"Even if it does not accord with the path I have taught,
Whoever agrees with me is right,
For I am one who sees the true Dharma."

Whether they have seen the Dharma or not,
Through the conduct of the white-robed ones,
Each within his own teaching,
Their ways and their speech arise.

Some say that everything exists;
Some say that everything is empty.
Not abiding on the straight path,
With their evil natures they destroy my Dharma.

Do not go near such people!
It is right to come to me and attend on me.
If the true Dharma is taught to you,
Your nature will swiftly change and you will attain the path.

Such sounds and cries
spread everywhere, near and far.
Like-minded, yet turning against their companions,
they destroy all the Dharma taught for its time.
Just as wicked thieves
make friends of others as wicked as themselves,
and, perverse and hostile, lay waste the lands,
the cities and the villages and homes,
so the monks of that time,
though they may manage to analyze and teach,
are fettered by dull faculties;
their wisdom is slight and they cannot be relied on.
As the Tathāgata practiced,
so they do not know how to explain the Dharma;
they declare where those with defilements will be born,
or say, "This one has attained the path."
They sit amid great gatherings;
monks are many,
and all of them say, "We have wisdom,"
yet not a single one seeks wisdom.
Within that great gathering
there may be one or a few monks
who know the true reality;
all the rest go about their practice without wisdom.
The gods, asuras and spirits see
that the path of the Dharma King has been destroyed.
All of them are in grief and turmoil,
and facing one another they weep in tears.
All the tree gods among them

come down from the treetops to the ground.
All of them say: "Of the Lion of the Śākyas
the true Dharma has come wholly to an end.
The Three Jewels, the Buddha and the rest,
have not lasted long in the world.
How is it that today all of them
are spent, scattered and destroyed?
The Dharma that the Tathāgata taught
we and others will never hear again.
Who has knowledge free of foolish dullness?"
They think there is none among the teachers.
Then the earth deities
raise a great cry
and say: "The great lamp of the Tathāgata's Dharma
is now spent among humankind."
The gods, asuras and spirits,
though they have not seen or heard it, take up the cry:
"From now on, do not grieve;
the Buddha's path is already gone.
For countless eons the Buddha
gave up his own life and was slain by others;
he took on all suffering with patience
and made the aspiration to attain buddhahood.
The Lion of the Śākyas, worker of wonders,
delivered all sentient beings,
yet his pure Dharma is brought to nothing:
all the deluded and wicked foes
have gained power over it.
Lacking minds of love and compassion,
they slander and stir up one another.
Māra's people, put to work by Māra,
with dull faculties, find the Dharma hard to discern.
Deceitful, heedless, lazy of mind,
in anger they destroy even the Buddha's Dharma.
Having merely, in empty groves and forests,
sat in meditation for three years,
they declare themselves arhats.

Though they master meditation, if they lack the three,
what need is there to speak of attaining the path?
Those said to have attained the path of seeing
are said, when they die, to have passed into nirvāṇa;
everyone believes it and builds them stūpas,
yet it is said those beings have gone to hell.
Some such deluded, empty ones
despise and rage at one another.
All that I attained
over countless eons is now spent."
Now the gods of the sky see
that the true Dharma of the Lion of the Śākya clan
has declined and collapsed;
all raise their voices and weep in tears.
When the divine lords of the four quarters hear it,
all of them too are in grief and turmoil.
Then the gods, asuras and spirits
all come down.
Indeed, to the dwelling of the city
all the blazing gods and spirits come;
all of them weep loudly in tears
and raise a dreadful cry.
Their palaces of the seven precious substances,
polished, adorned and surpassingly fine,
lose their color and become like earth.
The gods, losing heart in saṃsāra,
joyless, wail and loudly weep.
All come from their own abodes and gather;
each is in grief and turmoil;
seeing one another, they cannot speak.
Coming down from all their abodes,
together they went to the place where I was born;
coming and going, lying and sitting on the ground, they stayed there,
and raised their voices, saying this:
"Together we went to Jambudvīpa
and saw such great terror:
the Buddha's children fight and quarrel,

and destroying the Dharma, they split into separate factions."
The gods and spirits and their jeweled palaces
were without luster for seven days.
Each sat with the others and wept;
for seven days they did not rise.
"How great was his diligence,
heroic and steadfast, the venerable one of the world!
We sit here now;
from now on we shall not see him."
All went together to Jetavana,
and facing one another they wept in tears:
"Here the Buddha taught the truth as it is.
We who were within it,
the blind of the world's darkness,
despise and rage at one another,
set in motion only evil deeds,
and fall again into the lower realms.
All the fine palaces of the gods
were empowered by that noble one;
we gods, asuras and spirits
have no help for the whole eon."
At that time Jambudvīpa
declines and collapses and loses its splendor.
On the walking paths, at the foot of trees,
in mountains and in caves, no one practices virtue.
When the whole world is spent,
all is greatly stirred and shaken.
The lords of the gods and asuras
utter cries dreadful and terrifying.
Then the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three,
raising their hands, weep in sorrow;
within their own palaces too
they cry out, wailing and calling:
"In the palaces of the gods
we spoke and declared:
like a rainbow, we are parted from the Lord of great wonders,
who afterward taught us the Dharma."

In the divine realm of the Thirty-Three, for six months,
they do not eat the food of their pleasures;
the music of cymbals is no longer sweet;
they are joyless, as though someone had died.
All the asuras,
hearing such news,
each gathering all his servants,
set out to attack the gods of the Thirty-Three.
Then the kings of Jambudvīpa
will fight and quarrel with one another;
the gods and the asuras too
likewise fight and quarrel with one another.
At that time many monks and nuns
fall through their deeds into the lower realms;
few are freed from them.
Beings who break moral discipline
follow along after the bad monks;
because they act on those causes and conditions,
all of them too head for the lower realms.
All the bad laymen too,
because they followed bad preceptors,
also go to the lower realms.
Because the whole world is in turmoil and upheaval,
some enter cities and towns,
some go off to mountains and groves;
east and west they live in sorrow,
and their lives are harmed.
At that time there are enemies
and many kinds of perilous roads.
The five kinds of grain, millet, barley and the rest, though sown, do not sprout;
even when they have sprouted, they are eaten by vermin.
At that time many in the world
die of hunger and starvation;
those who fall among the wretched hungry ghosts
suffer long and are afflicted.
At that time people
divide up and consume as they please

the wealth of the Buddha's stūpas
and the offerings given to the Saṅgha of the four directions.
Such now is the Saṅgha.

Nanda, you and all the others,
rouse yourselves and practice diligence.
When the later age runs to its end,
it is not fitting that you should witness
such evil practices as these.
Ordinary people, every one of them,
are deluded and foolish, without wisdom.
They engage in the deeds of ordinary people
and swiftly fall into the evil paths.
Amid the turmoil, apply yourselves to recitation.
Its eye is the cause of wisdom.
Through the virtues of wisdom
you will swiftly reach the abode of the Victor.
What I have seen and trained in throughout the six worlds,
you too should train in likewise.
If you cut through the veils that obscure the world,
you will swiftly reach the abode of the Victor.
If you diligently practice the eightfold noble path,
you will swiftly attain nirvāṇa.
Seeking the Dharma, I sought merit;
all that I have taught is just so.
After this eon has passed,
for sixty eons there will be no buddha.
There will not even be the sound or the word "buddha,"
so what need is there to speak of attaining the path?
At that time all the people,
tormented by hunger and famine,
without respect, without a loving mind,
will eat even the flesh of mother and child.
At that time the children of each household
will be constantly guarded, for fear that others will eat them.
Having heard of such an evil time,
who would still bring about birth and death?

The mother of suffering is delusion;
the mother of the five aggregates is attachment.
If one places no faith in the five objects of desire,
all wanting and clinging are cut off,
and one attains the path, the glorious fruit.
When a deep mind of wanting and clinging arises,
then through the causes and conditions of attachment
evil is stirred, and one falls into the evil paths.
Undefiled phenomena are empty and at peace;
the world becomes without solidity.
If you know and understand it in this way,
you and the others should practice swiftly.
Where there is no mind, the perception of a mind arises,
and they themselves become terrified and afraid.
"I did not cultivate thoughts of love;
what does this mean?"
When ordinary people such as these
reflect, ponder, and weigh the course they have run,
thinking, "What have I done?",
they weep tears constantly.
Where there are no aggregates, the perception of aggregates arises;
where there is no "I," the perception of an "I" arises.
They hear the Dharma that their own marks are empty,
yet even so, though they train, they are bewildered.
The truth taught by the Buddha,
the scripture on the aggregates, they do not understand.
They think, "Even if I hear it, nothing will change."
In a place of fear they have no thought of fear.
I have taught the past, the future, and the present:
the aggregates are all empty,
and the three times are spent and wholly equal,
like, for example, empty space.
All the buddhas there were in the past
likewise taught emptiness day and night.
The buddhas of the future
likewise will teach emptiness day and night.
Those like me who appear in the world,

though they teach all phenomena,
teach that essential nature and characteristics are empty.
Unequaled throughout the three times
are all the true scriptures the Buddha has taught,
yet the people of the future will not know them.
Because they cling to an "I" and to sentient beings,
in the end they will fall into the evil paths.
Such is the time to come:
greatly evil, and truly to be feared.
You and the others, practice diligence,
and act so that you do not see such an evil time!

When the Buddha had finished teaching this Dharma text, the elder and venerable Śāriputra, the monks, the nuns, the gods of the world, and the great multitude of people all heard everything the Buddha had taught. They were all overjoyed, and they accepted with faith what the Buddha had taught.

Here ends Buddha's Treasury, taught by the Buddha. It comprises one thousand two hundred ślokas, arranged in four fascicles.

Translator's Notes

• This text appears to be an early Tibetan translation made from Chinese, hence unusual vocabulary. The mountain written □□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as Vulture Peak (Gṛdhrakūṭa), which the Chinese version names as the setting; the Tibetan form itself is obscure. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, repeated as the refrain, is rendered "rarer still"; its literal sense is unclear. In the lotus simile, □□□□ is read as "held up, suspended", and "fine as a thread of rain" is a tentative rendering of □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□. Śāriputra's opening reply, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, is uncertain and is rendered "it is not that anything is real."
• The phrase rendered "there is no turmoil" translates the obscure archaic term □□□□□□□□, whose exact sense is uncertain. The term rendered "mingling" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is likewise archaic and its precise meaning uncertain. This text belongs to the early layer of translations from Chinese, and its vocabulary is often non-standard.
• This text was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its Tibetan is often unidiomatic. In "no sage, and no root of the sage," the word □□□□□ may stand for another Chinese term, such as "endurance" or "capacity." The sentence about "the source, the root of all that is expressed in comparisons" and "cannot even be reckoned" is obscure in the Tibetan, and the rendering is tentative. In "it dispels all recollecting and thinking," the verb is read as □□□ ("dispels") in place of □□□□, which makes little sense here and is matched by the parallel □□□ in the next clause. The bad teacher's instruction □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "empty and nonexistent."
• This Tibetan was translated from a Chinese text, the Buddha Treasury Sūtra, and its wording is often unusual. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered literally as "because there is no hearing"; its exact sense is uncertain. In □□□□□□□□□ the syllable □□□ appears to be a slip for □□□ ("a certain"), and it is translated that way. The sentence is understood as the familiar teaching

that even the five heinous acts are preferable to clinging to views of a self. The "five heinous wrongs" are presumably the five deeds of immediate retribution. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "the dharma of illusion"; the underlying Chinese term is uncertain. In the final paragraph, □□□□□□□□□ is taken as rendering the "true" or "right" of "unsurpassed, true and perfect awakening" (anuttarā samyaksaṃbodhi), not as "eternal."

• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its idiom follows the Chinese. "Recollection of the Buddha" and "abode of recollection" render terms that stand for buddhānusmṛti and a foundation of mindfulness. The pair "feeling and examination" follows the house rendering, but it most likely reflects the Chinese pair for vitarka and vicāra, initial and sustained thought. The phrase rendered "subtle and wondrous, free of conceptualization" is uncertain. The chapter colophon reads "third chapter, on recollecting the Dharma" as it stands in this text, although the content preceding it concerns recollection of the Buddha.

• This sūtra appears to be translated into Tibetan from Chinese, which accounts for its unusual vocabulary. The word □□□□□□□□ is not standard Tibetan. From context it seems to correspond to "thought" or "recollection," and it is rendered "recollection." In □□□□□□□□□□□□□

sentences, is plainly intended. In the last paragraph the Tibetan reads "son of the true one"; this is taken as a slip for "Again, Śāriputra," as the parallel sentences and the following piece show. "Bringing across to extinction" renders a term meaning nirvāṇa, not the wrathful-rite sense of "liberating."

• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, which accounts for some unusual phrasing. Several terms follow Chinese originals: □□□□□□ renders pravāraṇā (the Chinese term for this rite means "self-surrender"), and □□□□□ in the list of five renders "aggregate" (skandha), as in the five pure aggregates. In that list, □□□□□, literally "sage" or "able," stands in the position of concentration (samādhi), and it is translated that way. □□□□□□□□□ ("seen in the east") is read as □□□□□□□□□□, "knowledge and vision," in line with the earlier list. The fraction describing the tiny offering is rendered closely, but the exact arithmetic of the Tibetan is unclear.

• This text appears to be a translation from Chinese, and its Tibetan is often archaic and unusual. The phrase rendered "is like a bat" contains the unclear word □□□□; the simile is interpreted from □□□□ "bat." The four kinds of worm are given in phonetic form because the names are unidentified, possibly transcriptions of Chinese. The word □□□□□□□ is rendered "pretense" tentatively. The sentence about the clay pot that ends with "give off a fragrance?" is taken as the Buddha's question, because Śāriputra answers it in the following sentence. The term □□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the eight unfavorable states (akṣaṇa), the opposite of the eight favorable conditions, and not as obstructing spirits.

• This sūtra appears to be translated from Chinese, which explains several unusual expressions. The four kinds of "laziness" (le lo) almost certainly render Chinese □, which means both "slow, lax" and "conceit"; doctrinally these are the kinds of pride (arrogance, the conceit of "I," great conceit, and perverse conceit), but the Tibetan says "laziness" and that has been kept. In the list of the five aggregates of the Dharma (discipline, concentration, wisdom, liberation, knowledge and vision of liberation), the Tibetan has thub pa ("ability" or "sage") in the place of concentration; it has been rendered "concentration" by the evident sense. The epithet "the six arrows of grief and turmoil" is rendered literally; its exact reference is unclear. The bad monk's quoted words ("This the Buddha spoke, but it is not a word to be taught to other people") are terse and ambiguous in the Tibetan; the rendering follows the parallel statements that he takes the teaching as aimed at himself and tells others it is not the Buddha's teaching.

• This Tibetan text was evidently translated from Chinese and is terse and at times obscure. The phrase rendered "the Byileu Palgapa" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) could not be identified; it appears to be a transliterated term, perhaps from the Chinese, and is given in phonetic form. □□□□□□ in the list with the aggregates and elements renders the Chinese "entrances," that is, the twelve āyatanas, translated here as "sense fields." The words of the lazy pseudo-arhats to the young monks continue into the next piece, so the quotation is left open.

• The Tibetan of this sūtra is an archaic and often awkward rendering, apparently from Chinese, and several sentences are hard to construe. The sentence about the Tathāgata being "openly scorned and disparaged" uses an instrumental that could also make the Tathāgata the speaker of a reproach; the passive reading was chosen as fitting the following lines. The guards' sentence in the honey simile ("Even if I got it and did not eat it...") and the line about evil people "exerting open power" but being unable to "give fearlessness" are obscure and are rendered closely. "The marks of the five" followed by "the marks of the five aggregates" appears to be a near-repetition in the source and is kept as written.

• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its archaic Tibetan is often obscure. In the long list of epithets, several are uncertain. "A mere speculator among the śramaṇas," "one who lingers on the margins," "one who is always flattering," "befogged" and "one who consorts with women and with signs" are tentative readings. "The chaff of śramaṇas" takes the

unclear word sbang rna in the light of a stock Chinese sūtra epithet.

"Nothing indestructible" renders mi 'jigs pa'i chos med, read in its list of permanence and unchangingness as "not destroyed" rather than "fearless." The phrase rendered "no 'I' and no place for a 'mine'" is also uncertain.

In the explanation of "empty" (stong pa), the text glosses the word with "lost" (stor ba). This is probably a play on words or a reflex of the Chinese original, and it is kept as written.

• The answer "the times of aversion are many" stands as written, though the parallel answers before it would lead one to expect "the times without aversion are many." The phrase rendered "in this present life" and "in this present life" (literally a "magical" or "manifest" life and path) appears to be a calque from the Chinese original for the present life. Several clauses in this Chinese-derived Tibetan are obscure: "he does not speak of his wrongdoing as anything else," "defiled and attached to what he dwells on," "the soiled and stained," and "a companion of Māra and of his realm." These are best-effort renderings. The quotation of the gods' and nāgas' words is likewise of uncertain extent.

• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its Tibetan is often idiomatically obscure. "White garments of laypeople" renders "those with pale clothes," a calque of the Chinese term for laypeople. Two phrases are especially uncertain: "it only breeds one more torment" for □□□□

the truth (Skt. ānulomikī kṣānti). "Digest the offerings" takes □□□□ in its sense "to digest," matching the Chinese idiom for being worthy of the alms one receives. The word rendered "true" in "unsurpassed, true and perfect awakening" is literally "eternal" or "immutable"; here it apparently stands for samyak. "Nayuta" follows the transcription □□□□□□□□, which seems to reflect the Chinese transcription of nayuta. The large numbers are kept as the Tibetan states them; "hundred thousand myriad" renders □□□□□□□□. The third posture's figure lacks "myriad" in the Tibetan, and it is translated as written. The names of the Buddha "All-Illuminating" and of the Ash and Killing hells are translated from their meaning, since no Sanskrit form can be identified with confidence.

• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese (the Fozang jing), and several names are sound-spellings of Chinese transcriptions. The various spellings of the great Dharma master (Phu li ta 'bri ta ra 'dzin 'dzi, Pu le'u 'da', Pu li ta, Pu le'u ta) all render the Chinese for Pūrṇa Maitrāyaṇīputra and are given uniformly as Pūrṇa. The names of the corrupt monks of the past could not be securely identified: "Spreader of Suffering" translates the Tibetan (Chinese Kuan, "Suffering Shore"); "All Exists" translates the Tibetan; Tsangi, Bartada (possibly Chinese Banantuo, i.e. Upananda) and Rimada are given phonetically. "Conforming forbearance" renders the Tibetan "forbearance of non-contradiction," corresponding to anulomikī kṣānti. The four unobstructed wisdoms are the four discernments (pratisaṃvid).

• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its phrasing is often unidiomatic. A few passages are uncertain. The frightened disciple's words to his preceptor ("It ought to be explained in the manner of the practice of emptiness set down in the scriptures") are rendered literally, and their intent is unclear. In "I have set forth for the Saṅgha what concerns offerings," the word may instead mean "qualities." The sentence on the four dhyānas literally says that beings "have not attained" them since beginningless time; the probable point is that attaining the dhyānas alone does not make a true monk. The list "a śramaṇa, a brahmin, or a brahmin" repeats "brahmin" exactly as the Tibetan does. Throughout, the "absence of 'I'" translates the Tibetan for selflessness, phrased with the first-person pronoun.

• This sūtra survives in an early Tibetan translation that appears to be made from Chinese, which explains its archaic vocabulary. The phrase rendered "I practiced with something to attain" reflects the doctrinal point that offerings made with an acquisitive, attainment-oriented mind did not earn a prophecy. Several buddha names cannot be confidently given in Sanskrit and are translated literally: Unchanging Light (possibly corresponding to Dīpaṃkara in parallel versions), Radiant Light, King of Mountains, Supreme Flower, Excellent Splendor and Merit Protector. Puraśa is kept as the Tibetan transliterates it. The name rendered Kauṇḍinya is a Tibetan sound-spelling that seems to reflect a Chinese transcription of that name. The text gives eighty-eight thousand buddhas and then refers to "those eighteen thousand"; the passage is translated as written. The chapter colophon numbers this as the eighth chapter, although it is the eleventh in the overall sequence.

• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and the buddha and king names are Tibetan renderings of Chinese names, mostly not reconstructible to Sanskrit with confidence; I have translated them by meaning: Universal Protector, Universal God, Seer of All Rites, Royal Mark, Sunlight, Virtue, Last of the Many, Field-Plougher, Manifest Light, Light of Virtue. "Sunlight" reads □□□□□□□ as □□□□□□. "Unchanging Light" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is taken as a rendering of Chinese Dingguang, that is Dīpaṃkara, who in Buddhist tradition gave Śākyamuni his prophecy. "Jambūnada" assumes □□□□□□□□□□ renders Chinese Yanfutan. In this text, □□□□□□ / □□□□□□□ appears to function as "name" or "title", not "abbot". The ten epithets are given in their standard English forms. The closing words, presented as a plain statement, are taken as the king's aspiration.

• The Buddha named "Invincible" translates □□□□□□□, whose Sanskrit original I cannot identify with confidence (possibly Aparājita). Of the five bodhisattvas, □□□□□□□□□□ appears to be a

transcription of the name Sadāprarudita via a Chinese form; the other four (Dharma Seeker, Ever Compassionate, Unsparing of Self, Ever Diligent) are translated by meaning, as their Sanskrit forms are uncertain. In "even practicing in that way it was extremely difficult," the Tibetan reads □□□ ("joyful"), evidently a slip for □□□ ("difficult"), and is translated accordingly. In the sentence "None of them is without grasping at attainment," the Tibetan literally says "in all there is no grasping at attainment"; I have read it as an affirmation in line with the argument, but the wording is unclear. The words "So long as I did" in the final sentence are added to make explicit the implied link between the Buddha's own former views and the withheld prophecy; the continuation of the text supports this reading.

• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its Tibetan is often unidiomatic. Several sentences are obscure, and their renderings are interpretive. These include the deluded people's thought before the simile of the blind man, the line about those who "speak of it, seeing hostile people as great enemies," and the phrase rendered "if one searches for the heart of the matter." The verb rendered "test" (□□) appears to refer to the four-month probation given to former non-Buddhists who seek ordination. The passage on who is and is not "fit to be tested" seems internally inconsistent, but it is translated as it stands.

• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its idiom is often unusual. A few phrases are uncertain: "the outward form becomes manifest" renders an obscure expression; "flimsy and unsound" renders an expression literally meaning "not hard, not firm"; and in the simile of the performer, the details of his "changing cloths" and the audience being "taken aback" are approximate. "Kept under their control" for the laity's treatment of monks who have broken their discipline is likewise tentative.

• The thought attributed to the lax monks, "The things in this Dharma that are improper to do are improper to do," is translated as the Tibetan stands; its point is obscure, perhaps an empty assent to the rules that they do not actually follow. The phrase rendered "treats lightly and disparages" (□□□□□□□□□□□) is uncertain. This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its Tibetan is often unidiomatic.

• This text was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its phrasing is often unusual. The name rendered "Nirgranthas" is a Tibetan sound-spelling of the Chinese transcription of Nirgrantha (the Jain ascetics). "Jackal" renders the animal that the Chinese tradition contrasts with the lion. Two phrases are uncertain. In "a mind that has turned away from evil," the Tibetan literally reads "a mind born from evil." In "straw-thatch śramaṇas," the image is of a hollow, merely external renunciant.

• This sūtra is a Tibetan translation from Chinese, and its idiom is often unusual. "Falls into the state called the summit" renders a phrase that appears to reflect the Chinese notion of "falling at the summit," a stagnation on the path; the sense is uncertain. The syllables rendered "a worldly household" (Tibetan 'dzi gen ji) look like a transcription of a Chinese term and are uncertain. The phrases "the fruit of the place where the mind is fixed" and "the root source of the buddhas and those below them … its offspring" are obscure in the Tibetan and are rendered closely. The four corruptions (discipline, view, livelihood, conduct) are the standard four vipattis.

• This sūtra was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its idiom is often unusual, so several clauses are uncertain. The phrase rendered "the disciples who have broken away" is obscure in the Tibetan. "Arhats who have put an end to sorrow" renders an unusual expression. "The attainment of emptiness is the great obstacle to anxiety" follows the Tibetan word order closely, and the sense could also be that attaining emptiness removes the great obstacle of anxiety. "Without putting on another robe" interprets a terse conditional clause. "Stream-entry" reads the term as written with an unusual first syllable; the term is clear from the sequence of the four fruits.

• This is an early, idiosyncratic translation, probably made from Chinese, and several phrases

are obscure. In the list of perceptions about food, "a heavy debt to be repaid" interprets the unclear phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, and "something received as a protection" interprets □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□. The phrase "cutting off the sorrows and agitations of people" follows the Tibetan, which literally speaks of cutting off "the people of sorrow and agitation"; the sense appears to be cutting off the afflictions. "Has cut off concern for results and is not attached to the gain of livelihood" is a tentative reading of an obscure clause. The list of scriptural divisions has eleven items; "the dharma of the words 'thus it was'" seems to correspond to the itivṛttaka division.

• The clause rendered "a monk whose discipline is broken would do better to give up the precepts" interprets the obscure □□□□□ ... □□□□□□□□ as expressing preference ("rather"), in line with the sense of the passage that follows. The interlocutor □□□□□□ is rendered Nanda, as the Tibetan reads. In the parallel Chinese version of this sūtra the interlocutor may be Ānanda. The phrase rendered "those torn by grief and turmoil" is obscure in the Tibetan.

• This sūtra appears to be translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its idiom is often unusual. "He vanished at once" renders the obscure phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; the sense is uncertain. The verse in which a monk says "Even if it does not accord with the path I have taught..." is ambiguous in the Tibetan, as is the verse with "What I have is rare"; both are rendered as the boastful claims of false teachers, which fits the surrounding context. "Scriptural basis anywhere in the four directions" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally.

• This sūtra appears to have been translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and its verse is often terse and awkward; several lines are rendered by their most likely sense. The phrase "gods, asuras and spirits" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, whose exact classes are uncertain. □□□□□□□ is taken as a transcription of the Chinese name for Jetavana. "Three years" supplies an unstated unit for "three", and "the three" in the following line, also unspecified, may refer to the three trainings. The line rendered "like a rainbow, we are parted from the Lord of great wonders" is uncertain in the Tibetan.

• The addressee □□□□□□ is rendered "Nanda" as the standard equivalent. This text was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, however, and in the Chinese version the Buddha entrusts the teaching to Ānanda in the closing chapter, so the name may stand for Ānanda here. Several verse lines use unusual vocabulary typical of this translation from Chinese. These include □□□□□□□□□□□□, rendered "rouse yourselves," and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, rendered "cut through the veils that obscure the world." Their exact sense is uncertain.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.